MATHEMATICS · VERSION 9 · CORRECTED AFTER THE THIRD REVIEW · 11 OCTOBER 2026

The Prop Firm Option

The prop-firm programmes worth trading under each firm's rules and the plan's compliance policies, optimised setting by setting and derived step by step: how much one person can expect per month, and the mathematics behind every number.

$60,714 expected per month in the first year, one person, recommended plan

Expected values under a model of fair prices, for a trader with no predictive skill, under each firm's written rules as read on 4 and 5 October 2026. Firms may refuse payouts or apply behavioural rules at their discretion (Chapters 29 and 31). Not investment advice. Do not share or sell this plan: several firms close traders who run the same marketed strategy together.

THE ANSWER

Expected cash per month, one person

$60,714 a month in the first year, ± $2,251 (95%)

That is the expected cash, after the fees modelled (evaluation fees, activation and monthly fees, refunds and credits as each firm's rules give them; not taxes or payment costs), that one person receives per month in the *first year* of the recommended plan: 28 accounts at 13 prop firms, each traded with zero predictive skill under every rule of its firm that the model contains and the plan's own policies (flat every evening; no trade and no day above 40% of a target; at least 10 minutes between trades and no target or stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations; an account near its floor traded out with a last stop at the floor, so that it ends in a breach that frees its allocation). In 90% of simulated first years the total lies between $94,501 and $1,647,738 (median $665,386).

$68,972
Months 2–12 average (first year)

$71,981
Average of months 13–36 of 36-month lives (± $1,931)

$168,355
Value still to come at month 12 from accounts then open

$72,523
Sum of the accounts' long-run rates (Part II)

$41,579
If payouts are refused 2% / 5% / 15% by tier (Chapter 29)

$27,820
If refused 5% / 10% / 30%

$42,808
If every trading cost is twice the assumption

$31,474
First year with only $20,000 of starting cash

$24,078
Tier A firms only (15 accounts)

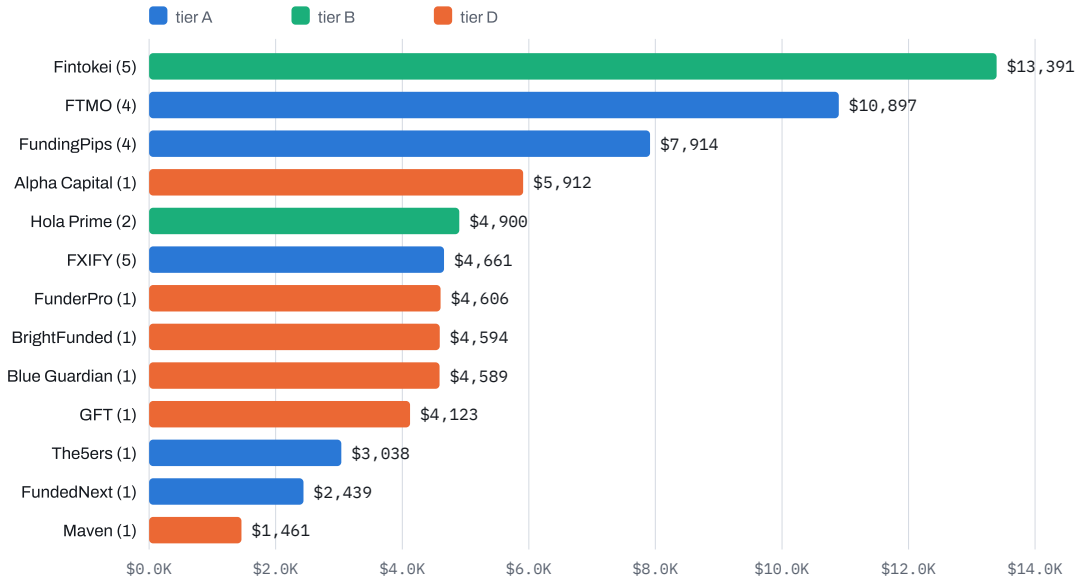
$40,249
Tiers A and B (22 accounts)

$69,885
Every firm at its full modelled allowance (35 accounts)

$67,882
Recommended + futures (53 accounts)

What changed from version 8

A third detailed review, of version 8, raised 21 findings (Appendix A); fixing them, and checking the corrected engine with new tests, found 5 further errors (n17, n18, n19, n20, n21). Every rule finding was checked against the firms' own pages and every model finding against the code, with the review's own witnesses rerun. The first-year figure moves from version 8's $62,198 a month to $60,714. **The model is stricter where the review found it lenient:** the account's floor and today's loss limit are barriers of every trade, so a position that reaches them ends the account even if the price recovers (version 8 clipped the loss afterwards); every position is whole lots or contracts; days completed with filler trades are real 0.01-lot trades with their cost and result, and Fintokei and Alpha Capital get none; Blue Guardian's bracket is placed only after 3 minutes; Alpha's duration rule is checked on each account; BrightFunded's days need a trade held a minute; Hola Prime's profitable days must fall within 14 days; Fintokei's next payout waits 14 days after the last one is processed; reviews and payout processing take working days. **The measurement changed:** Part II's long-run rate is now measured on continuing slots (one account run back to back with everything it carries) rather than read off random-start attempts; a finite budget can no longer spend a payout before it arrives; and a position in the portfolio counts as open only until its actual exit. Programme by programme (Chapter 9.4, random-start ratios), 4 of 24 chosen settings are below their version 8 value by more than their interval, 0 above it, and the rest within it. The figure is a new measurement under the corrected model, not version 8's minus a list. Version 6's $138,412 rested on bold play, which several firms forbid; version 7 replaced it with the 40% policy.



Long-run value per month by firm in the recommended plan (number of accounts in brackets): each account's long-run rate as a continuing slot (8.3). Colour: reliability tier (Chapter 29).

Where it comes from

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month per account (95%)	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	A	Nasdaq	4 × 100K	1.5% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$2,724 ± $319	$10,897

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month per account (95%)	EV/month
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	A	USDJPY	4 × 100K	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 20%	$1,979 ± $430	$7,914
The5ers HS	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20%	$3,038 ± $517	$3,038
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$2,609 ± $420	$2,609
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 50K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$1,194 ± $211	$1,194
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 25K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$558 ± $111	$558
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 10K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$212 ± $44	$212
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 5K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$87 ± $21	$87
FundedNext Stellar	A	EURUSD	1 × 200K	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	$2,439 ± $766	$2,439
Fintokei ProTrader	B	Nasdaq	5 × 100K	1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	$2,678 ± $364	$13,391
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	B	gold	2 × 100K	1.75% / 7 / 1.03 / 20%	$2,450 ± $479	$4,900
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	$5,912 ± $1,118	$5,912
FunderPro Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.5% / 6 / 0.92 / 30%	$4,606 ± $668	$4,606
GFT Standard	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%	$4,123 ± $390	$4,123
BrightFunded Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 3.5 / 1 / 30%	$4,594 ± $873	$4,594
Blue Guardian 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 15%	$4,589 ± $654	$4,589
Maven 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 2 / 1.25 / 4.9%	$1,461 ± $111	$1,461
28 accounts at 13 firms						**$72,523**

Risk / k / m / X: risk per trade and payout target as a share of the account, reward-to-risk, stop in hourly standard deviations. Per-account values are long-run rates of continuing slots on sixteen new paths (8.3); their sum ($72,523 ± $5,189, the interval from the per-path totals of all of them, 8.4) is a different quantity from the first-year average ($60,714), see 8.5.

What the number means, and what it does not

- It is an **expected value under a model**: the average over many possible years if prices are fair random walks with the measured volatility and costs. The ± is the simulation's precision, not a range for real income.
- It assumes **zero skill**: the value comes from the contract (a capped loss, a share of gains), not from predicting prices.
- It assumes the firms **pay as their rules say** and do not judge the plan's trading to break their behavioural rules (Chapter 31.2). The refusal scenarios above price random refusals only.
- It assumes every slot is **refilled at once**, which needs cash for fees; with a finite budget the first year is lower (Chapter 28.7).
- It is **per person**: every firm limits what one person may hold. Accounts in anyone else's name are not allowed and are not in the plan.

How it was found

1. Part I derives every formula and says which model it is exact for; the exact chain of 5.5 implements the plan's actual rule near the floor. tests_v9.py checks every rule mechanism of the engine directly, the review's witnesses included (Chapter 11), and audit_v9.py replays every chosen setting trade by trade against every rule.
2. Every programme's settings (risk, k, stop, payout target, market) were searched over 10,857 grid settings and 399 refined ones (28 million simulated attempts), then re-measured on sixteen fresh paths each, and run as continuing slots on sixteen more for their long-run rates.
3. The engine was checked against the chain with the daily rules switched off (Chapter 11), and the rules' own effect measured with them on.
4. The accounts were run together, one person at a time, each simulated life on its own new paths: 8,400 first years, 800 three-year lives, and the budget and stress scenarios.

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NOTATION

Notation and conventions

Symbol	Meaning
S	account size
F	fee per attempt
A, A_1, A_2	profit target of a phase
B	maximum loss of a phase (distance to the floor)
b	safety buffer above the floor ($100 per $100K)
d	daily loss limit
D	funded allowance
α	profit split
R	fee refund
X_1, X	funded payout target: first, later
L, l	risk per trade: the plan's, and the one actually used
k	reward-to-risk setting
w	net win of a trade, after caps and costs
c, ρ	round-trip cost of a trade; per dollar of risk, $\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$
σ	hourly standard deviation of the log price
m	stop distance in hourly standard deviations
N	notional of a position, $l/(m\sigma)$
κ	round-trip cost as a fraction of the notional
λ	leverage (1:λ)
p	win probability of one bracket
P, P_1, P_2	pass probability
q_1, q	probability that a funded cycle reaches its payout target
X_{end}	balance at which an attempt or account ends
V, C, T	value of an attempt, funded cash, duration
K	expected total cost of a phase or cycle
EV/month	$30.44\,\mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$ in days, a long-run rate: measured on continuing slots, or as the search's random-start ratio (8.3)

Money is in US dollars. A 100K account is $100,000 of simulated capital. ± is a 95% Monte Carlo interval under the model. "Fresh paths" are synthetic price paths that played no part in choosing the setting they measure. "Engine" is the rule-by-rule simulation; "chain" the exact trade-level equations; "Brownian" the continuous approximation. Tiers A, B, D are the firms' reliability classes (Chapter 29).

PART I

The mathematics, from zero

Every result in this document follows from a handful of facts about fair games. This part derives each of them, says exactly which model each formula is exact for, and works the numbers of the plan through at every step. Where a formula is an approximation it is labelled as one, and the engine (the rule-by-rule simulation) supplies the figure that is used.

CHAPTER 1

What is being bought

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells an *evaluation*. You pay a fee, you trade a simulated account under written rules, and if you meet the profit targets without breaking a loss limit, the firm gives you a *funded* account. On the funded account you keep a share of every profit you withdraw, and the firm absorbs every loss. You never owe the firm money beyond the fee.

That last sentence is the whole opportunity. Your downside is capped at the fee, and your upside is a share of profits that, as Chapter 7 shows, have a positive expected size even when every trade is a coin flip. The contract is an *option*: you pay a premium (the fee) for the right to keep part of the gains of a game whose losses fall on someone else.

1.1 The parts of the contract

Symbol	Meaning	FTMO 2-Step 100K, as an example
S	account size (simulated money)	$100,000
F	fee for one attempt	€540 = $607.82 at 1.1256
A_1, A_2	profit targets of phase 1 and phase 2	$10,000 and $5,000
B	maximum loss: the floor sits B below the starting balance and never moves ("static")	$10,000
d	daily loss limit, measured from a reference level set at each day's reset	$5,000
D	maximum loss on the funded account (the "allowance")	$10,000
α	your share ("split") of every profit withdrawn	80%
R	fee refund, paid with the first payout	$607.82
—	minimum trading days, payout cycle, other rules	4 days per phase; payouts every 14 days

1.2 The value of one attempt

Call the cash an attempt brings you V. It is the fee (always paid), plus, if both phases are passed, whatever the funded account pays out (the refund included):

VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$V = -F + \mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\} \cdot C, \qquad \mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass}) \cdot \mathbb{E}[C \mid \text{pass}]$$

Here $\mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\}$ is 1 if both phases are passed and 0 otherwise, and C is the total cash from the funded account. Where a firm returns part of the fee as non-cash credit when a phase is passed (The5ers), that credit is a third term, counted separately from cash (Chapter 14).

1.3 The whole argument in five lines, in an idealised model

Before the details, the result in its simplest form: no trading costs, every phase ending exactly at its target or its floor, and payouts of a fixed cycle target X from a static allowance. Chapter 5 proves that a fair game reaches $+A$ before $-B$ with probability $B/(A+B)$ in that model; Chapter 7 proves that a funded account then withdraws on average exactly D before it is lost, and reaches its first payout with probability $q = D/(D+X)$. The refund comes only with that first payout, so it is weighted by q:

FTMO 2-STEP, ZERO COST, ZERO SKILL, IDEALISED

$$\Pr(\text{pass}) = \frac{B}{A_1+B} \cdot \frac{B}{A_2+B} = \frac{10{,}000}{20{,}000} \cdot \frac{10{,}000}{15{,}000} = \frac{1}{3}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass})\big(\alpha D + q\,R\big) = -632 + \tfrac{1}{3}\Big(8{,}000 + \tfrac{10{,}000}{10{,}000+X}\,632\Big)$$

At the version 6 fee of $632 this is $2,140.00 with a cycle of $X = \$10{,}000$ and $2,087.33 with $X = \$30{,}000$; version 6 printed $2,245, which counts the refund on every pass and is only the limit as $X \to 0$. At the correct fee of $607.82 and $X = \$10{,}000$ it is $-607.82 + \tfrac{1}{3}(8{,}000 + 303.91) = \$2{,}160.15$.

Everything else in this document refines this number: trading costs lower it; the plan's policies (flat every evening, at most 40% of a target from one trade or one day, at least 10 minutes between trades, targets and stops at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry, whole lots, and a last trade with its stop at the floor when an account has too little room left) change both the value and the time; and the settings are then chosen to make the most of it per month and per person. The sign is already visible here; its size needs the full engine.

1.4 Why the firm still makes money, and what that implies

The firm's revenue is the fees of everyone, and most traders are not zero-skill traders with a plan built around the contract: they over-trade, break rules, abandon accounts and stop after one failure. A plan that treats the contract as a mathematical object and repeats it many times is the case the firm's pricing does not cover. Firms know this, and their terms contain behavioural rules (against "gambling", "all-in" trading, one-trade target attainment, account rolling) that are written broadly and applied at their discretion. The plan is built to meet every rule that can be stated as a condition on trades, and Chapter 31 lists the behavioural rules that cannot, firm by firm, as conditions under which the figures here apply.

CHAPTER 2

The probability toolkit

Seven ideas carry the analysis. Each is stated with the conditions it needs.

2.1 Expected value and linearity

A random quantity X that takes values $x_1, x_2, \ldots$ with probabilities $p_1, p_2, \ldots$ has expected value $\mathbb{E}[X] = \sum_i p_i\, x_i$. For any random quantities, dependent or not,

$$\mathbb{E}[X + Y] = \mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y], \qquad \mathbb{E}[cX] = c\,\mathbb{E}[X].$$

Linearity says that the expected cash of many accounts *over one horizon, under one policy* is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, however strongly they move together. It does not say that a first year's average equals a long-run rate (they are different quantities, Chapter 8.5), and it does not make correlation irrelevant: correlation leaves the sum of the means alone and changes everything else (the spread, the cash needed for fees, the chance of many failures at once).

2.2 Variance

$\mathrm{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[(X - \mathbb{E}X)^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - (\mathbb{E}X)^2$. For independent X, Y variances add; for dependent ones a term $2\,\mathrm{Cov}(X, Y)$ is added. Variance enters the time a fair game takes (Chapter 8) and the confidence intervals of every simulated figure.

2.3 Fair games and martingales

A sequence of balances $X_0, X_1, \ldots$ is a *martingale* if $\mathbb{E}[X_{n+1} \mid X_0, \ldots, X_n] = X_n$. "Zero skill" means this for the balance before costs: the price is a martingale, the balance is a sum of positions times price changes, and no rule for direction, size or timing that uses only the past can change that. With costs the expected next balance is lower by the cost: a *supermartingale*.

2.4 Stopping times and the optional stopping theorem

A *stopping time* τ is a rule for when to stop that uses only information available at the time. The *optional stopping theorem*: if X is a martingale, τ is almost surely finite, and the stopped process $X_{n \wedge \tau}$ is bounded (or, more generally, uniformly integrable), then

$$\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = X_0.$$

Each use below states why the condition holds. For one phase it holds because the balance stays between the floor and the target plus one win. For a funded account whose profits are withdrawn the balance plus everything withdrawn is *not* bounded, so Chapter 7 applies the theorem to one payout cycle at a time, where it is.

2.5 Wald's identity

If the steps $Y_1, Y_2, \ldots$ are independent and identically distributed with finite mean μ, and τ is a stopping time with $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$, then $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{n \le \tau} Y_n] = \mu\,\mathbb{E}[\tau]$. Having the same *unconditional* mean at every step is not enough: with $Y_1 = \pm 1$ equally likely, $Y_2 = -Y_1$, and stopping after the first step if $Y_1 = +1$ and after the second otherwise, every step has mean 0 but the stopped sum has mean $\frac{1}{2}$. The form used here is the martingale one: if the *conditional* mean of each step given the past is $-c_n$ (a cost known when the trade is placed), the conditional absolute means are bounded and $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$, then $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau - X_0] = -\mathbb{E}[\sum_{n \le \tau} c_n]$, because $X_n + \sum_{i \le n} c_i$ is a martingale with bounded increments in mean and optional stopping applies. Every trade of the plan has conditional mean minus its own cost given everything before it (4.3), so this holds even when the cost varies from trade to trade.

2.6 Brownian motion

The continuous-time limit of a fair random walk is Brownian motion W_t: it starts at 0, has independent increments, and $W_{t+h} - W_t$ is normal with mean 0 and variance h. A process $X_t = \mu t + \sigma W_t$ has three martingales that carry the approximations of Chapters 5 and 8:

$$X_t - \mu t, \qquad (X_t - \mu t)^2 - \sigma^2 t, \qquad \exp\!\left(-\tfrac{2\mu}{\sigma^2} X_t\right).$$

The third follows from Itô's formula: $de^{\lambda X} = e^{\lambda X}(\lambda\mu + \frac{1}{2}\lambda^2\sigma^2)\,dt + (\ldots)\,dW$, whose dt term vanishes for $\lambda = -2\mu/\sigma^2$. These formulas are exact for Brownian motion; applied to a sum of bracket trades, which jump, they are approximations (5.2).

2.7 The reflection principle

For a Brownian path from a to b over a time with variance v, the chance that it rose above $y \ge \max(a, b)$ in between is

$$\Pr\left(\max \ge y \,\middle|\, a \to b\right) = \exp\!\left(-\frac{2(y-a)(y-b)}{v}\right).$$

This gives the *marginal* distribution of the maximum of a bridge (and, by symmetry, of the minimum). The maximum and the minimum of one bridge are dependent, and the marginal alone does not say which of a high and a low level was touched first. Section 3.3 bounds the error of drawing them independently. For two levels $\ell < a, b < u$ the exact chance of staying between them is the image series $\sum_k \left[e^{-2kW(kW-(b-a))/v} - e^{-2(a-\ell-kW)(b-\ell-kW)/v}\right]$, $W = u - \ell$, which tests_v9.py uses to check the bound.

CHAPTER 3

The price model

3.1 Hourly volatility

Over one hour the log price changes by a random amount with standard deviation σ, the *hourly volatility*, measured on two years of real hourly bars (Yahoo Finance, 2024–26, only hours that follow another trading hour):

Market	Price, 2 Oct 2026	Hourly σ	Daily σ	Round-trip cost κ	κ/σ	Entry hours used (UTC)
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0064%	0.023	01–18
USDJPY	157.83	0.1193%	0.58%	0.0051%	0.043	00–18
EURUSD	1.126	0.0853%	0.42%	0.0062%	0.073	07–18
gold (XAUUSD)	4,176.80	0.2838%	1.36%	0.0108%	0.038	01–18
micro Nasdaq futures (MNQ)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0027%	0.010	01–18

σ: standard deviation of hourly log returns on 2024–26 data (sigma_v32.json); daily = hourly × √23 (indices, gold) or √24 (currencies). κ: spread + commission + slippage allowance as a fraction of the notional, per round trip (calibrate.py). κ/σ is the cost of one hourly standard deviation of movement. Entry hours: the market's hours, cut at 19:00 UTC by the daily flat (no entry from 19:00, everything closed at 20:00).

Over h hours the standard deviation grows like $\sigma\sqrt{h}$: the Nasdaq moves about 1.31% in a 23-hour trading day. Every stop in the plan is a multiple of σ, so the same rules fit every market.

3.2 Zero drift, stated precisely

The model gives the *price* no expected change: $\mathbb{E}[P_{t+h} \mid P_t] = P_t$. That is the zero-skill assumption, and it is a modelling choice, not a theorem. For the price itself to be a martingale, the log price must drift down by $\sigma^2/2$ per hour (about 0.0004% for the Nasdaq): $\log P_{t+h} - \log P_t$ is normal with mean $-\sigma^2 h/2$ and variance $\sigma^2 h$. The Nasdaq's real long-run rise (about 0.0025% per hour, a hundredth of σ) is left out. Version 7 justified that by saying the plan is long and short equally often; equal counts do not settle it, because the drift's effect depends on the signed exposure over each trade's holding time. In the model the direction of every account's first position is chosen by a rule that is symmetric in up and down moves, so, with the price a martingale, a real drift would add its effect to longs and subtract it from shorts in expectation; the plan's results are therefore stated for the zero-drift model, and a real drift is one of the things that could make them wrong (Chapter 31.6).

3.3 Synthetic paths

1. Each hour is split into 60 one-minute sub-steps of normal increments of the log price with variance $\sigma^2/60$ and mean $-\sigma^2/120$ (version 7: 12 five-minute sub-steps).
2. Within each sub-step, the highest and the lowest point are drawn from the exact marginal distributions of a Brownian bridge between the sub-step's end points (2.7):

$$\max = \tfrac{1}{2}\left(a + b + \sqrt{(b-a)^2 - 2v\ln U}\right), \qquad U \sim \mathrm{Uniform}(0,1),$$

   and the minimum is the mirror image with an independent draw. Each is exact on its own, so a single level (a stop alone, or the account's breach level alone during a holding time) is crossed with exactly the right probability; drawing the two independently is not exact jointly, because a bridge that rises far is a little less likely to fall far as well. The sub-step's closing price is kept too: a position closed at a fixed time (a filler trade, the end of a holding time) is closed at it.
3. When a stop and a target both fall inside one hourly bar, the engine replays that hour's sixty sub-steps in time order and takes the level the path touched first; it also uses the exit minute for the 10-minute gap between trades (10.4) and for the trade's duration. Only if both levels fall inside the *same* one-minute sub-step does it decide by the martingale chance from the sub-step's starting price, which is not the exact conditional probability either; its error lies inside the bound of the next item.
4. **How large the error can be.** Couple the generator with an exact Brownian path that has the same sub-step end points (their law is exact). Given end points a, b inside a bracket $[\ell, u]$ of log-width W, a sub-step's outcome (no touch, stop, target) can differ between the two only on the event that both barriers are touched, so the total-variation error is at most $P_{\text{ind}} + P_{\text{exact}}$, where $P_{\text{ind}} = e^{-2[(a-\ell)(b-\ell)+(u-a)(u-b)]/v}$ is the generator's chance and P_{exact} the bridge's. By the strong Markov property at the first touch of ℓ, the bridge then runs from ℓ to b and reaches u with chance at most $e^{-2W(u-b)/v}$, so $P_{\text{exact}} \le e^{-2[(a-\ell)(b-\ell)+W(u-b)]/v} + e^{-2[(u-a)(u-b)+W(b-\ell)]/v} \le 2P_{\text{ind}}$: the error is at most $3P_{\text{ind}}$ (with an end point outside the bracket, at most twice the chance of touching the far barrier, which is smaller). *Version 8 claimed $P_{\text{ind}} \le e^{-W^2/v}$, arguing that the exponent is smallest with both end points at the middle; that is true only for a sub-step with no net move, and false when the end points lie near opposite barriers: with $\ell = 0$, $u = 1$, $a = 0.01$, $b = 0.99$, $v = 0.01$, $P_{\text{ind}} = e^{-3.96} = 0.019$ and the exact chance is $e^{-4} = 0.0183$, against a claimed e^{-100} (review of version 8, finding 2).* For a net move $\delta = b - a$ the largest P_{ind} over the starting point is $e^{-(W^2-\delta^2)/v}$ (at $a = \ell + (W-\delta)/2$). The move is independent of where the sub-step starts and of whether the trade is still open, so each sub-step in which a trade watches both barriers adds at most

$$G(r) = \mathbb{E}\Big[\min\big(1,\ 3e^{-(r^2-Z^2)}\big)\,\mathbf{1}\{|Z| \le r\} + \mathbf{1}\{|Z| > r\}\Big] = \frac{6}{\sqrt{2\pi}}\,e^{-(r^2+\ln 3)/2}\,J(x) + \operatorname{erfc}\big(x/\sqrt{2}\big),$$

   with $r = W/\sqrt{v}$ (less the tiny drift per sub-step), Z standard normal, $x = \sqrt{r^2 - \ln 3}$ and $J(x) = \int_0^x e^{(t^2-x^2)/2}dt$; $G(r)$ is close to $e^{-r^2/2}$, the square root of version 8's figure. By the union bound over sub-steps, a trade's outcome differs from an exact path's with probability at most $G(r)$ times its expected number of such sub-steps. At the plan's narrowest bracket (stop and target 0.6 hourly standard deviations each, $r \approx 1.2\sqrt{60} = 9.3$), $G \approx 5 \times 10^{-20}$ per minute. The engine adds this bound up over every simulated trade (Chapter 11). It is a bound on the generator's error under the model, not a claim that the construction is exact.

5. Markets that close at weekends are closed in the path from Friday to Sunday, but the price keeps moving underneath, so Monday can open with a gap. Under the plan's daily flat (6.5) no position is open then.
6. **Random streams.** Every path is drawn from its own stream of random numbers, a numpy SeedSequence keyed by the path number, the market group, the length, the sub-steps per hour and the correlation. Each stage has its own path numbers: the grid search 101–104, the refinement 111–114, the final value of every chosen setting 121–136 (sixteen paths), the continuing slots 151–166, the sensitivities 141–144, the checks 401–6131, the rule tests 901–905, and the portfolio simulation one new path number per simulated life (100,000 and up; 300,000 and up for three-year lives). Gold, USDJPY and EURUSD use the life's number with their own key, so their paths are independent of the Nasdaq and of each other. Version 7 gave other markets offset numbers (+50, +60, +70), which made, for example, gold's validation paths reuse the random numbers of yen's search paths; streams_v9.py lists every stream of every stage and checks that no two independent stages share one (stream_manifest_v9.json). The Nasdaq CFD and the micro Nasdaq future share one stream on purpose: they follow the same index. Chapter 28 measures what a correlation of 0.3 between all four markets changes.

3.4 What the model leaves out

Real prices have volatility that changes (calm and wild months), fat tails, jumps at news, and spreads that widen at the daily break and around releases. The plan's stops and targets are at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry, so that average costs are a fair description, and the cost stress tests of Chapter 31 double every cost. The synthetic model is the right tool for the question asked (what is the contract worth to a trader with no edge), not a forecast of any particular year.

CHAPTER 4

The bracket trade

Every trade in the plan is a *bracket*: one position with a stop-loss and a take-profit attached the moment it opens, never moved, and closed at the latest at 20:00 UTC the same day.

4.1 Set-up

Open a long position at price e with notional N dollars (a short is the mirror image), stop a fraction s below the entry and target a fraction u above. The plan fixes three things and derives the rest:

- the **risk** l: what a stopped trade loses before costs. Normally $l = L$ (1–1.75% of the account, searched in Chapter 9), but never more than the room left, net of the trade's own cost (5.4);
- the **stop distance** $s = m\sigma$: m hourly standard deviations;
- the **win** w the trade nets after costs if it reaches its target: $w = \min\left(\max(\min(k\,l,\ \text{distance to the target}),\ w_{\min}),\ \text{caps}\right)$, where k is the reward-to-risk setting, the caps are the plan's 40% concentration policy (6.7) and any firm cap, and $w_{\min} = l\,(0.6/m - \rho)$ keeps the take-profit at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry (a target closer than that is reached a little past it). If a cap leaves less than $w_{\min}$: with nothing made yet that day, the risk is lowered until the cap is a full minimum-distance win (a small payout target, Maven's ceiling), never below the smallest position; with profit already made that day, no further trade until tomorrow.
- the **volume**: l/s divided by the value of one lot, rounded down to the volume step (0.01 lot of a CFD, one futures contract), never below the smallest volume (10.1). The trade's risk, cost and margin are those of the rounded volume; a win set by a cap (the target, a rule) keeps its amount, its take-profit placed for exactly that win, while an uncapped win $k\,l$ scales with the rounded risk.
- the **breach level**: the loss, cost included, at which the account breaches (the nearer of its floor and today's loss limit). It is a barrier of every trade: if the price reaches it, the account ends there, whatever the price does afterwards. A normal trade's stop is well inside it (5.4), so it matters only for the last trade near the floor and during a holding time (6.3, 7.4).

POSITION AND TARGET

$$N = \frac{l}{s}, \qquad Nu - c = w \;\Rightarrow\; u = \frac{s\,(w + c)}{l}.$$

A win pays $+w$ and a loss costs $-(l + c)$, where $c = \kappa N$ is the round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage allowance) of this position. (With whole lots, N is the rounded volume's notional and $l = Ns$; the formulas below hold for it.)

4.2 The win probability

The price is a martingale and the trade ends at the first touch of the stop or the target. If nothing else can end it and fills are exact, the exit price is bounded, so optional stopping (2.4) gives $p\,e(1 + u) + (1 - p)\,e(1 - s) = e$, i.e. $p = s/(s + u)$:

WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET (FIXED COST, EXACT FILLS)

$$p = \frac{l}{l + w + c} = \frac{1}{1 + w/l + c/l}.$$

4.3 The mean and the variance of one trade

With outcomes $+w$ (probability p) and $-(l + c)$:

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{pnl}] = p\,w - (1 - p)(l + c) = \frac{l\,w - (w + c)(l + c)}{l + w + c} = -c,$$

$$\text{Var}(\text{pnl}) = p\,(w + c)^2 + (1 - p)\,l^2 = l\,(w + c).$$

These hold for the binary trade of 4.2 with a cost known at entry. Some outcomes in the plan are not binary. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed at that hour's price, somewhere between stop and target; a filler trade (6.3) is closed after 3 minutes; at Blue Guardian a position whose price is already beyond its stop or target when its 3-minute hold ends is closed there (7.4). In each case the price is still a martingale and the closing time a bounded stopping time, so the mean is still $-c$, but the variance and the distribution differ. And a price that gaps through a level fills at the gap. The engine simulates all of them; the chain of Chapter 5 uses the binary trade.

4.4 What a trade costs

The round-trip cost is a fraction κ of the notional, so per dollar of risk

$$\rho \equiv \frac{c}{l} = \frac{\kappa N}{l} = \frac{\kappa}{m\sigma}.$$

Market	ρ at m = 0.6	0.75	1.0	1.25	at cost × 2, m = 0.6	m = 1.0
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	3.90%	3.12%	2.34%	1.87%	7.79%	4.68%
USDJPY	7.12%	5.70%	4.27%	3.42%	14.25%	8.55%
EURUSD	12.12%	9.70%	7.27%	5.82%	24.24%	14.55%

Market	ρ at m = 0.6	0.75	1.0	1.25	at cost × 2, m = 0.6	m = 1.0
gold (XAUUSD)	6.34%	5.07%	3.81%	3.04%	12.68%	7.61%

The round-trip cost in units of the risk, $\rho = c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$, for stops of m hourly standard deviations. The plan holds nothing through a daily reset, so there is no financing to add (version 6 paid up to 16% of the risk per night held at a tight Nasdaq stop).

Version 6 held winning trades through nights and paid overnight financing φN per rollover, a cost that is random (it depends on how long the trade lasts) and was not in the formulas. Since version 7 the plan holds no position through a daily reset (6.5), so there is no financing to add, and ρ is the whole cost (the checks of Chapter 11 that switch the daily flat off run without financing for that reason, n20).

4.5 The plan's trade on the Nasdaq, worked through

The plan's FTMO setting is risk $L = \$1{,}500$ (1.50% of $100,000), a stop of $m = 1$ hourly standard deviations, $k = 8$ and a payout target of $30,000. The first trade of phase 1 aims at $w = \min(k\,L,\ A,\ 0.4A) = \min(\$12{,}000,\ \$10{,}000,\ \$4{,}000) = \$4{,}000$. With the Nasdaq at 31,070:

Stop distance: $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price, i.e. 85.0 index points.

Notional: $N = l/s = \$548{,}068$, i.e. $\$17.64$ per index point. One lot is $1 per point (contract size 1, 10.1), so 17.640 lots, rounded *down* to 17.63 : the risk actually taken is $\$1{,}499.17$ (the engine trades the rounded volume; below, the unrounded figures keep the algebra readable).

Cost: $c = \kappa N = 0.0064\% \times \$548{,}068 = \$35.08$, so $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$.

Target: $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.2737\% \times 4{,}035.08/1{,}500 = 0.7362\%$, i.e. 228.7 points from the entry.

Win probability: $p = l/(l + w + c) = 1{,}500/(1{,}500 + 4{,}000 + 35.08) = 0.2710$.

Mean $-c = -\$35.08$; check: $p\,w - (1 - p)(l + c) = -35.08$. Variance $l(w + c) = 6{,}052{,}615$, standard deviation $\$2{,}460$.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$10{,}961$ = 11.0% of the starting balance; the engine re-checks it against the current balance at every entry (10.2).

Duration (8.1, approximate): $m^2(w + c)/l = 2.69$ hours of open market on average; losers 2.13 h, winners 4.21 h. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed there.

On the funded account (payout target $30,000) a full win is $\min(k\,L, X, 0.4X) = \$12{,}000$: take-profit 682 points away, $p = 0.1108$, winners 26.8 hours of open market on average, so some are cut by the daily flat and some wait for the next day's cap. No take-profit is ever closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations (51 points): a target closer than that is reached a little past it.

4.6 Ways a simulation can flatter a trade

1. **Skipping the entry bar.** Checking levels only from the next hour ignores stop-outs inside the entry hour. (Measured in version 4: +0.14 R per trade, all fake.)
2. **Sampling prices too rarely.** A few prices an hour miss touches in between, and the nearer level (the stop) is missed more often. The bridge extremes of 3.3 remove it.
3. **Ties inside one bar.** When one bar's range contains both levels, the bar alone does not say which came first. Version 5 used the fair chance; versions 6 and 7 replay five-minute sub-steps; version 8 replays one-minute sub-steps, and the remaining error is bounded in 3.3.
4. **Gaps.** A price that opens beyond the stop fills at the open. Under the daily flat there is no overnight or weekend position to gap.
5. **A rounding error at the target.** A win sized to close the gap to the target lands a few billionths of a dollar short in floating point; version 6's exact comparison then placed a pointless extra trade (risking $1,500 to make $1). Since version 7 the engine compares with a one-cent tolerance.
6. **Re-entering at once.** Checking only whole hours lets a trade close at 12:59 and the next open at 13:00. The engine uses the exit minute and waits at least 10 minutes (10.4).
7. **Clipping a loss at the floor.** A position larger than the room above the floor, whose loss is clipped back to the floor after the trade, keeps its full chance of winning while losing less than its stop: version 8 did this for risks under $1 per $100K and for one futures contract above a small room (a $0.50 room, a $1 risk and an $8 win had mean +$0.44 instead of $-c$). Since version 9 the floor is a barrier of the trade (4.1).
8. **Fractional positions.** A position of exactly l/s, however small, is not a real order. Since version 9 every position is whole lots or contracts (10.1).
9. **Holding a closed position open.** Counting a position as open until the next entry is allowed (up to an hour after its exit) lets another account copy a direction that is no longer held, and dates closed profit late. Since version 9 the engine keeps the exit time apart from the next permitted entry.

CHAPTER 5

Reaching a target before a floor

A phase is passed when the balance gains A before it loses B: the gambler's ruin. This chapter solves it in an idealised model, then exactly for the plan's actual rule.

5.1 The idealised model: $P = B/(A+B)$

Let X_n be the balance after n trades, a martingale with $X_0 = 0$, and τ the first time it reaches $+A$ or $-B$. *If* every trade is sized so the balance lands exactly on one of the two, X_τ is $+A$ with probability P and $-B$ otherwise, and optional stopping gives

$$0 = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = P\,A - (1-P)\,B \quad\Rightarrow\quad P = \frac{B}{A+B}.$$

The exact-landing assumption is what this formula needs. Under the plan's rule every failure does end exactly on the floor (5.4), but a pass can end a little above the target (the minimum target distance of 4.1 and the $20 filler margin of 6.3), so the formula is the benchmark and 5.5 gives the exact value.

5.2 With costs, approximately: the Brownian formula

Treat the balance as a Brownian motion with drift $-c$ and variance $v = l(w+c)$ per trade. By 2.6, $e^{\theta X}$ with $\theta = 2c/v$ is a martingale, and optional stopping gives

PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS (BROWNIAN APPROXIMATION)

$$P \approx \frac{e^{\theta B} - 1}{e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1}, \qquad \theta = \frac{2c}{v} = \frac{2\rho}{l\,(w/l + \rho)}, \qquad P \approx \frac{B}{A+B}\left(1 - \frac{c\,A}{v}\right).$$

This is accurate when each trade is small next to A and B and its size does not change. The plan's trades are capped (40% of the target), shrink near the floor and the daily limit, and jump: the exact chain of 5.5 is used instead, and the Brownian value is shown only for comparison.

5.3 How many trades, approximately

With a constant trade, $(X_n)^2 - nv$ is a martingale before costs, so $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau^2]/v = AB/v$ in the idealised model. With trades that change size the relevant quantity is the accumulated variance $\sum_n v(X_n)$, not v times the count; the chain computes the expected count exactly.

5.4 The plan's rule near the floor

Version 6's written rule could leave an account a few dollars above its floor with no trade ever allowed. Version 7 ended the attempt there and bought a replacement; but an account that has not breached is still open, and at firms with a per-person limit (FTMO's $400,000, FXIFY's one account per size) it may still count against it. Since version 8 every account ends in a way the firm records: a breach. At a balance x (relative to the start), with floor $-B$, buffer b ($100 per $100K) and the cost per dollar of risk ρ:

RISK OF THE NEXT TRADE

$$\text{room}(x) = \frac{x + B - b}{1+\rho}, \qquad l(x) = \min\left(L,\ \text{room}(x),\ \text{today's room},\ \text{margin room}\right) \quad \text{if room}(x) \ge l_{\min},$$
$$l_{\min} = \max\left(0.1\,L,\ \text{the smallest position's risk}\right).$$

THE TERMINAL TRADE (ROOM(X) < L_MIN)

$$\text{volume: } \frac{x+B}{1+\rho} \text{ at the plan's stop, rounded down, at least the smallest position;}$$
$$\text{its stop order: at the floor itself (the breach level), so a loss ends at } -B \text{ exactly.}$$

(If today's room is smaller than the room to the floor, the trade is a normal one with its stop inside today's room; if that is below the smallest position, the account waits for tomorrow. On futures L in the first line is at least one contract.)

A normal trade loses at most $l(1+\rho) \le x + B - b$, so it never reaches the floor. A terminal trade is an ordinary bracket at the plan's reward:risk, small (under a tenth of the normal risk), whose stop sits at the floor: a loss ends the account in a breach, which the firm closes, freeing the allocation; a win continues it, and the account returns to normal trades once the room allows. Where the smallest position at the plan's stop distance would risk more than the room (0.01 lot of gold, one futures contract), its stop order still sits at the floor, so it is closer than the plan's distance; the price reaching the floor ends the account at that moment, even if the price would later have reached the take-profit (version 8 let such a position run to its own stop and clipped the loss afterwards: review of version 8, finding 3). So every failure ends exactly at $-B$, the text, the engine and the chain follow the same rule, and no account is left open and unused.

5.5 The exact chain

The balance after each trade is a Markov chain on $[-B, A]$, plus a small overshoot above A. At x the next trade has risk $l(x)$ as in 5.4, win $w(x) = \min(\max(\min(k\,l,\ A-x),\ w_{\min},\ \$1),\ \text{cap})$ (4.1), cost $c(x) = \rho\,l_v(x)$, where l_v is the risk of the volume traded (l on a normal trade), and win chance $p(x) = l_e/(l_e + w + c)$, where $l_e = l$ on a normal trade and $l_e = x + B - c$, the distance to the floor, on a terminal trade; it moves to $x +$

w (a pass if $x + w \geq A$, possibly above A) or to $x - l - c$ (to $-B$ exactly after a terminal trade). The chain uses unrounded volumes; the engine's whole lots change a trade's risk by less than one volume step. Four functions solve the same recursion with different end values:

ONE STEP OF THE EXACT CHAIN

$$V(x) = p\,V(x+w) + (1-p)\,V(x-l-c), \qquad V = 1 \text{ from } A \text{ up},\ 0 \text{ at } -B,$$
$$N(x) = 1 + p\,N(x+w) + (1-p)\,N(x-l-c), \qquad K(x) = c(x) + p\,K(x+w) + (1-p)\,K(x-l-c),$$
$$T(x) = p\,T(x+w) + (1-p)\,T(x-l-c), \qquad T = \text{the balance where the attempt ends.}$$

V is the pass probability, N the expected number of trades, K the expected total cost and T the expected final balance. They are solved by value iteration on a grid of about 8,000 points (analytic_v9.py). Because every trade's conditional mean is exactly minus its own cost (4.3), the stopped balance is bounded and the number of trades has finite mean, optional stopping (2.4, 2.5) gives the accounting identity, which the solver checks:

THE ACCOUNTING IDENTITY, EXACT

$$P\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + (1-P)\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -K(0), \qquad \text{and with every failure at } -B: \quad P = \frac{B - K(0)}{\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B}.$$

The textbook form $P = (B-K)/(A+B)$ is the special case where every pass ends exactly at A. Under the plan's rule a pass ends a little above A, so the textbook form overstates P slightly (0.05 to 2.00 percentage points over the chosen programmes).

FTMO phase 1 ($A = B = \$10{,}000$, buffer \$100) at the plan's setting (risk \$1,500, $k = 8$, $m = 1$, $\rho = 2.34\%$). No win can exceed $0.4A = \$4{,}000$, so no single win ends the phase from the start; the first trades along the all-loss path:

Trade j on the all-loss path	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win w_j	p_j	A win ends the phase?
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
2	−\$1,535	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
3	−\$3,070	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
4	−\$4,605	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
5	−\$6,140	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
6	−\$7,675	\$1,500	\$35.08	\$4,000	0.2710	no
7	−\$9,210	\$674	\$15.76	\$4,000	0.1437	no

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4680$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.83$, $K(0) = \$597$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$.

Identity: $P_1\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + (1-P_1)(-B) = 0.4680 \times 10{,}093 - 0.5320 \times 10{,}000 = -596.93 = -K(0)$ (gap -0.0000); the mean balance at a pass is \$10,093, above A by the \$20 filler margin and the small overshoot of minimum-distance targets.

Exact form $P = (B-K)/(\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B) = 0.4680$; the textbook form $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4697$ (with A the target the engine trades to, the firm's target plus the \$20 filler margin of 6.3) is 0.17 percentage points higher, because a pass ends a little above A. Every failure ends exactly at $-B$ under the terminal rule (5.4).

Brownian approximation (5.2) with a constant full-size trade: $P_1 \approx 0.4711$.

Phase 2 ($A = \$5{,}000$, wins capped at \$2,000): $P_2 = 0.6170$, 18.39 trades, $K = \$623$. Both: $P = 0.2888$ (chain).

The engine (with the daily limit, the daily flat, minimum days, the per-day concentration cap and weekends), on sixteen fresh paths: $P = 0.2914 \pm 0.0079$ (cluster-robust, 8.4). With those rules switched off (11.2) it gives 0.2945 ± 0.0078, against the chain's 0.2893.

5.6 Bold play, and why the plan does not use it

Each trade costs on average $c = \rho\, l_v$, proportional to the risk of the volume traded, so a phase's expected total cost is $K = \rho\,\mathbb{E}\big[\sum_i l_i\big]$, the cost rate times the expected total risk staked, not a constant times the number of trades: fewer, larger trades need not cost less. And by 5.5 the pass probability depends on both K and the mean balance at a pass, $P = (B-K)/(\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B)$, so lowering K while raising the overshoot does not by itself raise P. Version 8 argued from "fewest trades, least cost" to staking enough to reach the target in one win; that step does not follow under variable stakes and overshoots (review of version 8, finding 18). *Bold play*, which Dubins and Savage (1965) proved optimal for reaching a goal in a fair or slightly unfavourable game of fixed odds and exact landing, is a theorem about that model, not about this one. What is measured is that version 6's search, left free, moved every programme to k of 20–30 and payout cycles of 25–30% of the account, so that a single trade could pass a phase or fill a payout; that is an empirical result for its grid, not a proof of optimality.

Version 7 gave that up, deliberately, and versions 8 and 9 keep it so. Several firms forbid exactly this behaviour: Fintokei forbids reaching a target "in one or a few identical trades", The5ers bans "one-trade target attainment" permanently, Alpha forbids "all or nothing" trading, FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy reacts to one trade idea above 60% of a target, and FundedNext, Hola Prime, FTMO and FXIFY reserve the right to treat concentrated outcomes as gambling. The plan therefore caps every trade and every day at 40% of the current target (6.7), so that every phase takes at least three winning days (a payout taken on its date before the target can rest on fewer, 6.7). Under that cap one win can never end a phase, the product formula for bold play (the chance of passing as a sequence of all-or-nothing trades) never applies, and the chain of 5.5 is the exact value in its model. The settings within the policy are chosen by search (Chapter 9), and the search's winners are empirical results for the grid searched.

For reference, the bold product formula, $P = \sum_j p_j \prod_{i<j}(1-p_i)$ with $x_{j+1} = x_j - l_j - c_j$, is exact only if *every* possible win ends the phase, i.e. $k\,l(x_j) \geq A - x_j$ at every state on the all-loss path; $kL \geq A + B$ is not enough, because $l(x)$ shrinks near the floor. Version 6's tables printed wins of $A - x_j$ even where $k\,l(x_j)$ was smaller; those rows described trades the plan would not place.

k	Phase 1 trades, 40% cap	P, 40% cap	Attempt value, 40% cap	Phase 1 trades, no cap	P, no cap	Attempt value, no cap
1.5	31.2	0.2738	+$854	31.2	0.2765	+$868
2	24.0	0.2829	+$1,074	24.0	0.2910	+$1,122
3	18.2	0.2886	+$1,300	16.5	0.3027	+$1,393
4	18.1	0.2887	+$1,402	12.7	0.3104	+$1,554
6	17.9	0.2887	+$1,510	9.2	0.3170	+$1,717
8	17.8	0.2888	+$1,564	7.3	0.3201	+$1,800
12	17.8	0.2888	+$1,566	5.9	0.3219	+$1,876
20	17.8	0.2888	+$1,567	5.8	0.3221	+$1,926
30	17.7	0.2888	+$1,567	5.6	0.3223	+$1,946

Exact chain, FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's stop m = 1, risk $1,500 and payout target $30,000. Without the cap the value keeps rising with k toward bold play; with it, k beyond the cap changes nothing.

In the engine, at the plan's setting: $2,654 ± $251 a month with the 40% policy, $2,820 ± $443 with a 60% cap and $3,350 ± $382 with no cap at the same k (paths 141–144). Version 6's uncapped FTMO setting (k = 20, m = 0.5, X = 30%) was worth $5,463 a month in its own final run.

CHAPTER 6

The evaluation in full

6.1 Two phases

Always, $\Pr(\text{pass both}) = P_1 \cdot \Pr(\text{pass 2} \mid \text{passed 1})$. A fresh second account resets the balance, but not the calendar: the weekday and hour at which phase 2 starts, and on futures the price level that sets a contract's risk, depend on how and when phase 1 ended (and on the review that follows it), and the daily flat and the calendar shape the path phase 2 can trade. Independent future price increments do not make that starting state independent. So the conditional probability is not in general an unconditional P_2 (version 8 said it was: review of version 8, finding 13). The engine simulates the two phases in sequence on one path, so its pass rate estimates $P_1 \Pr(2 \mid 1)$ directly, with $\Pr(2 \mid 1)$ taken under the start states phase 1 actually leads to. In the calendar-free chain of 5.5, where a phase depends on nothing but the balance, the phases are independent and $P = P_1 P_2$ is exact; that is the only model in which this document multiplies unconditional probabilities.

Version 6 also said that putting the larger target first saves time and cost. It does not in general: with the Brownian trade count of 5.3 and targets A, C over a common B, the expected number of trades is $AB/v + \frac{B}{A+B} \cdot CB/v$, which for $A = 10{,}000$, $C = 5{,}000$, $B = 10{,}000$ and $v = 1{,}500^2 \times 5$ is 11.11 trades, against 10.37 with the targets reversed. The claim is withdrawn.

6.2 The daily loss limit

Most firms add a floor that is reset every day: the account may not fall more than d below a reference level fixed at the reset. Firms fix that level differently:

Firm	Reference fixed at the reset	Reset	Allowance	Engine
FTMO	balance at the reset	00:00 Prague (22:00/23:00 UTC)	5% of the initial balance	fixed
FundingPips	higher of the day's opening balance and equity	platform midnight, UTC+3 (21:00 UTC)	4% of that level	relative
The5ers	higher of the previous day's closing balance and equity	00:00 server time	5% of that level ($5,500 at $110,000)	relative
FXIFY	previous day's balance	17:00 New York	4% of that balance	relative
FundedNext	the day's starting balance	00:00 server time	5% of the initial balance	fixed
Fintokei	equity at the start of the day	00:00 server time	5% of that equity	relative
Hola Prime	previous day's closing balance	17:00 New York	5% of that balance	relative
Alpha Capital	the day's starting balance (close of the daily candle)	00:00 broker time	5% of that balance	relative
GFT	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	5% of that level	relative
FunderPro	the day's starting balance (balance-based)	00:00 GMT+3	5%; base not stated	the stricter of the two
BrightFunded	higher of balance and equity at rollover	rollover, Prague time	5% of the original size	fixed
Blue Guardian	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	4% of the initial balance	fixed
Maven	higher of equity and balance	00:00 UTC	4% of that level (4% of $1,100 in its example)	relative

As published (4 October 2026; rules_snapshot_v9.json quotes the pages). Engine: 'fixed' subtracts a share of the initial balance from the reference; 'relative' a share of the day's reference itself, recomputed at every reset (version 7 used 'fixed' everywhere but Fintokei). Every reset falls between 20:00 UTC and 00:00 UTC, while the plan holds no position, so balance and equity are equal whenever a reference is fixed.

Two things differ by firm: the *reference* fixed at the reset (balance, equity, the higher of the two, the previous day's close) and the *base* of the percentage. At FTMO, FundedNext, BrightFunded and Blue Guardian the allowance is a fixed share of the initial balance, subtracted from the day's reference. At FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven, Alpha Capital and Fintokei it is the same share of the day's reference itself: The5ers' own example is a $100,000 account at $110,000 of equity at the reset, whose loss allowance for the day becomes $5,500; a FundingPips account starting a day at $94,000 has $3,760, not $4,000. FunderPro says only that its 5% is balance-based at the start of the day; the engine takes the stricter of the two bases there. Version 7 used the initial balance at every firm except Fintokei, and its response said that being flat at the reset made the engine's limit the firm's. Being flat makes balance and equity equal at the reset; it does not change the base. Since version 8 the engine recomputes each firm's allowance at every reset with its own base (acct_mc._dll_at).

With an open position at the reset, an equity-based or higher-of reference rises with the open profit, and a smooth reversal can then break the day's limit with no gap at all. The plan is flat at every reset (6.5), so the reference is the balance. Within the day, every trade's risk plus its cost fits the room left (5.4); after two or three losses the account waits for the next day.

6.3 Minimum trading days: the joint condition

FTMO (4), FundedNext (5), BrightFunded (5), FXIFY Classic (4), FunderPro Classic (4), Alpha (3), Hola Prime (3) and Fintokei (3) require days with at least one trade in each phase; Fintokei also before every payout, and Alpha five before its first. A phase is passed when the target is met *and* the days are complete. Since the 40% concentration policy (6.7) caps every day at 40% of the target, a phase needs at least three winning days, so the three-day minimums are always met; the four- and five-day ones may not be. How a day counts differs: FTMO counts "any day ... during which at least one position is opened", BrightFunded a day on which a trade was open for at least 60 seconds, Fintokei an executed trade "with a real market outcome", Alpha a trade opened and closed on the day.

Filler trades. Where the target is reached with days missing, the plan stops trading the strategy and, on each of the next trading days not yet traded (found on the market's real calendar), opens one minimal position: 0.01 lot (one contract on futures), at the day's first permitted hour, with an emergency stop at the account's breach level, closed at the market after 3 minutes. It is a real trade in the engine: its cost and result enter the balance, it can lose, and the day counts only if the firm's definition is met (at BrightFunded, held 60 seconds). The engine trades to the firm's target

plus $20 per $100K, so a filler's few cents or dollars rarely matter; if a loss takes the balance under the firm's target, ordinary trading resumes. Version 8 counted the missing days on the calendar without trading them (review of version 8, finding 5). The firms' day definitions state no minimum volume; that such a trade is accepted is an assumption of the model, and Chapter 31.8 measures the plan without it.

No fillers at Fintokei and Alpha Capital. Fintokei's all-in article objects to "much smaller trades ... just to meet the minimum 3-day trading requirement", and Alpha does not allow minimal lots to pass trading days on a qualified account. There the plan places no filler trades: a phase never needs one (three winning days), and a funded cycle short of its days (Fintokei's 3 per payout, Alpha's 5 before the first) collects them with ordinary trades of the plan, at most one a day. Fillers are not used where a rule counts *profitable* days (6.4).

6.4 Profitable-day rules

The5ers, Maven, Blue Guardian, GFT (whose days count only with +0.5%) and FundingPips' 95% option require days with at least +0.5% profit in each phase; FundingPips' 95% option, GFT (4), Hola Prime, Maven and, in its stricter reading, Blue Guardian also in each payout cycle. Hola Prime's bi-weekly option needs its three "within a 14-day period": the engine counts the profitable days within the 14 calendar days ending on the request day, so older ones expire (version 8 counted every profitable day since the last payout: review of version 8, finding 9). (Version 7 also applied +0.5% to Fintokei, whose rule counts any trading day.) While such days are missing, the plan trades normally until the day's profit reaches

$$g_{\text{today}} = \max\left(0.55\%\, S,\ \frac{\text{distance left to the target}}{\text{profitable days still needed}}\right)$$

and then stops for the day; every trade is a full fair bracket whose take-profit is capped at what is left of today's target (but never closer than the minimum distance of 4.1). Stopping for the day is a stopping time, so in a cost-free fair game the expected stopped balance is unchanged; that alone does not keep the pass probability unchanged, which by 5.5 is $B/(B + \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}])$ and moves with the mean balance at a pass (a fair game ending at +1 or −1 passes with probability 1/2, one ending at +2 or −1 with 1/3). The pass probability is invariant only where every pass lands exactly on the target and every failure on the floor; under the plan's overshoots it is not, and with costs every extra trade costs c as well (review of version 8, finding 19). The engine measures their effect in every programme's chapter. Under Maven's funded ceiling (profit kept at or below $4,900, 7.4) the plan also keeps room for the days still needed: every win leaves 0.55% of the account below the ceiling for each profitable day still needed after today, and for today as well if the win would leave today short of +0.5%; otherwise it is cut, or the plan waits for tomorrow. Without that reserve an account can reach the ceiling a profitable day short and never be paid (version 8's corrections, n10).

6.5 The daily flat, weekends and news

The plan opens no position from 19:00 UTC and closes every position at the 20:00 UTC open, every weekday. Every daily reset in the plan falls between 20:00 and 00:00 UTC (FTMO and BrightFunded near midnight Prague time, GFT and Blue Guardian at 5 pm New York, Fintokei and Maven at 00:00 UTC), so the account is flat at each of them. This also removes overnight financing, overnight and weekend gaps, and the widened spreads of the daily break. The cost is time: a trade still open at 20:00 is closed between its stop and its target (a fair outcome) and the next one waits until the next day's open. Such a trade is decided at that open, with that day's loss allowance and caps: every daily figure in the engine (loss, profit, profitable and trading days) belongs to the day a trade opens, which under the daily flat is also the day it closes, and a payout requested during a day does not restart that day's caps. A position opens at the first hourly open that has not begun before the decision (Appendix A, n17).

News. Restricted news windows differ by firm (Maven: no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations too; FundingPips: profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after may be deducted; FTMO funded: no new orders within 2 minutes; FundedNext: 40% of news profit counted on funded accounts). A bracket opened earlier can still reach its stop or target inside a window. The plan closes positions before any release that a firm restricts for the account's stage and market (US, euro-area and Japanese releases alike) and opens nothing until the window has passed. The engine has no news calendar, so the headline is a model without news restrictions. Chapter 28 runs a stylised news-hours sensitivity in which every account is flat from 12:00 to 14:00 UTC (and 08:00 to 09:00 on EURUSD) every weekday; it is a scenario, not a bound: those hours do not contain every restricted release, and removing trading hours has no proven one-way effect on cash per month (it changes which trades happen, when days qualify and when payouts fall).

6.6 Review time

Firms take one to three working days to check a passed phase and issue the next account, and about a working day to process a payout. The engine counts both in working days (Monday to Friday) on the path's calendar: one after phase 1, the firm's stated time after phase 2, so a three-day review that starts on a Friday afternoon ends on the next Wednesday afternoon, and a payout requested on a Friday is received on Monday. Version 8 added 24 hours per working day (review of version 8, finding 20).

6.7 The concentration policy

On every account the plan caps the win of every trade at 40% of the current target (the phase target in an evaluation, the payout target on a funded account), and stops for the day once the day's profit reaches 40% of that target. Three consequences follow:

- every phase needs at least three winning days, so no pass rests on one trade or one day. A funded cycle that reaches its target needs three too, but a payout taken on its date before the target can rest on fewer: where a firm requires profitable days per payout, that is a rule of the programme (6.4), not a consequence of the cap;
- FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy (60% of a phase target from one trade idea) can never trigger, and FXIFY's 25% best-day rule is met by its own tighter cap;
- the effective reward-to-risk is capped: in phase 2 of a 5% target on 100K a win is at most $2,000, so at 1.75% risk at most 1.14 : 1. The search (Chapter 9) therefore covers smaller k and the risk per trade.

Chapter 9 measures what the policy costs against the uncapped strategy of version 6, programme by programme.

CHAPTER 7

What a funded account pays

On the funded account the plan trades each *payout cycle* to a profit target X above the starting balance, stops, requests the payout on the first allowed day, and withdraws everything above the start. The balance is back at the start, the static floor is still D below it, and the next cycle begins. If a payout date comes before the target, the plan withdraws whatever profit there is (where the firm's rules allow) and starts a new cycle; the cycle formulas below describe the simpler policy of paying only at the target, and the engine simulates the plan's. The account ends in a breach at the floor under the rule of 5.4 (or, at a few firms, after a fixed number of payouts).

7.1 The withdrawal identity, with its conditions

Take one cycle. Its balance (relative to the start) is a stopped sum of trades, bounded between $-D$ and X plus one win, and each trade has conditional mean minus its own cost, so optional stopping applies to it (2.5). Let cycle i end with balance Z_i after costs K_i, and let $Q_i \ge 0$ be any profit removed from the account without being paid to the trader or counted as a cost (a firm's deduction of profit above a day cap, profit voided by a rolling cap). Then $\mathbb{E}[Z_i] = -\mathbb{E}[K_i] - \mathbb{E}[Q_i]$. The account's total withdrawal is $W = \sum_i Z_i \, \mathbf{1}\{\text{cycle } i \text{ paid}\}$ and it ends with balance X_{end} in its last cycle. Adding the cycles (the number of cycles has finite mean because each fails with a probability bounded away from zero):

THE WITHDRAWAL IDENTITY, GENERAL FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{total funded cost}] - \mathbb{E}[Q].$$

External credits (The5ers' hub credit, refunds) are paid outside the account and are added separately. Under the plan $Q = 0$ in the model: wins are capped at what is left of GFT's daily cap and of Maven's ceiling and 30-day window, and no position is open through a gap, so nothing is deducted or voided. (In practice a take-profit filled a few points better than its price at an exact cap gives up those few points.) Under the terminal rule of 5.4 every account ends at the floor, $X_{\text{end}} = -D$, and the identity becomes $\mathbb{E}[W] = D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$, the form version 6 stated without its conditions. It fails when the account can end elsewhere: a daily-limit breach part-way down, a closure after a fixed number of payouts (Apex), or a floor that moves (Topstep, Apex); for those accounts only the engine's figures are used. The cycle-by-cycle argument is needed because the balance plus withdrawals is not bounded.

7.2 Cycle by cycle

Each cycle is a fresh run of the chain of 5.5 from 0 to its target X_i before the floor, with success chance q_i. Cycles continue until one fails, so cycle j is paid with probability $\prod_{i \le j} q_i$. A win may pass the target (the minimum target distance of 4.1), so a successful cycle pays its balance at success, not exactly X_i: write $m_i = \mathbb{E}[\text{balance at success of cycle } i \mid \text{it succeeds}]$, which the chain gives as $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}]$ of 5.5. With a first cycle (X_1, q_1, m_1) and later ones (X, q, m), in the chain's model of independent cycles that each restart from zero:

FUNDED CASH, CYCLE FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \left(m_1 q_1 + m \, \frac{q_1 \, q}{1 - q} \right) + R \cdot q_1 q^{\,r-1},$$

where the refund R comes with the r-th payout ($r = 1$ at most firms; Blue Guardian 4, Maven 3; FundingPips Flex, FXIFY Classic and BrightFunded without its paid add-on return no fee, and none is assumed at Alpha Pro); a refund in r equal parts with the first r payouts (Hola Prime) contributes $\frac{R}{r} \sum_{j=1}^{r} q_1 q^{\,j-1}$. Version 8 wrote X_1 and X here, the targets, while its chain used the balances at success; at FTMO's chosen setting the difference was $82 per paid cycle (review of version 8, finding 16). The mean cash of an account that is paid exactly n cycles is $\alpha \, (m_1 + (n-1)\, m)$ plus the refund if $n \ge r$; its actual cash is random around that. With *two* special first cycles (GFT: the first two payouts are capped, so the first two cycles have target X_a, chance q_a and mean paid m_a, later ones X_b, q_b, m_b):

TWO SPECIAL FIRST CYCLES (GFT)

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q_a + q_a^2 + \frac{q_a^2 \, q_b}{1 - q_b} = q_a + \frac{q_a^2}{1 - q_b}, \qquad \mathbb{E}[W] = m_a \, (q_a + q_a^2) + m_b \, \frac{q_a^2 \, q_b}{1 - q_b}.$$

(GFT pays at most its cap in each of the first two payouts; a balance above the cap stays in the account, and the chain, which restarts each cycle from zero, leaves that carry-over out.) In the zero-cost idealised model with exact landing, $m = X$, $q = D/(X + D)$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = D/X$ and $\mathbb{E}[W] = D$, which is where the zero-cost example of 1.3 takes q from.

7.3 What the cycle target changes

In the idealised zero-cost model, nothing about the average. With costs, at fixed l and k, the expected number of funded trades grows with X: by 5.3 it is about XD/v per cycle times $(X + D)/X$ expected cycles, i.e. $D(X + D)/v$. So a larger cycle means *more* trades and more cost over the account's life, and more time between payouts; a smaller one means more payout requests and more waiting for payout dates. Version 6 said larger cycles mean fewer trades and less cost; that contradicted this formula and is withdrawn. With caps, daily targets and payout calendars the balance between the two effects is found by search (Chapter 9), and the measured effect of X is shown in each programme's chapter.

7.4 Funded rules and what they change

- **Best-day rules.** If no day may exceed a share β of a payout's profit, each day's take-profit is capped at βX less what the day has made (FXIFY 25%, measured against the account's best day ever; the plan's own 40% everywhere), and a payout is requested only when the rule holds.

- **Maven**: above $5,000 of profit, no "day" (a run of trades without a 24-hour gap) and no trade may exceed 50% of the cycle's profit. Under daily trading a week is one such day, so the plan keeps every Maven account's profit at or below $4,900, $100 under the threshold so that a take-profit filled a few points better than its price cannot bring the rule in, and the rule never applies. At most $10,000 of profit may be closed in any 30 days, the excess voided, so no win is placed that could take any window above it.
- **Profitable days per cycle** (FundingPips 95%: 3; Hola Prime: 3 within 14 days; GFT: 4; Maven: 3; Blue Guardian, stricter reading: 3) and **trading days** (Fintokei: 3 per payout; Alpha: 5 before the first): the daily target of 6.4, or ordinary trades one a day (6.3; no fillers at either).
- **Payout calendars.** The first payout is allowed 14 to 30 days after the first trade on the funded account (FTMO, FundingPips, Fintokei, GFT, Alpha and Maven count from the first trade; the engine does so for every firm), then every 10 to 30 days. Counting from the first trade is not "at most hours" later than counting from funding, as version 8 said: an account issued after Friday's entry cut-off has its first trade on Monday (review of version 8, finding 21). A cycle that reaches its target early waits, flat. Request, processing and receipt are separate times: the cash arrives after the firm's processing time in working days (6.6), and at Fintokei the next request is allowed 14 days after the last payout was successfully *processed*, not after the request (review of version 8, finding 10).
- **Duration rules.** Blue Guardian: "The minimum holding time is 2 minutes"; a shorter trade "may be flagged for tick scalping". The plan opens with only an emergency stop at the breach level and places its bracket 3 minutes after the entry; at that moment it closes at the market if the price is already beyond the stop or the target. Only a breach can then end a trade sooner, and the engine treats a trade under 2 minutes as ending the account. Alpha Capital: an account's average trade must last over 2 minutes, most trades must, and at least half of the gross profit must come from trades over 2 minutes; the engine checks this on the account's own trades at every phase pass and payout request and applies the firm's consequence on failure (the evaluation restarts; a qualified account's profits are removed). BrightFunded: a trading day counts only if a trade on it was open for at least 60 seconds. Version 8 relied on a distance argument and a global count instead (review of version 8, findings 6 and 7).
- **Minimum payouts**: FundingPips 1% of the account, FXIFY $50, Fintokei, GFT, FunderPro, Blue Guardian and Alpha $100, The5ers $150.
- **Payout caps** (GFT: the first two payouts at most 6% or $10,000): the first two cycles aim at the cap.
- **Daily profit caps** (GFT: $3,000 a day at every size): the take-profit is capped at what is left of the day's cap, so nothing is deducted.

Without costs, rules that only cap or delay wins leave the average withdrawal unchanged; with costs, each extra trade costs c. The engine includes all of them.

7.5 The plan's funded account, worked through

FTMO's funded account at the plan's setting: allowance $D = \$10{,}000$ (static), payout target $X = \$30{,}000$, wins capped at $0.4X = \$12{,}000$, split 80%, refund $R = \$607.82$ with the first payout.

One cycle is the chain of 5.5 from 0 to X: $q = 0.2349$, with 18.2 trades per cycle on average.

$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q/(1-q) = 0.3071$; $\mathbb{E}[W] = m\,q/(1-q) = \$9{,}225$, where a paid cycle withdraws its balance at success, on average $m = \$30{,}044.33$ rather than $X = \$30{,}000$ (the minimum-distance overshoot, 7.2).

General identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 775 = \$9{,}225$ (gap -0.00). Under the terminal rule every account ends at the floor, so $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] = -D$ and the static form $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$ holds again; no profit is forfeited under the plan ($Q = 0$).

$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha\,\mathbb{E}[W] + R\,q = 0.8 \times 9{,}225 + 607.82 \times 0.2349 = \$7{,}523$ (chain).

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many (split + refund)	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7651	$0	$0
1	0.1797	$24,643	$24,608
2	0.0422	$48,679	$48,608
3	0.0099	$72,714	$72,608
4	0.0023	$96,750	$96,608

Chain values, in the chain's model of independent cycles that each start from zero. A paid cycle pays its balance at success, on average $30,044 in the first cycle and $30,044 in later ones ($m_1, m$ of 7.2), not exactly the target; the last column, the targets alone, is shown only for comparison (version 8 printed it as the cash). The cash of a funded account is lumpy: many pay nothing, a few pay several cycles.

The engine, on fresh paths, pays $7,892 per funded account (the chain with the daily rules switched off in the engine: $7,327 ± $545).

CHAPTER 8

Time, and value per month

8.1 How long one trade lasts, approximately

For a driftless *arithmetic* Brownian motion with variance σ^2 per hour, $Z_t^2 - \sigma^2 t$ is a martingale, and stopping at $+d_t$ or $-d_s$ gives $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = d_s d_t/\sigma^2$. For the bracket, $d_s = m\sigma$ and $d_t = m\sigma(w+c)/l$:

EXPECTED DURATION OF A BRACKET (HOURS OF OPEN MARKET), APPROXIMATION

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau] \approx m^2\,\frac{w+c}{l}, \qquad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{win}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3}\left(\left(\tfrac{w+c}{l}\right)^2 + 2\,\tfrac{w+c}{l}\right), \qquad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{loss}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3}\left(1 + 2\,\tfrac{w+c}{l}\right).$$

The synthetic price is geometric: its log has drift $-\sigma^2/2$ per hour, and the barriers sit at log distances $-\ln(1-s)$ and $\ln(1+u)$, not s and u. For the plan's brackets (s and u a fraction of a percent to a few percent) the difference is of the order of s and u themselves, a fraction of a percent of the duration. The daily flat also cuts long trades at 20:00 UTC. So these formulas are used only to explain orders of magnitude; every duration reported in Part II is measured by the engine.

8.2 How long a phase lasts

In the idealised model the number of trades is AB/v (5.3) with $v = l(w+c)$, and each lasts about $m^2(w+c)/l$ hours, so the market time is about $(A/l)(B/l)\,m^2$ hours, independent of k. For FTMO phase 1 at $m = 0.75$ and $l = \$1{,}500$: $6.67^2 \times 0.56 \approx 25$ hours of open market. The calendar is set by the rules instead: minimum and profitable days, the concentration policy's three winning days, the daily flat, weekends, reviews and payout dates.

8.3 Value per month: the renewal–reward theorem, and how it is estimated

The plan runs *slots*: one account position at a firm, refilled with a new evaluation as soon as an attempt ends. A slot completes attempts with values V_i and durations T_i. If those pairs were independent and identically distributed, the renewal–reward theorem would give the long-run rate directly:

RENEWAL–REWARD THEOREM

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} V_i}{\sum_{i=1}^{n} T_i} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T]}, \qquad \text{EV per month} = 30.44 \times \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T \text{ in days}]}.$$

They are not quite: a new attempt starts on the weekday and at the hour where the last one ended, on futures at the price level where it ended, and at a few firms it carries a credit (The5ers) or a rolling window (Maven). Resetting the balance does not reset the calendar. What holds instead is a Markov renewal argument: with S_i the state at the start of attempt i (position in the week, price level, carried credit or window), the long-run rate is $\mathbb{E}_\pi[V]/\mathbb{E}_\pi[T]$, the ratio of the means under the stationary distribution π of the start states, provided that chain is ergodic.

Two estimators. The search of Chapter 9 ranks settings by the *random-start attempt ratio* $30.44\sum V_i/\sum T_i$ over attempts that each start a new trader at a random point of a path, at a random hour, with nothing carried over and a random direction rule. Random starts are not distributed as π, and nothing proves the two ratios equal; version 8 described the random-start ratio as the stationary rate with credits and windows carried, which it is not (review of version 8, finding 12). Version 9 therefore measures the long-run rate directly with *continuing slots* (continuing_v9.py): for every final setting, a slot buys an evaluation, trades it to its end, buys the next at once, and so on, for nine years on one path and calendar, carrying everything a real slot carries (the path position and price level, the calendar, The5ers' credits, monthly and activation fees, payouts dated when they arrive, and the plan's 5-hour direction rule); the first year is a warm-up and is discarded, and the rate is the cash dated in years 2 to 9. Twelve slots start on different days of each of 16 new paths (151–166). The continuing rate is Part II's long-run rate and what Part III's choices use; the random-start ratio stays the search's yardstick, and Chapter 11 compares the two for every chosen setting, separating the measurement from the direction rule (cont_check_v9.py).

This is a *long-run rate*: a ratio of expectations, not the expectation of ratios, and the objective each programme's settings are chosen for.

8.4 How precise a simulated figure is

With n independent attempts the ratio estimate $\hat r = \bar V/\bar T$ has, by the delta method, standard error $\mathrm{sd}(V_i - \hat r\,T_i)/(\sqrt{n}\,\bar T)$. Attempts that start at random times on the *same* synthetic path share its history, so they are not fully independent. The final figures therefore use 16 independent paths per programme (1,500 attempts on each) and treat each path as a cluster:

CLUSTER-ROBUST INTERVAL FOR A RATIO

$$\widehat{\mathrm{Var}}(\hat r) = \frac{G}{G-1}\,\frac{\sum_{g=1}^{G}\left(V_g - \hat r\,T_g\right)^2}{\left(\sum_g T_g\right)^2},$$

where V_g, T_g are the totals on path g. With only G clusters the multiplier for a 95% interval is the Student t quantile with $G-1$ degrees of freedom, not 1.96: 2.131 for 16 paths, 2.069 for 24, 2.012 for 48, 3.182 for 4, computed (version 8 took 2.060 for 24 paths from a table's next row). Every "±" for a programme is the larger of that cluster interval and 1.96 attempt-level standard errors; a pass rate gets the same treatment, with V_g the passes and T_g the attempts on path g (version 8 printed a binomial interval over all attempts: review of version 8, finding 14). A continuing slot's rate is the mean of its 16 per-path rates, with the same Student interval.

Sums and differences. Every programme's final and continuing figures come from the same 16 paths, so programmes on one market, and sizes of one programme, are correlated. The interval of a sum of programmes (a portfolio's sum of long-run rates) is therefore computed from the per-path totals of all of them together, which carries their full covariance, $\mathrm{Var}(\sum_j R_j) = \sum_j \mathrm{Var}(R_j) + 2\sum_{j<k} \mathrm{Cov}(R_j, R_k)$, rather than by adding the programmes' widths in quadrature as version 8 did (review of version 8, finding 15). Likewise two settings run on the same paths and random numbers are compared by their paired per-path difference: its interval can be narrow when their separate intervals overlap. The chain checks of Chapter 11 use 48 independent paths per programme for the same reason: with thousands of attempts on one path, the same stretch of price history is traded dozens of times, and an attempt-level interval would be several times too narrow. Portfolio lives each run on their own new path, so they are independent and the ordinary standard error applies. These are Monte Carlo intervals *under the model*: they say how well the model's expectation is estimated, not how much a real year can differ from it, and they carry no allowance for wrong rules, wrong costs or a wrong model.

8.5 A first year is not the long-run rate

A new portfolio pays every fee in its first weeks and receives its first payouts a month or more later; at the end of any finite horizon some accounts are part-way through and hold value not yet paid. So the first year's average cash, the average of later months, and the long-run renewal rate are three different quantities, and nothing requires them to be equal. Chapter 28 reports them separately: the first-year average from 12-month lives, and the average of months 13–36 and the value of the accounts still open at month 12 from 36-month lives. The months 13–36 average is a finite-window estimate: Chapter 28.6 compares its two annual windows with a paired interval before reading it as the long-run rate.

8.6 The plan's attempt, timed

Engine, sixteen fresh paths: an attempt lasts $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.40$ days on average, from the purchase to the failed phase or the closed funded account.

So one slot buys $30.44/19.40 = 1.57$ evaluations a month and pays $1.57 \times \$607.82 = \$953$ a month in fees before refunds.

Value of an attempt: $\mathbb{E}[V] = \$1{,}692$; pass rate 29.1%; cash per funded account $7,892.

Random-start ratio (8.3): $30.44 \times 1{,}692/19.40 = \$2{,}654$ per month, ± $251 (95%, cluster-robust over 16 paths; attempt-level ± $147).

Continuing slot (8.3: one slot run back to back for eight years after a year's warm-up, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths): **$2,724** ± $319 a month, the long-run rate this slot is valued at in Part II.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): an attempt that fails in the evaluation lasts 11.7 days on average; one that passes spends 22.1 days in the evaluation and 15.5 days funded, with 0.58 payouts on average; 40.4 trades per attempt.

CHAPTER 9

Optimising the settings

Four numbers define how the plan trades a programme: the risk per trade L, the reward-to-risk k, the stop m and the funded payout target X; a fifth choice is the market. This chapter explains what each does, how they were searched, and what the search can and cannot claim.

9.1 What each setting does

Setting	Value of an attempt	Time of an attempt	Range searched
Risk L	with the 40% cap on a win, a larger L means a smaller effective reward:risk	market time $\propto 1/L^2$	1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75% of the account (every firm's 2% rule stays out of reach after costs); FTMO at most 1.5%, its own guidance
Reward:risk k	fewer trades, less cost, until the 40% cap binds	little in theory (8.2)	1.5 to 12
Stop m	cost per trade $\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	market time $\propto m^2$	from the leverage floor (Chapter 10) or 0.6, whichever is larger, to 1.25 (0.6: no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations, 4.1)
Payout target X	more funded trades and cost with larger X (7.3)	payout waiting against cycle length	4% to 30% of the account, within each firm's payout rules (Maven: 2–4.9%, so at most $4,900)
Market	cost per unit of movement κ/σ	trading hours	those the firm's leverage and copy rules allow

9.2 The search

1. **Grid.** For every programme and every market it may trade, every combination of L, m (up to four stops from the leverage floor up), $k \in \{1.5, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 12\}$ and five or six payout targets: 10,857 settings, each 2,000 attempts on four paths (101–104): 21.7 million simulated attempts.
2. **Refine.** For each programme and market, the fourteen best grid settings, plus k half-way to its neighbours around the best (or 16 and 1.2 where the best sat at the end of the k grid) and a payout target 5 points larger, at most 30%, where the best sat at the top of its grid (not at Maven, whose grid ends at the plan's $4,900 ceiling), re-run for 16,000 attempts on four *different* paths (111–114), plus FTMO's best grid settings inside its 1.5% ceiling: 399 settings, 6.4 million attempts.
3. **Choose.** The highest refined value per month with a stop of at least 0.6 hourly moves, a payout target of at most 30% of the account and, at FTMO, a risk of at most 1.5% (its own guidance, 10.5).
4. **Report.** The chosen setting is run a third time on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts in all, with the cluster-robust interval of 8.4, and as a continuing slot on sixteen more (151–166, 8.3). A setting's figures from these runs are not inflated by having been picked as the best of many noisy estimates of *that setting*. The inflation is visible: the chosen settings average 5% less on the fresh paths than on the paths that chose them. The continuing figures are then used again, to choose between a firm's programmes, markets and sizes (Part III); the sum of the chosen programmes' rates is therefore not a selection-free estimate, while the portfolio simulations, which run on new paths, are.

What the search establishes. The best setting found in this grid, for these programmes and these markets, under the model. It is not a proof of a global optimum over every possible rule, product, size or market; Part II lists what was searched for each programme and what was left out.

9.3 What the search found

The policy moves the optimum. Under the 40% cap no win can end a phase, so the version 6 corner (k of 20–30, one trade per phase) is gone. The chosen settings use risk 1.50% (5), 1.75% (19), k from 2 to 12, stops from 0.75 to 1.25 and payout targets from 4.9% to 30% of the account.

Risk per trade. With wins capped at 40% of the target, a larger risk mainly makes the account move faster (market time $\propto 1/L^2$, 8.2) at almost the same pass probability, which favours the largest risk the plan allows: 1.75%, set by the firms' 2% rules, and 1.5% at FTMO (10.5). 20 of 24 chosen settings use that ceiling. The others chose a smaller risk because a lower setting measured higher on the refinement paths: The5ers HS Classic on Nasdaq at 1.50% ($2,770 ± $845 in the refinement, against $2,760 ± $638 for the best setting at 1.75%; paired difference on the same four paths and seeds +$10 ± $531); Fintokei ProTrader on Nasdaq at 1.50% ($2,632 ± $1,314 in the refinement, against $2,626 ± $1,084 for the best setting at 1.75%; paired difference on the same four paths and seeds +$6 ± $489); GFT Standard on USDJPY at 1.50% ($2,008 ± $408 in the refinement, against $2,006 ± $265 for the best setting at 1.75%; paired difference on the same four paths and seeds +$2 ± $167); FunderPro Classic on Nasdaq at 1.50% ($2,559 ± $1,062 in the refinement, against $2,472 ± $773 for the best setting at 1.75%; paired difference on the same four paths and seeds +$87 ± $414). The settings of one programme are run on the same paths and random numbers, so the paired difference (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom) is the test of a choice, not whether the separate intervals overlap; a paired interval that includes zero means the refinement cannot tell the two apart.

Payout targets. 7 of 24 chosen settings use the plan's ceiling of 30% of the account (one payout of more than 30% invites review); a larger target means fewer payout dates to wait for and, under the 40% cap, larger wins per trade, against more funded trades (7.3). Firms with payout caps or ceilings (GFT, Maven) are held below them.

9.4 Every programme

Programme, market	Chosen L / k / m / X	Random-start EV/month (95%)	Continuing slot (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Days per attempt	Version 8
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	$2,620 ± $177	$2,863 ± $505	28.3% ± 0.8%	18.6	$2,653
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 15%	$2,071 ± $157	$2,301 ± $337	29.6% ± 0.7%	19.3	$2,231
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 3.5 / 1 / 30%	$2,276 ± $150	$2,312 ± $432	28.8% ± 0.9%	19.5	$2,607
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.5% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$2,654 ± $251	$2,724 ± $319	29.1% ± 0.8%	19.4	$2,512
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$2,149 ± $174	$2,609 ± $420	29.0% ± 0.9%	27.9	$2,097

Programme, market	Chosen L / k / m / X	Random-start EV/month (95%)	Continuing slot (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Days per attempt	Version 8
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$1,885 ± $236	$1,650 ± $551	25.2% ± 1.0%	24.1	$1,909
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 15%	$1,782 ± $138	$1,794 ± $352	30.5% ± 0.8%	27.5	$1,755
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1.25 / 20%	$1,524 ± $195	$1,105 ± $289	27.0% ± 1.1%	25.5	$1,528
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	**1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%**	**$2,723 ± $313**	**$2,678 ± $364**	**28.9% ± 0.7%**	**17.7**	**$2,877**
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.75% / 12 / 1.03 / 20%	$2,317 ± $226	$2,168 ± $419	30.0% ± 0.9%	20.5	$2,207
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	**1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%**	**$1,427 ± $174**	**$1,227 ± $415**	**24.0% ± 0.6%**	**19.4**	**$1,389**
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	**1.5% / 6 / 0.92 / 30%**	**$2,514 ± $294**	**$2,176 ± $361**	**27.9% ± 1.0%**	**18.4**	**$2,919**
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	$2,227 ± $293	$1,907 ± $444	26.2% ± 0.7%	17.7	$2,186
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	**1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 20%**	**$2,382 ± $261**	**$1,979 ± $430**	**26.4% ± 1.1%**	**26.9**	**$2,479**
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 12 / 1 / 20%	$2,017 ± $187	$1,823 ± $451	25.3% ± 0.8%	24.7	$1,866
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 5 / 1.25 / 20%	$1,469 ± $173	$1,693 ± $445	22.9% ± 0.9%	27.8	$1,560
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$1,203 ± $150	$1,315 ± $293	21.3% ± 0.8%	24.2	$1,235
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	**1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%**	**$2,164 ± $115**	**$2,627 ± $293**	**28.5% ± 0.8%**	**22.0**	**$2,197**
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.5% / 12 / 1.25 / 8%	$1,781 ± $116	$1,764 ± $234	27.1% ± 0.9%	23.7	$1,834
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	**1.75% / 7 / 1.03 / 20%**	**$2,385 ± $193**	**$2,450 ± $479**	**29.5% ± 0.7%**	**18.6**	**$2,413**
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	$1,317 ± $142	$1,169 ± $364	23.7% ± 0.8%	18.1	$1,343
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	**1.75% / 2 / 1.25 / 4.9%**	**$1,317 ± $73**	**$1,461 ± $111**	**26.8% ± 0.7%**	**25.2**	**$1,409**
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	**1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20%**	**$2,928 ± $151**	**$3,038 ± $517**	**27.4% ± 0.6%**	**16.9**	**$2,941**
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	$2,903 ± $265	$2,926 ± $575	30.1% ± 0.6%	18.2	$3,099

One 100K account. Random-start: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts each, the ratio of 8.3 used by the search; continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9, Part II's long-run rate (8.3). 95% intervals: the larger of the attempt-level and the cluster-robust interval (Student t, 15 degrees of freedom), for the pass rate too (8.4). L: risk per trade; X: payout target, both as a share of the account. Shaded: in the recommended plan. Version 8: its chosen setting's random-start value under version 8's engine (no lots, the floor clipped after a trade, calendar fillers, Fintokei fillers, calendar-day reviews, Hola Prime's days counted per cycle, Fintokei's clock from the request); not a measure of the same thing.

CHAPTER 10

Position size, leverage and margin

10.1 From risk to lots

The stop distance in price points is $m\sigma \times \text{price}$. If one lot gains or loses V dollars per point (the firm's contract specification), then

LOTS FOR A GIVEN RISK

$$\text{lots} = \frac{l}{m\,\sigma\,\text{price}\,V}, \qquad \text{notional} = \frac{l}{m\sigma}.$$

Lots are rounded *down* to the lot step, so the realised risk is never above l, and never below the smallest volume. Since version 9 the engine trades exactly this (pathfirm.LOTS): index CFDs one index unit a lot ($1 a point; FTMO's MT5 contract size for its index CFDs is 1), gold 100 ounces a lot, currency pairs 100,000 units a lot, CFD volumes from 0.01 lot in steps of 0.01, at each market's level of 2 October 2026 scaled by the path (version 8 traded the exact notional l/s on CFDs, however small: review of version 8, finding 4). Other brokers' contract sizes change only the rounding. A win set by a cap keeps its amount at the rounded volume (its take-profit is placed for that win); an uncapped win $k\,l$ scales with the rounded risk. The smallest position's risk, 0.01 lot at the plan's stop, is about $0.85 on the Nasdaq at $m = 1$, $12 on gold and about $1 on the currency pairs, small next to a normal risk; it matters for the last trade near the floor (5.4) and for filler trades (6.3). Micro Nasdaq futures trade in whole contracts of $2 per point. The synthetic Nasdaq path starts at 100, so at every entry the engine converts its price to the index level, $P_{\text{index}} = 31{,}070 \times P/100$, values one contract's stop at $2\,P_{\text{index}}\,m\sigma$ dollars, and rounds the number of contracts down (never below one). Version 7 used 31,070 at every entry: at a path level of 125 that understated one contract's risk by a fifth. A futures account whose room is below one contract's stop makes its terminal trade with one contract, its stop order at the floor (5.4). Where one contract at the planned stop risks more than the planned l (on a path whose index has risen several-fold), the plan trades one contract if the floor and daily rooms allow it; the first version 8 engine waited instead, and those accounts never traded again (version 8's corrections, n11).

10.2 Leverage and margin, at every entry

A position of notional N needs margin N/λ at leverage 1:λ. The plan keeps margin at most 60% of the *current* balance at every entry (version 6 checked it on the starting balance only):

MARGIN CONDITION AT ENTRY, AND THE SMALLEST STOP AT THE START

$$\frac{l}{m\sigma\lambda} \le 0.6\,(S + x) \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad l \le 0.6\,\lambda\,m\sigma\,(S + x), \qquad m_{\min} = \frac{L/S}{0.6\,\lambda\,\sigma}.$$

The engine applies the first form to every trade, lowering the risk when the balance has fallen; the search starts its stops at $m_{\min}$. Where a firm's leverage differs between evaluation and funded accounts (GFT: 1:20 then 1:10 on indices), the funded leverage sets $m_{\min}$. FunderPro's funded accounts have a rule of their own: at most 20% of the *starting* balance as margin per asset class. At 1:30 on the Nasdaq that needs $m \ge L/(S \times 0.2 \times 30 \times \sigma)$: 1.066 at the plan's 1.75% risk (0.913 at 1.5%; version 7's rule sheet quoted 0.92, the 1.5% figure, next to a 1.75% risk). GFT's funded 1:10 with the plan's 60% cap gives the same 1.066 at 1.75%. Version 6's FunderPro setting ($m = 0.35$) used about 52% and broke the rule.

Programme	Market	Leverage: evaluation / funded	Risk	$m_{\min}$	Plan's m	Notional per 100K	Funded margin / start balance
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1	$639,413	32%
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.25	$511,530	51%
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1	$639,413	32%
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.50%	0.183	1	$548,068	11%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	$597,582	60%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1	$1,466,782	49%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.25	$511,530	51%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1.25	$1,173,426	39%
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.50%	0.183	0.75	$730,758	15%
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	$2,052,760	21%
FundedNext Stellar	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.028	1.03	$598,598	60%
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	1:30 / 1:30 (20% cap)	1.50%	0.913	0.92	$595,726	20%
FunderPro Classic	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100 (20% cap)	1.75%	0.733	1	$1,466,782	15%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1	$1,466,782	15%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	$2,052,760	21%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1.25	$1,173,426	12%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1.25	$1,642,208	16%
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	$597,582	60%
GFT Standard	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:50	1.50%	0.419	1.25	$1,005,793	20%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.028	1.03	$598,598	60%

Programme	Market	Leverage: evaluation / funded	Risk	$m_{\min}$	Plan's m	Notional per 100K	Funded margin / start balance
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	EURUSD	1:50 / 1:50	1.75%	0.684	1	$2,052,760	41%
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1.25	$511,530	26%
The5ers HS	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.75%	0.426	0.75	$852,551	34%
The5ers HS Classic	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.50%	0.365	0.75	$730,758	29%

Leverage as published on 4 October 2026 (optimize_v9.LEV). $m_{\min}$: the smallest stop whose margin fits 60% of the starting balance at both leverages (FunderPro funded: 20%). At every entry the engine also requires margin at most 60% of the current balance, lowering the risk if needed.

10.3 Which market each account trades

- **Nasdaq 100** (US100 CFD, or micro Nasdaq futures): every firm that allows the position and the same trades as your own accounts elsewhere.
- **USDJPY**: FundingPips (leverage), and any firm whose Nasdaq stop the leverage pushes too wide, where the search found it better.
- **Markets of their own** for the firms that forbid copying from other firms' accounts or into funded accounts: FundedNext and Hola Prime each trade a market (EURUSD, gold) that no other account trades.

Inside each group every account takes the same direction (Chapter 28), so no two accounts are ever on opposite sides of one market.

10.4 The ten-minute rule

FundingPips groups positions on one market and direction into one "trade idea" limited to 2% on funded accounts above $25K; Hola Prime treats a position opened within 10 minutes of closing one in the same direction and market, profitable or not, as the same trade idea, whose combined risk may not exceed 2%. The plan waits at least 10 minutes after *every* close before the next entry on that account, at every firm. Version 7 said that an entry at a later hour's open already met this; a close at 12:59 and an entry at 13:00 does not. The engine now knows each exit's minute from the one-minute sub-steps (3.3) and, after an exit later than minute 50, waits one more hour; tests_v9.py measures the shortest time from an exit to the next entry over thousands of consecutive trades (10556 consecutive trades: shortest time from an exit to the next entry 10.0 minutes).

10.5 Risk per trade

Version 6 fixed the risk at 1.5% and argued from time alone. Under the 40% cap a larger risk lowers the effective reward:risk of a capped win, so the risk now matters for value too, and it is searched (1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75%). The upper end is 1.75% because Alpha forbids risking or losing 2% or more on a trade, FundingPips closes a trade idea at 2%, Hola Prime and FunderPro cap funded risk at 2%, and Blue Guardian's shield and GFT's Goat Guard act at a 2% open loss: 1.75% plus cost stays below all of them. FTMO publishes a recommendation of 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade and says larger risk can trigger its risk monitoring; it is not a written rule, but the plan treats it as one and caps FTMO at 1.5%.

Risk per trade	EV per month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.00%	$1,514 ± $401	$1,207	27.7%	24.3
1.25%	$2,135 ± $729	$1,493	29.1%	21.3
1.50%	$2,263 ± $431	$1,413	28.3%	19.0
1.75%	$2,668 ± $562	$1,590	29.0%	18.1
2.00%	$2,600 ± $664	$1,515	28.8%	17.7

FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's k = 8, m = 1, payout target 30K, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per row, same random numbers in every row. 2% is shown for reference only.

CHAPTER 11

Checking the engine against the formulas

The engine and the chain were written separately. The chain leaves out daily limits, minimum and profitable days, filler trades, holding times and duration rules, lot rounding, the per-day part of the concentration policy, payout dates (it pays only at the payout target, while the plan withdraws whatever profit there is on each payout date), the daily flat, weekend closes, the 10-minute gap and Maven's 30-day window; the engine includes them. Both include the terminal rule of 5.4 (the floor as the trade's barrier), the minimum target distance of 4.1 and, at Maven, the same stopping set: a cycle is paid at its target or within $1 of the $4,900 ceiling, and a win too small for the minimum distance is placed with its risk lowered (version 8's chain paid wherever the distance to the ceiling was below the smallest allowed win: review of version 8, finding 17). One effect exists only in the engine and only if positions are held over a weekend: a gap through the floor is absorbed by the firm, a gap through the target is kept. The plan is flat at weekends, so it does not arise; the verification stays flat at weekends too. Agreement where both apply is supporting evidence that each implements its model as described. It is not proof that either is right: two programs can agree because they share a wrong rule input or a wrong assumption. Where they differ, the difference should come from what the chain leaves out, and the third column of 11.2 measures exactly that, by running the engine with those rules switched off.

11.1 Basic checks

Check	Theory	Engine
Win rate of brackets with costs, $1:1, 1:2, 1:3, 1:6$, stop $m = 1$ (60,000 trades each)	49.4% / 33.1% / 24.9% / 14.2%	49.6% / 32.8% / 24.8% / 14.6%
The same at the plan's tightest stop $m = 0.6$	49.0% / 32.9% / 24.8% / 14.2%	49.3% / 32.5% / 24.5% / 14.3%
Average result per trade in units of risk, $1:3$, $m = 1$ (theory $-\rho$)	-0.0234	-0.0210 ± 0.0148
Sub-step convergence: win rate of cost-free brackets at $m = 0.6$, k = 1, 2, 3, 6, with 12 sub-steps per hour	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	49.96% / 33.27% / 24.68% / 14.34%
The same with 60 sub-steps (the plan's paths)	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	50.02% / 33.21% / 24.96% / 14.04%
The same with 240 sub-steps	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	50.22% / 33.31% / 24.96% / 14.37%
Path-generator error bound of 3.3, per trade, every chosen programme's final run	a bound, not 0	≤ 1e-10 per trade
Trades that may have closed within 2 minutes, every chosen programme (theory: the exact chance for a bracket with both levels at 0.6 hourly sd, driftless Brownian motion)	0.10–0.11% (at 0.6 sd)	0.002% of trades < 2 min
Rule tests of the engine (tests_v9.py: daily-loss bases; every failure a breach at the floor barrier; the review's near-floor futures witness; minimal-lot trades with $0.50 left; whole lots; the generator's error bound against the exact two-barrier law; filler trades as real positions; no fillers at Fintokei and Alpha; Blue Guardian's hold; BrightFunded's 60-second day; Alpha's duration rule; Hola Prime's 14-day window; Fintokei's clock from the processed payout; working days; budget lives' dated cash; copies only from open positions; the 10-minute gap; target distance; payout clocks; Maven's ceiling and 30-day cap by close date; futures at the path's price; streams; every day's loss and profit against the firm's allowance and the day caps; FXIFY's best day at every payout; no stalled account; Student quantiles)	all pass	27 of 27 pass
FTMO phase 1, no costs, no daily rules, $k = 3$: pass rate (chain, with the plan's floor rule)	49.92%	50.08% ± 0.97%
FTMO funded account, no costs, no daily rules: average withdrawn before the split (chain)	$10,000	$9,870 ± $495

Check	Theory	Engine
Half a 200K attempt minus the matching 100K attempt, same seeds, 1,500 pairs, with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee (FTMO, Fintokei, The5ers, GFT)	0 up to rounding where every rule scales	fee doubled: FTMO −$242 ± $422, The5ers −$137 ± $436, Fintokei −$362 ± $469, GFT +$353 ± $421
Maven's funded cycle on the chain's rules: paid per successful cycle; first cycle's success rate	$4,900.00; 59.1%	$4,900.00 ± $0.00; 58.9% ± 0.7%
Continuing slot (momentum rule, paths 151–166) against the final random-start ratio (coin flip, paths 121–136), every chosen setting: within 1.96 combined standard errors; sums	–	22 of 26 (largest +3.1, GFT on Nasdaq); $50,929 against $51,035
The measurement alone: continuing slot minus random start, same paths (151–166) and momentum rule, paired by path, every chosen setting: within the 95% interval	equal	26 of 26 (largest +2.0 s.e.)
The direction rule alone: momentum minus coin flip, random start on paths 151–166, paired by path, every chosen setting: within the 95% interval	equal	26 of 26 (largest -2.1 s.e.)
Accounting identity of 5.5, largest gap over every chosen programme's phases and cycles	0	$0.0000
FTMO with the plan's direction rule against a coin flip	equal	per trade +0.0026 / +0.0057 R (±0.014)

Sub-step convergence. At the tightest stop the plan allows (0.6 hourly standard deviations), cost-free brackets on six independent two-year paths per cell (120,000 each) win at rates that differ from $1/(1+k)$ by k = 1: -0.04 ± 0.43 points at 12, +0.02 ± 0.28 points at 60, +0.22 ± 0.48 points at 240; k = 2: -0.06 ± 0.76 points at 12, -0.13 ± 0.41 points at 60, -0.02 ± 0.35 points at 240; k = 3: -0.32 ± 0.66 points at 12, -0.04 ± 0.75 points at 60, -0.04 ± 0.36 points at 240; k = 6: +0.05 ± 0.28 points at 12, -0.25 ± 0.64 points at 60, +0.08 ± 0.49 points at 240 sub-steps per hour (the larger of the binomial and the cluster interval). Every cell lies inside its interval. These intervals say how far each estimate can be from the truth under the model; they are not a bound on the generator's error, which is the bound of 3.3 below. Version 7's claim of a quarter-point bound did not follow from its own cells and is withdrawn.

The scaling test, twice. *Rules:* with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee, half a 200K attempt against the matching 100K attempt, path by path on the same seeds (1,500 pairs each): FTMO −$242 ± $422 per attempt (345 of 1,500 pairs differ by more than a cent); The5ers −$137 ± $436 per attempt (966 of 1,500 pairs differ by more than a cent); Fintokei −$362 ± $469 per attempt (383 of 1,500 pairs differ by more than a cent); GFT +$353 ± $421 per attempt (508 of 1,500 pairs differ by more than a cent). Since version 9 the two are equal only up to rounding: volumes are whole 0.01-lot steps (two 100K positions rounded separately are not one 200K position rounded once), and a filler trade is 0.01 lot at either size; a rounding difference changes a trade's result by cents and can move an attempt's path from there on, so individual pairs can differ by a whole outcome while the means agree. The5ers also has a rule that does not scale: its $150 minimum payout is a flat amount. Fintokei also has a rule that does not scale: its $100 minimum payout is a flat amount. GFT also has a rule that does not scale: its $3,000 day cap and $10,000 payout cap are flat amounts. *Contracts:* with the firms' real 200K fees, FTMO $1,118 per 100K at 200K against $1,360 at 100K (fee $1,215.65 against 2 × $607.82); Fintokei $1,299 per 100K at 200K against $1,727 at 100K (fee $1,249.00 against 2 × $549.00); GFT $1,723 per 100K at 200K against $1,341 at 100K (fee $974.00 against 2 × $524.00) (The5ers sells no 200K account of this programme, so its 200K row checks the rules only.) The fee difference is the whole of the gap where the rules scale; 27.2 values it.

The direction rule. Per trade (cost-free 1 : 3 brackets on the Nasdaq, 60,000 each), the plan's momentum rule averages +0.0026 ± 0.0142 R and a coin flip +0.0057 ± 0.0144 R. Per month (FTMO, 48,000 attempts each on paths 141–144) the momentum rule gives $2,320 ± $1,658 and the coin flip $2,304 ± $469. The momentum rule's interval is wider because attempts that overlap on one path take the same direction at the same time, so they are correlated. Under the model no rule that uses only past prices can have an edge (2.3); the plan uses the momentum rule only so that all of one person's accounts take the same side.

Continuing slots against random starts. The continuing rate and the final run's random-start ratio differ in three ways at once: the measurement (start states, credits, price levels and calendar carried from attempt to attempt), the direction rule (the plan's momentum rule against a coin flip) and the paths (151–166 against 121–136). cont_check_v9.py separates them: on the continuing stage's own paths it runs 1,500 random-start attempts per path for every chosen setting, once with each direction rule. *The measurement alone* (continuing slot minus random start, same paths, same momentum rule, paired by path): within its 95% interval for 26 of 26 settings, largest +2.0 standard errors; summed over the settings, path by path, +$2,370 ± $4,977 a month. *The direction rule alone* (momentum minus coin flip, random start, same paths, paired): within its interval for 26 of 26, largest -2.1 standard errors; summed, −$604 ± $3,881. Under the model the momentum rule cannot change the expectation (2.3); it does make attempts that overlap on one path take the same side at the same time, so its per-path figures scatter more, by a median factor of 2.3 here. That scatter, not the measurement, is the largest gap between the continuing rate and the final run's figure: GFT on Nasdaq, continuing $2,627 ± $293 and final random start $2,164 ± $115; on the continuing paths the random-start ratio is $2,570 ± $428 with the momentum rule and $2,240 ± $117 with a coin flip. So the random-start ratio, measured with a coin flip, estimates a slot's long-run rate with less noise than the continuing slot; Part II reports both, and the continuing rate, which runs the plan exactly as written, is the figure Part III uses.

11.2 Every chosen programme: chain against engine

Programme	P: chain	P: engine, chain's rules	P: engine, all rules	Funded cash: chain	engine, chain's rules	engine, all rules
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.289	0.295 ± 0.008	0.291	$7,523	$7,327 ± $545	$7,892
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	0.258	0.257 ± 0.007	0.253	$8,079	$7,558 ± $419	$8,431
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	0.218	0.216 ± 0.008	0.213	$7,426	$6,945 ± $634	$6,826
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	0.271	0.266 ± 0.007	0.264	$9,920	$9,318 ± $536	$9,853
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	0.238	0.247 ± 0.009	0.229	$9,016	$9,337 ± $575	$8,046
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	0.240	0.240 ± 0.007	0.240	$6,231	$6,235 ± $362	$6,093
FundedNext Stellar, gold	0.295	0.299 ± 0.006	0.300	$7,118	$6,646 ± $373	$7,029
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	0.269	0.273 ± 0.006	0.274	$7,207	$7,100 ± $427	$7,554
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	0.305	0.309 ± 0.007	0.301	$7,279	$7,069 ± $557	$7,385
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	0.292	0.296 ± 0.007	0.290	$8,632	$8,875 ± $413	$8,691
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	0.260	0.259 ± 0.006	0.252	$7,950	$7,399 ± $462	$8,096
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	0.299	0.302 ± 0.008	0.305	$7,055	$6,904 ± $369	$7,073
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	0.274	0.271 ± 0.006	0.270	$6,511	$6,717 ± $371	$6,751
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	0.288	0.290 ± 0.008	0.289	$7,317	$7,040 ± $498	$7,371
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	0.295	0.296 ± 0.007	0.295	$7,011	$6,987 ± $402	$6,974
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	0.240	0.237 ± 0.006	0.237	$6,142	$5,926 ± $410	$5,843
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	0.289	0.288 ± 0.007	0.283	$7,310	$7,174 ± $360	$7,394
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	0.292	0.295 ± 0.007	0.285	$7,210	$7,324 ± $245	$7,326
GFT Standard, USDJPY	0.275	0.277 ± 0.008	0.271	$6,713	$6,741 ± $235	$7,066
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	0.286	0.291 ± 0.008	0.279	$7,251	$6,834 ± $594	$7,390
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	0.260	0.259 ± 0.008	0.262	$6,957	$6,543 ± $287	$7,020
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	0.289	0.287 ± 0.007	0.288	$6,850	$6,978 ± $485	$7,013
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.298	0.298 ± 0.007	0.296	$6,324	$6,174 ± $309	$6,407
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.276	0.279 ± 0.006	0.268	$5,746	$5,857 ± $205	$5,711

Chain: analytic_v9.py. Engine with the chain's rules: the same engine with the daily loss limit, minimum and profitable days and the daily flat switched off, the concentration caps applied per trade, and payouts only at the payout target; it stays flat at weekends, because a position held through a weekend gaps and a gap is not in the chain, and it pays no overnight financing, which the chain does not have and the plan, flat every evening, never pays (n20). 48 independent two-year paths × 500 attempts, intervals cluster-robust over paths (Student t, 47 degrees of freedom). Engine with all rules: the final run. The middle columns test the implementation; the gap between them and the last columns is what the daily rules do.

Implementation. With the chain's rules, the engine's pass rate is within its 95% interval of the chain's in 24 of 24 programmes and its funded cash in 19 of 24; the largest standardised differences are +1.0 and -1.4 intervals. Remaining differences come from Monte Carlo noise and from what the engine still does that the chain does not: it closes positions at the Friday close (a fair outcome between stop and target, which the binary chain does not have, but the position reopened on Monday pays its cost again, which lowers the engine's figures a little) and rounds every position to whole lots, and the chain is solved on a grid; those two go both ways. These runs hold positions overnight (the daily flat is off) and so run without overnight financing: version 9's first run charged it, which neither the chain nor the plan pays, and that put the engine below the chain in 17 of 24 programmes (n20). Programmes on one market share their paths, so their differences move together rather than independently; rerun on 192 fresh paths, FunderPro's first funded cycle on USDJPY succeeds in 0.294 ± 0.006 of accounts against the chain's 0.298 (0.297 with the engine's own cost, which includes the trades reopened after Friday closes).

What the daily rules do. Switching the daily rules back on changes the value of an attempt by −$462 to +$193 across programmes. These are the effects the formulas of Part I do not contain; every reported figure comes from the engine with every rule on.

PART II

Every programme in the plan

One chapter per firm, for the programme and market the plan uses there: the rules as published; exactly what the engine simulates; the search; the chosen setting and its alternatives on fresh paths; one trade in dollars and points; the evaluation and the funded account from the exact chain; value per attempt and per month; sizes and number of accounts; higher costs; and how the plan meets the rules.

FTMO 2-Step Challenge

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 8$, $m = 1$, payout target 30% of the account; **$2,724 a month per 100K** (± $319, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 4 × 100K, $10,897 a month.

12.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€540 for 100K ($607.82 at 1.1256), €1,080 for 200K ($1,215.65); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5% of the initial balance
Maximum daily loss	5% of the initial balance, measured from the balance at 00:00 CE(S)T
Maximum loss	10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase (a day with at least one position opened)
Funded split and payouts	80% (90% after scaling); first reward on the 14th day after the first trade on the account, then every 14 days; $20 minimum by bank transfer
Consistency rule	none on the 2-Step (the 1-Step has a 50% best-day rule)
Leverage	1:50 on indices (Normal account)
News and weekends	funded Standard account: no new orders 2 minutes around restricted news; no weekend holding
Per person	$400,000 per trader or strategy across all accounts, evaluations included; the same strategy may run on several accounts within the cap
Prohibited	gambling (no plan, all-in), account rolling, opposite positions across accounts or providers, gap trading (opening within 2 hours of a market close to profit from the gap), latency arbitrage
Risk guidance	FTMO recommends risking 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade; larger risk can trigger risk monitoring (a recommendation, not a written rule)
Trading days	4 per phase; a trading day is 'any day … during which at least one position is opened' (FTMO trading objectives); no minimum volume stated

12.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$607.82
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; $607.82 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

12.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 30 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	8	0.75	30%	$2,506 ± $804	26.8%	16.4
1.75%	6	1	15%	$2,449 ± $631	28.8%	18.8
1.75%	7	0.75	20%	$2,371 ± $909	27.0%	16.8
1.75%	8	0.75	15%	$2,333 ± $627	26.7%	17.4
1.75%	6	1	30%	$2,333 ± $802	28.5%	17.8
1.75%	12	0.75	15%	$2,317 ± $756	26.5%	17.4
1.50%	**8**	**1**	**30%**	**$2,308 ± $1,174**	**27.8%**	**18.8**
1.50%	12	0.75	20%	$2,274 ± $847	27.2%	17.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$57 ± $499 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.69	1.92	1.90	2.05	1.53	1.76
2	1.85	1.77	2.10	1.91	2.12	2.15
3	1.77	2.31	2.00	2.55	2.42	2.01
4	1.80	2.09	2.39	2.28	2.50	2.37
6	1.88	1.85	2.14	2.12	2.49	2.42
8	1.86	2.12	2.03	2.18	2.67	2.37
12	2.07	2.08	2.13	1.84	2.42	2.53

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,500 and stop m = 1, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

12.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attem
Plan	**1.5% / 8 / 1 / 30%**	**$2,724 ± $319**	**$2,654 ± $251**	**29.1% ± 0.8%**	**$7,892**	**19.4**	**+$1,69**

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,512 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

12.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$548{,}068$; $17.64 **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 17.640 lots, rounded down to **17.63 lots**, a risk of $1,499.17 at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$35.08$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$4{,}000$; take-profit 228.7 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.2710$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 6{,}052{,}615$; duration about 2.69 h of open market (losers 2.13 h, winners 4.2 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $12,000 at risk $1,500: take-profit 682 points away, $p = 0.1108$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: $10,961 = 11.0% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

12.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4680$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.83$, $K = \$597$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4697$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6170$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.39$, $K = \$623$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6243$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4680 \times 0.6170 = 0.2888$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2914 ± 0.0079** (cluster-robust).

12.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$12{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2349$; expected paid cycles 0.3071; expected withdrawn before the split $\$9{,}225$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$30{,}044.33$ in the first cycle and $m = \$30{,}044.33$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 775 = \$9{,}225$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}523$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$143$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,892** per funded account; 11.4% of attempts reach a payout; median 35 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7651	$0	$0
1	0.1797	$24,643	$24,608
2	0.0422	$48,679	$48,608
3	0.0099	$72,714	$72,608
4	0.0023	$96,750	$96,608

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

12.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2888 \times 7{,}523 - 607.82 = \$1{,}564$; engine $\$1{,}692$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.40$ days per attempt, so 1.57 attempts a month per slot and $\$953$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.7 days on average; a passed one 22.1 days, then 15.5 days funded with 0.58 payouts; 40.4 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}692/19.40 = \$2{,}654$ ± $251 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,724** ± $319 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

12.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	FTMO 2-Step	1.5% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$607.82	$608	$2,724 ± $319	$2,724
200K	FTMO 2-Step	1.5% / 8 / 1 / 30% (the 100K setting scaled)	$1,215.65	$608	$5,482 ± $651	$2,741

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included. **Copying:** your own accounts, within the cap. **The plan:** 4 × 100K, worth $10,897 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 4 × 100K, worth $10,897 a month (4 accounts).

12.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,263 ± $431	+$1,413	19.0	28.3%
× 1.5	$2,015 ± $519	+$1,211	18.3	26.5%
× 2	$1,778 ± $350	+$1,022	17.5	24.6%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

12.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq 100 CFD, one position per account, shared direction with every other Nasdaq account
- 1.5% risk (inside FTMO's stated 1–1.5% guidance) with the stop attached at entry
- minimum days filled with one minimal trade per day after the target, where needed
- every account traded the same way; none abandoned or sacrificed (no account rolling)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days

- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: ftmo.com/en/faq/how-do-i-withdraw-my-profits/ (first reward 14 days after the first trade); ftmo.com/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/ ($400,000 per trader); https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trade/; ftmo.com (trading objectives, forbidden practices); https://ftmo.com/en/trading-objectives/.

FundingPips 2-Step Flex

USDJPY; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 20% of the account; **$1,979 a month per 100K** (± $430, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 4 × 100K, $7,914 a month.

13.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$499 for 100K (largest size); no registration-fee refund on Flex
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 8%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the higher of the day's opening balance and equity (relative: $3,760 on a day that opens at $94,000), reset at platform midnight (UTC+3) / 12% static
Minimum days	80% option: 1 trading day per phase (accounts from 26 August 2026); 95% option: 3 profitable days (at least +0.5%) per phase
Funded split and payouts	chosen at purchase and locked: 80% with 1 minimum trading day, or 95% with 3 profitable days (+0.5% of the starting size) in every reward cycle; every 14 days from the first executed trade on the Master account; minimum reward 1% of the account
Risk per trade idea	at most 2% above $25K; a trade idea is all positions on one market in one direction, including one opened within 10 minutes of closing a loss; a breach closes the account
Profit Concentration Policy	evaluations from 27 June 2026, $25K and up: if one trade idea makes more than 60% of a phase target, the funded account needs 4 profitable days (+0.5%) before every reward request, permanently
Leverage	1:100 on forex; indices and metals on dynamic leverage falling to 1:5 above 0.5 lots
Weekends and news	overnight and weekend holding allowed on evaluations; on Master accounts only with the Swing add-on; profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after restricted news may be deducted
Per person	$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts
Copying	only between your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services
Risk per trade idea (Master)	accounts above $25K: a trade idea (related positions, realised and floating) may not lose 2%; immediate closure

13.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$499
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $12,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $8,000; maximum loss $12,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200)
Funded account	maximum loss $12,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 95%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $1,000; 3 profitable days of $500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

13.3 The search

Searched: 1008 grid settings (EURUSD, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on USDJPY:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**6**	**1.25**	**20%**	**$2,694 ± $896**	**27.9%**	**27.8**
1.75%	12	1.25	30%	$2,690 ± $493	27.7%	27.4
1.75%	8	1	20%	$2,669 ± $217	25.7%	25.4
1.75%	8	1.25	30%	$2,666 ± $729	27.6%	27.4
1.75%	8	1.25	20%	$2,653 ± $771	27.6%	27.7
1.75%	12	1	20%	$2,626 ± $240	26.5%	25.4
1.75%	5	1.25	15%	$2,610 ± $443	28.2%	28.1
1.75%	3	1.25	15%	$2,593 ± $487	27.7%	28.0

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$4 ± $437 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.76	1.76	1.82	1.62	1.34	1.83
2	1.65	1.74	2.04	1.78	1.97	1.87
3	1.55	2.19	2.08	2.53	1.96	2.44
4	1.67	2.18	1.94	2.47	2.46	2.01
6	1.79	2.13	2.27	2.75	2.57	2.39
8	1.73	1.65	2.47	2.22	2.64	2.53
12	1.86	2.00	2.46	2.35	2.28	2.65

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.4–1.1K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.25, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

13.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of
Plan	**1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 20%**	**$1,979 ± $430**	**$2,382 ± $261**	**26.4% ± 1.1%**	**$9,853**	**26.9**	
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 12 / 1 / 20%	$1,823 ± $451	$2,017 ± $187	25.3% ± 0.8%	$8,431	24.7	
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$1,315 ± $293	$1,203 ± $150	21.3% ± 0.8%	$6,826	24.2	
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 5 / 1.25 / 20%	$1,693 ± $445	$1,469 ± $173	22.9% ± 0.9%	$8,046	27.8	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,479 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

13.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.1193\% = 0.1491\%$ of the price; at 157.83 that is **23.5 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1{,}173{,}426$; $\$74.35$ **per pip**; at $6.34 per pip per lot, 11.734 lots, rounded down to **11.73 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.37$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$59.84$, $\rho = c/l = 3.42\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}333$; take-profit 45.6 pips away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3403$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 5{,}938{,}062$; duration about 3.03 h of open market (losers 2.54 h, winners 4.0 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$8{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 108 pips away, $p = 0.1784$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: $\$11{,}734$ = 11.7% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.244$.

13.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000, B = \$12{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4973$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.15$, $K = \$1{,}036$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$12{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4983$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5455$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$8{,}000, B = \$12{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5443$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.46$, $K = \$1{,}056$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$12{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5472$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4973 \times 0.5443 = 0.2707$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2643 ± 0.0110** (cluster-robust).

13.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$12{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20{,}000$; split 95%; per-trade cap $\$8{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3428$; expected paid cycles 0.5216; expected withdrawn before the split $\$10{,}442$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$20{,}018.65$ in the first cycle and $m = \$20{,}018.65$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 12{,}000 - 1{,}558 = \$10{,}442$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$9{,}920$ per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **$9,853** per funded account; 12.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 41 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6572	$0	$0
1	0.2253	$19,018	$19,000
2	0.0772	$38,035	$38,000
3	0.0265	$57,053	$57,000
4	0.0091	$76,071	$76,000

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

13.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2707 \times 9{,}920 - 499.00 = \$2{,}186$; engine $\$2{,}105$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 26.91$ days per attempt, so 1.13 attempts a month per slot and $\$564$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 18.5 days on average; a passed one 27.9 days, then 22.9 days funded with 0.86 payouts; 42.8 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 2{,}105/26.91 = \$2{,}382$ ± $261 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$1,979** ± $430 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

13.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 20%	$499	$499	$1,979 ± $430	$1,979

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts. **Copying:** your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services. **The plan:** 4 × 100K, worth $7,914 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 4 × 100K, worth $7,914 a month (4 accounts).

13.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,521 ± $393	+$2,288	27.6	28.2%
× 1.5	$2,239 ± $344	+$1,910	26.0	24.7%
× 2	$1,970 ± $538	+$1,623	25.1	22.8%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

13.11 How the plan meets the rules

- USDJPY or EURUSD at 1:100 (the Nasdaq would need 1:7 and FundingPips gives 1:5 at that size)
- risk at most 1.75% plus cost, below the 2% trade-idea limit; at least 10 minutes after any close before the next trade
- the 40% concentration policy keeps every trade idea under the Profit Concentration Policy's 60%
- 4 × 100K Flex (the largest Flex size) fills the $400,000 cap
- own entry on each account; no copier service

- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/48174287980177-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy).

The5ers High Stakes

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 20% of the account; **$3,038 a month per 100K** (± $517, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 100K, $3,038 a month.

14.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	New (10% / 5%): $491 for 100K; Classic (8% / 5%): $545; smaller sizes $19–$278
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	New 10% / 5%; Classic 8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance or equity, the higher (relative: the firm's example is $5,500 at $110,000), reset 00:00 server time / 10% of the initial balance, static
Profitable days	3 per phase (at least +0.5%); may not be manufactured
Funded split and payouts	80% rising with scaling; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; $150 minimum
Fee return	10% of the fee as hub credit (not cash) after phase 1, 20% after phase 2, 70% added to the funded account and paid with the first payout (at least $150, 14 days after funding); the model keeps the credit apart from cash and spends it on the next The5ers evaluation
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:25 metals and indices
News	no new orders from 2 minutes before to 2 minutes after high-impact news
Per person	Classic: one 2.5K, one 5K, one 10K or 25K, one 50K or 100K; New: three each of 2.5K, 5K and 10K, one 25K, one 50K or 100K; the 50K/100K account is one across both programmes
Copying	allowed across your own accounts
Prohibited	one-trade target attainment (permanent ban)

14.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$491
Fee credit	non-cash credit of $49.10 and $98.20 on passing phase 1 and phase 2, spent on the next evaluation
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; $343.70 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $150; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:25 (evaluation), 1:25 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

14.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**12**	**0.75**	**20%**	**$2,710 ± $915**	**27.5%**	**16.7**
1.75%	8	0.75	30%	$2,682 ± $1,121	27.4%	16.3
1.75%	4	1	30%	$2,645 ± $808	28.3%	17.6
1.75%	8	1	20%	$2,639 ± $580	29.0%	18.2
1.75%	3	1	30%	$2,568 ± $643	28.6%	17.5
1.75%	6	0.75	30%	$2,563 ± $1,305	27.1%	16.0
1.75%	5	0.75	30%	$2,550 ± $1,086	27.1%	16.0
1.75%	3	0.75	20%	$2,546 ± $702	27.2%	16.4

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$28 ± $267 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.91	2.26	2.30	2.14	2.26	1.95
2	2.08	2.14	2.31	2.37	1.87	2.03
3	2.14	2.66	2.60	2.70	3.04	2.84
4	1.87	2.51	2.54	2.60	2.48	2.90
6	1.83	2.34	2.50	2.77	2.54	3.32
8	2.07	2.35	2.49	2.68	2.64	3.00
12	2.10	2.39	2.37	2.69	2.91	2.84

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 0.75, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

14.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20%**	**$3,038 ± $517**	**$2,928 ± $151**	**27.4% ± 0.6%**	**$7,554**	**16.9**	-
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	$2,926 ± $575	$2,903 ± $265	30.1% ± 0.6%	$7,385	18.2	-

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,941 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

14.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$852{,}551$; $\$27.44$ **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 27.440 lots, rounded down to **27.43 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.38$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$54.56$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}333$; take-profit 123.5 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3406$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 5{,}928{,}819$; duration about 1.09 h of open market (losers 0.91 h, winners 1.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$8{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 294 points away, $p = 0.1785$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:25: $\$34{,}102$ = 34.1% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.426$.

14.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4575$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.37$, $K = \$793$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4604$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5886$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.63$, $K = \$872$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6086$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4575 \times 0.5886 = 0.2693$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2735 ± 0.0056** (cluster-robust).

14.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$8{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3068$; expected paid cycles 0.4425; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}877$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$20{,}061.22$ in the first cycle and $m = \$20{,}061.22$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}123 = \$8{,}877$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}207$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$105$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,554** per funded account; 9.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6932	$0	$0
1	0.2127	$16,393	$16,344
2	0.0652	$32,442	$32,344
3	0.0200	$48,491	$48,344
4	0.0061	$64,540	$64,344

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

14.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2693 \times 7{,}207 + 49 - 491.00 = \$1{,}499$; engine $\$1{,}624$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.88$ days per attempt, so 1.80 attempts a month per slot and $\$885$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.6 days on average; a passed one 19.7 days, then 14.1 days funded with 0.56 payouts; 31.6 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}624/16.88 = \$2{,}928$ ± $151 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$3,038** ± $517 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

14.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	The5ers HS	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20%	$491	$491	$3,038 ± $517	$3,038
25K	The5ers HS 25K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20% (New's own setting scaled)	$176	$704	$675 ± $95	$2,701
10K	The5ers HS 10K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20% (New's own setting scaled)	$69	$690	$280 ± $43	$2,799
5K	The5ers HS 5K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20% (New's own setting scaled)	$35	$700	$145 ± $22	$2,895
2.5K	The5ers HS 2.5K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 20% (New's own setting scaled)	$19	$760	$69 ± $15	$2,774

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: one 50K or 100K account across Classic and New together; New also 3 × 2.5K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 10K and 1 × 25K (Classic's own small slots not used: fees not readable). **Copying:** your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 100K, worth $3,038 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 100K; 1 × 25K; 3 × 10K; 3 × 5K; 3 × 2.5K, worth $5,195 a month (11 accounts).

14.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,750 ± $547	+$1,517	16.8	26.6%
× 1.5	$2,136 ± $531	+$1,101	15.7	23.8%
× 2	$1,945 ± $579	+$977	15.3	22.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

14.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction
- daily profit target while profitable days are missing
- one 100K account; optionally New's small accounts (3 × 2.5K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 10K, 1 × 25K), each on New's own contract and fee

- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: the5ers.com/faqs/what-is-the-drawdown-rule-for-high-stakes/; the5ers.com/faqs/how-many-high-stakes-accounts-can-i-have/; the5ers.com/high-stakes/.

FXIFY Two Phase Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 3$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 15% of the account; **$2,609 a month per 100K** (± $420, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 100K; 1 × 50K; 1 × 25K; 1 × 10K; 1 × 5K, $4,661 a month.

15.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$549 for 100K (largest Classic size); no refund on Classic (the refund belongs to Two Phase Standard)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	5% / 10%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the previous day's balance at 5 pm EST (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days, or 100% every 30 days (chosen at purchase); minimum payout $50
Consistency rule (funded)	no day may exceed 25% of the profit of a payout; the benchmark is the account's best day ever and does not reset
Leverage	1:10 on indices; 1:30 forex and metals (1:50 with an add-on)
Per person	one active account of each size, challenge and funded alike (5K, 10K, 15K, 25K, 50K, 100K, 200K, 400K; $805,000 in all, rule of 25 November 2024); Classic goes up to 100K; Classic prices 5K $59, 10K $89, 25K $199, 50K $379, 100K $549
Copying	between your own FXIFY accounts allowed; into FXIFY from external accounts only with approval (30-day statement); third-party copying prohibited
Prohibited	gambling and all-or-nothing ('YOLO') trading

15.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$549
Phase 1	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Phase 2	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 100%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after the first funded trade, then every 30 days; minimum payout $50; best day at most 25% of a payout's profit, measured against the account's best day ever; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

15.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**3**	**1.07**	**15%**	**$2,062 ± $437**	**29.2%**	**27.7**
1.75%	12	1.07	15%	$2,059 ± $481	28.4%	28.2
1.75%	12	1.07	20%	$2,024 ± $598	28.1%	26.8
1.75%	16	1.07	20%	$2,024 ± $600	28.2%	26.8
1.75%	4	1.07	30%	$2,011 ± $889	28.6%	25.4
1.75%	2	1.25	15%	$2,007 ± $379	29.2%	29.4
1.75%	6	1.07	30%	$2,001 ± $487	29.0%	25.7
1.75%	3	1.25	15%	$1,963 ± $351	28.7%	28.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$3 ± $126 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.25	1.71	1.70	1.85	1.95	1.85
2	1.55	1.56	1.91	1.60	1.92	2.09

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
3	1.54	1.93	1.87	2.31	1.94	1.71
4	1.46	1.89	1.70	2.09	1.66	2.18
6	1.53	1.65	1.62	2.02	1.96	2.18
8	1.45	1.91	1.93	2.15	2.12	2.13
12	1.39	1.83	2.00	2.27	2.51	1.88

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.2–0.9K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.07, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

15.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an a
Plan	**1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%**	**$2,609 ± $420**	**$2,149 ± $174**	**29.0% ± 0.9%**	**$8,691**	**27.9**	**+**
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	$1,650 ± $551	$1,885 ± $236	25.2% ± 1.0%	$8,096	24.1	+
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 15%	$1,794 ± $352	$1,782 ± $138	30.5% ± 0.8%	$7,073	27.5	+
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1.25 / 20%	$1,105 ± $289	$1,524 ± $195	27.0% ± 1.1%	$6,751	25.5	+

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,097 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

15.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$597{,}582$; $\$19.23$ **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 19.233 lots, rounded down to **19.23 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.69$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$2{,}000$; take-profit 106.0 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.4620$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 3{,}566{,}929$; duration about 1.33 h of open market (losers 1.27 h, winners 1.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$3{,}750$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 197 points away, $p = 0.3160$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$59{,}758$ = 59.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

15.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.6192$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.10$, $K = \$586$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6268$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$10{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.4704$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.73$, $K = \$560$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4715$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.6192 \times 0.4704 = 0.2913$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2898 ± 0.0087** (cluster-robust).

15.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15{,}000$; split 100%; per-trade cap $\$3{,}750$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3643$; expected paid cycles 0.5731; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}632$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$15{,}061.34$ in the first cycle and $m = \$15{,}061.34$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}368 = \$8{,}632$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$8{,}632$ per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **$8,691** per funded account; 10.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 54 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6357	$0	$0
1	0.2316	$15,061	$15,000
2	0.0844	$30,123	$30,000
3	0.0307	$45,184	$45,000
4	0.0112	$60,245	$60,000

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

15.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2913 \times 8{,}632 - 549.00 = \$1{,}965$; engine $\$1{,}970$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 27.89$ days per attempt, so 1.09 attempts a month per slot and $\$599$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 16.1 days on average; a passed one 24.2 days, then 32.6 days funded with 0.58 payouts; 45.1 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}970/27.89 = \$2{,}149$ ± $174 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,609** ± $420 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

15.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15%	$549	$549	$2,609 ± $420	$2,609
50K	FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15% (the 100K setting scaled)	$379	$758	$1,194 ± $211	$2,388
25K	FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15% (the 100K setting scaled)	$199	$796	$558 ± $111	$2,233
10K	FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15% (the 100K setting scaled)	$89	$890	$212 ± $44	$2,118
5K	FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 15% (the 100K setting scaled)	$59	$1,180	$87 ± $21	$1,743

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: one active account of each size. **Copying:** between your own FXIFY accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 100K; 1 × 50K; 1 × 25K; 1 × 10K; 1 × 5K, worth $4,661 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 100K; 1 × 50K; 1 × 25K; 1 × 10K; 1 × 5K, worth $4,661 a month (5 accounts).

15.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,132 ± $262	+$1,943	27.7	28.5%
× 1.5	$1,731 ± $214	+$1,507	26.5	27.2%
× 2	$1,488 ± $418	+$1,252	25.6	24.9%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

15.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10 leverage (USDJPY was searched too)
- each day's take-profit capped at 25% of the cycle target less $1 per $100K (and 40% per trade), so the best-day rule always holds
- one Classic account of each size: 100K, 50K, 25K, 10K and 5K

- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/12130186-2-phase-account-types (refunds by type); intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/14834680-the-2-phase-classic-account; fxify.com/blog/cheapest-path-funded-50k-fxify/ (refund guide, 14 September 2026).

FundedNext Stellar 2-Step

EURUSD; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **$1,227 a month per 100K** (± $415, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $2,439 a month.

16.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$549.99 for 100K; $1,049.99 for 200K (from August 2026); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10%
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first reward 21 days after the funded account opens, then every 14 days (the 21-day option); 3-day and on-demand options exist with other conditions
15% challenge reward	for accounts bought from 12 January 2026, paid only on Scale-Up eligibility (not counted)
Consistency rule	none on Stellar accounts; profit around high-impact news counts at 40% on funded accounts
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:10 gold (from January 2026); 1:10 indices (from May 2026)
Per person	$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	between your own challenge accounts; never into a funded account
Monitored as gambling	one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, breaching several accounts in a short span, losses exceeding gains (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split)

16.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$549.99
Phase 1	target $8,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; $549.99 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 21 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

16.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on EURUSD:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**6**	**1**	**20%**	**$1,502 ± $146**	**24.5%**	**19.7**
1.75%	8	1	15%	$1,458 ± $232	24.0%	20.0
1.75%	10	1	30%	$1,455 ± $364	24.6%	19.5
1.75%	8	1	30%	$1,452 ± $428	24.5%	19.5
1.75%	6	1.25	20%	$1,445 ± $507	26.0%	22.3
1.75%	16	1	30%	$1,442 ± $402	24.5%	19.5
1.75%	12	1.25	20%	$1,434 ± $483	25.9%	22.4
1.75%	8	1.25	20%	$1,434 ± $442	26.0%	22.4

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$44 ± $223 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	0.98	0.79	0.81	0.67	0.69	0.28

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
2	0.78	0.98	1.27	0.93	0.86	0.79
3	1.03	1.08	1.34	1.27	0.97	0.66
4	1.20	1.12	1.42	1.52	1.44	1.12
6	1.17	1.31	1.28	1.76	1.72	1.43
8	1.05	1.15	1.23	1.67	1.40	1.73
12	1.10	1.20	1.56	1.80	1.38	1.95

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–0.9K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

16.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of
Plan	**1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%**	**$1,227 ± $415**	**$1,427 ± $174**	**24.0% ± 0.6%**	**$6,093**	**19.4**	
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.75% / 12 / 1.03 / 20%	$2,168 ± $419	$2,317 ± $226	30.0% ± 0.9%	$7,029	20.5	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $1,389 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

16.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.0853\% = 0.0853\%$ of the price; at 1.1256 that is **9.6 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$2{,}052{,}760$; $\$182.37$ **per pip**; at $10.00 per pip per lot, 18.237 lots, rounded down to **18.23 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.33$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$127.27$, $\rho = c/l = 7.27\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}200$; take-profit 18.2 pips away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3447$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 5{,}822{,}725$; duration about 1.90 h of open market (losers 1.60 h, winners 2.5 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$8{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 45 pips away, $p = 0.1772$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: $\$20{,}528$ = 20.5% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.342$.

16.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4507$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.20$, $K = \$1{,}818$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4541$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 5 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5325$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.84$, $K = \$1{,}906$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5389$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 5 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4507 \times 0.5325 = 0.2400$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2398 ± 0.0060** (cluster-robust).

16.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$8{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2751$; expected paid cycles 0.3795; expected withdrawn before the split $\$7{,}600$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$20{,}029.57$ in the first cycle and $m = \$20{,}029.57$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 2{,}400 = \$7{,}600$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$6{,}231$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$151$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$6,093** per funded account; 7.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 43 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7249	$0	$0
1	0.1994	$16,574	$16,550
2	0.0549	$32,597	$32,550
3	0.0151	$48,621	$48,550
4	0.0042	$64,645	$64,550

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

16.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2400 \times 6{,}231 - 549.99 = \$946$; engine $\$911$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.44$ days per attempt, so 1.57 attempts a month per slot and $\$861$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 12.8 days on average; a passed one 22.8 days, then 17.2 days funded with 0.49 payouts; 31.5 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 911/19.44 = \$1{,}427$ ± $174 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$1,227** ± $415 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

16.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	FundedNext Stellar	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	$549.99	$550	$1,227 ± $415	$1,227
200K	FundedNext Stellar	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20% (the 100K setting scaled)	$1,049.99	$525	$2,439 ± $766	$1,219

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $2,439 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K, worth $2,439 a month (1 accounts).

16.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$1,346 ± $289	+$844	19.1	23.2%
× 1.5	$792 ± $149	+$454	17.4	18.8%
× 2	$195 ± $178	+$99	15.5	14.0%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

16.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market (no other account trades it), with its own direction rule: its trades are never copies
- one account at the larger size if it is worth more
- flat around news
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days

- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: https://help.fundednext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundednext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model; help.fundednext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies).

Fintokei ProTrader

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 12$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 30% of the account; **$2,678 a month per 100K** (± $364, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 5 × 100K, $13,391 a month.

17.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$549 for 100K; $1,249 for 200K; $2,599 for 400K; returned with the first payout as a sign-up bonus
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 6%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the equity at the start of the day (midnight UTC; it rises with open profit at midnight) / 10% static
Minimum days	3 separate trading days (a trade opened on the day, any result) per phase and before every payout request
Maximum risk per trade	3% on open trades (a warning, after which consistency rules can apply)
Funded split and payouts	80%; a request at least 14 days after the first trade or after the last successfully processed payout; minimum $100 (the 3% minimum profit belongs to SwiftTrader); all positions closed at the request
Discretionary consistency rules	if trading is flagged unsustainable: leverage 1:10, daily profit and loss capped at 1%
Leverage	1:100 forex, gold and silver; 1:50 indices
Per person	€500,000 of accounts in total
Copying	your own trades across your own accounts allowed; other people's signals prohibited
Prohibited	reaching a phase target in one or a few identical trades ('all-in'); token trades to complete days
Small trades	the all-in article objects to traders who reached the target and then 'opened additional, much smaller trades … just to meet the minimum 3-day trading requirement'; a trading day needs an executed trade 'with a real market outcome'

17.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$549
Phase 1	target $8,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (no filler trades: ordinary trades, one a day, if days are missing); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200)
Phase 2	target $6,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (no filler trades: ordinary trades, one a day, if days are missing); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,400)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; $549.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $100; 3 trading days in every payout cycle (no filler trades: ordinary trades, one a day, while days are missing); the next payout 14 days after the last one was processed; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

17.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.50%	**12**	**0.75**	**30%**	**$2,632 ± $1,314**	**28.1%**	**17.2**
1.75%	6	1	30%	$2,626 ± $1,084	30.7%	18.3
1.75%	7	1	30%	$2,618 ± $1,130	29.8%	18.2
1.75%	12	1	30%	$2,453 ± $707	30.2%	18.4
1.50%	4	0.75	10%	$2,426 ± $533	28.1%	19.2
1.75%	12	1	10%	$2,396 ± $681	29.9%	20.5
1.50%	8	1	20%	$2,378 ± $731	29.7%	19.2
1.75%	5	1	30%	$2,338 ± $509	29.7%	18.0

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$6 ± $489 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.61	1.66	1.65	2.07	2.00	1.62
2	1.66	2.03	2.26	2.01	2.28	1.37
3	2.00	2.18	2.05	2.48	2.12	2.13
4	2.15	2.45	2.76	2.52	2.34	2.56
6	1.85	2.02	2.24	2.21	2.58	2.58
8	1.92	2.04	2.50	2.16	2.38	2.08
12	1.91	2.15	2.22	2.38	2.72	2.91

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,500 and stop m = 0.75, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

17.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an a
Plan	**1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%**	**$2,678 ± $364**	**$2,723 ± $313**	**28.9% ± 0.7%**	**$7,371**	**17.7**	**+$**

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,877 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

17.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$730{,}758$; $\$23.52$ **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 23.520 lots, rounded down to **23.51 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}499.38$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$46.77$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}200$; take-profit 138.0 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3160$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 4{,}870{,}153$; duration about 1.22 h of open market (losers 1.00 h, winners 1.7 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$12{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}500$: take-profit 512 points away, $p = 0.1107$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: $\$14{,}615$ = 14.6% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

17.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5104$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.59$, $K = \$788$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5118$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 3 trading days (ordinary trades only; the 40% policy already needs three winning days).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$6{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5650$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.28$, $K = \$824$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5735$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6250$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,400; 3 trading days (ordinary trades only; the 40% policy already needs three winning days).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5104 \times 0.5650 = 0.2884$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2892 ± 0.0071** (cluster-robust).

17.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$12{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2302$; expected paid cycles 0.2990; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}989$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$30{,}057.76$ in the first cycle and $m = \$30{,}057.76$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}011 = \$8{,}989$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}317$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$126$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,371** per funded account; 9.4% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7698	$0	$0
1	0.1772	$24,595	$24,549
2	0.0408	$48,641	$48,549
3	0.0094	$72,688	$72,549
4	0.0022	$96,734	$96,549

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

17.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2884 \times 7{,}317 - 549.00 = \$1{,}561$; engine $\$1{,}582$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 17.69$ days per attempt, so 1.72 attempts a month per slot and $\$945$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.1 days on average; a passed one 19.9 days, then 13.3 days funded with 0.47 payouts; 37.9 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}582/17.69 = \$2{,}723$ ± $313 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,678** ± $364 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

17.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	Fintokei ProTrader	1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	$549	$549	$2,678 ± $364	$2,678
200K	Fintokei ProTrader	1.5% / 12 / 0.75 / 30% (the 100K setting scaled)	$1,249	$624	$5,159 ± $815	$2,580

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: €500,000 of accounts. **Copying:** your own trades across your own accounts. **The plan:** 5 × 100K, worth $13,391 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 5 × 100K, worth $13,391 a month (5 accounts).

17.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,672 ± $496	+$1,533	17.5	28.7%
× 1.5	$2,083 ± $326	+$1,135	16.6	26.1%
× 2	$1,963 ± $481	+$1,034	16.0	24.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

17.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction; 5 × 100K: $500,000 is about €444,000 at 1.1256, inside the €500,000 cap, and 100K is cheaper per dollar than 200K
- risk 1.5%, below the 3% limit
- every position closed before a payout request
- no filler trades: the 40% policy already needs three winning days per phase; a payout cycle short of its 3 trading days collects them with ordinary trades, one a day
- the next payout requested 14 days after the last one was processed (the model assumes one working day of processing)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends

- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation

Sources: https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated; support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538884 (withdrawals, minimum amount); support.fintokei.com/en/articles/8428030 (minimum trading days); https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade; https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538884-how-and-how-often-can-i-withdraw-my-performance-rewards-and-what-is-the-minimum-amount.

Hola Prime 2-Step Prime

gold (XAUUSD); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 7$, $m = 1.03$, payout target 20% of the account; **$2,450 a month per 100K** (± $479, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 2 × 100K, $4,900 a month.

18.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	about $599 for 100K (published $409–$599 with the payout option); returned 25% with each of the first four payouts
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5% (the 200K size has 4% / 8% limits)
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance (relative), reset 17:00 EST / 10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	bi-weekly 80% with 3 profitable days (+0.5% of the initial balance) within the 14 days; monthly 95% with 7; on-demand 80% with a consistency score of at most 40% and 2% minimum profit
Consistency (funded)	the 40% consistency score applies to on-demand payouts only
Risk (funded)	stop-loss on every trade; at most 2% risk per trade
Leverage	1:50 forex; 1:10 indices and metals
Per person	$500,000
Copying	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); copying from accounts at other prop firms prohibited
Prohibited	one-sided betting, grid trading, excessive margin use, hedging across accounts, profitability materially dependent on concentrated outcomes
Trade ideas	positions on the same asset and direction that overlap, or one opened within 10 minutes of closing another, are one trade idea; combined risk at most 2%

18.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$599
Phase 1	target $8,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; fee returned in 4 equal parts with the first 4 payouts; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; the profitable days within 14 calendar days ending on the request day; 3 profitable days of $500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

18.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on gold:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**7**	**1.03**	**20%**	**$2,639 ± $420**	**29.6%**	**19.0**
1.75%	10	1.03	20%	$2,622 ± $585	29.9%	19.0
1.75%	12	1.03	30%	$2,621 ± $470	30.2%	18.7
1.75%	12	1.03	20%	$2,612 ± $550	30.0%	19.0
1.75%	8	1.03	30%	$2,591 ± $449	29.6%	18.5
1.75%	8	1.03	20%	$2,494 ± $394	30.2%	18.9
1.75%	6	1.03	20%	$2,455 ± $358	29.6%	18.7
1.50%	6	0.89	15%	$2,453 ± $554	29.6%	19.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$18 ± $556 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.44	1.78	1.84	1.09	1.43	1.27
2	1.67	1.60	1.95	2.12	2.13	1.22
3	1.62	1.69	2.12	1.74	2.20	1.64
4	1.60	1.93	1.99	1.97	2.30	1.89
6	1.66	1.97	2.23	2.61	2.36	1.96
8	1.79	1.77	2.08	2.32	2.74	2.53
12	1.80	1.77	2.00	1.86	2.62	2.66

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.03, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

18.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.75% / 7 / 1.03 / 20%**	**$2,450 ± $479**	**$2,385 ± $193**	**29.5% ± 0.7%**	**$6,974**	**18.6**	
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	$1,169 ± $364	$1,317 ± $142	23.7% ± 0.8%	$5,843	18.1	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,413 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

18.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.03 \times 0.2838\% = 0.2923\%$ of the price; at 4,176.80 that is **12.2 dollars**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$598{,}598$; $\$143.32$ **per dollar**; at $100.00 per dollar per lot, 1.433 lots, rounded down to **1.43 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}746.15$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$64.65$, $\rho = c/l = 3.69\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}200$; take-profit 22.8 dollars away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3490$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 5{,}713{,}135$; duration about 1.98 h of open market (losers 1.67 h, winners 2.6 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$8{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 56 dollars away, $p = 0.1783$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$59{,}860$ = 59.9% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.028$.

18.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4979$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.58$, $K = \$952$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5021$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 3 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5920$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.97$, $K = \$988$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6000$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 3 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4979 \times 0.5920 = 0.2947$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2953 ± 0.0069** (cluster-robust).

18.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$8{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3025$; expected paid cycles 0.4336; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}683$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$20{,}023.84$ in the first cycle and $m = \$20{,}023.84$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}317 = \$8{,}683$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}011$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$64$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$6,974** per funded account; 11.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6975	$0	$0
1	0.2110	$16,169	$16,150
2	0.0638	$32,338	$32,300
3	0.0193	$48,506	$48,449
4	0.0058	$64,675	$64,599

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

18.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2947 \times 7{,}011 - 599.00 = \$1{,}467$; engine $\$1{,}461$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.64$ days per attempt, so 1.63 attempts a month per slot and $\$978$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.6 days on average; a passed one 19.4 days, then 15.2 days funded with 0.55 payouts; 33.0 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}461/18.64 = \$2{,}385$ ± $193 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,450** ± $479 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

18.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	1.75% / 7 / 1.03 / 20%	$599	$599	$2,450 ± $479	$2,450

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $500,000. **Copying:** only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms. **The plan:** 2 × 100K, worth $4,900 a month (2 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 2 × 100K, worth $4,900 a month (2 accounts).

18.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$1,925 ± $411	+$1,141	18.0	27.8%
× 1.5	$1,789 ± $345	+$1,022	17.4	25.8%
× 2	$1,216 ± $290	+$660	16.5	23.1%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

18.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market, traded by no other account (so nothing is copied from another firm)
- two accounts: one master and one copier, the most Hola Prime allows to share trades
- bi-weekly payouts; daily profit target until 3 profitable days within the 14 days ending on the request day
- at least 10 minutes after any close before the next trade, so no two trades are one idea
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days

- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/.

Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **$2,863 a month per 100K** (± $505, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $5,912 a month.

19.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$497 for 100K; $997 for 200K; refund policy reported inconsistently (assumed none)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the day's starting balance (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% bi-weekly: the first request 14 days after the first trade on the funded account, with 5 trading days of the same strategy (a trade opened and closed on the day; minimal lots to complete days not allowed) and at least $100 of profit; then every 14 days (on-demand payouts, with their 40% rule, are a different option)
Risk	never risk or lose 2% or more on one trade or group of trades closed together
Duration	the average trade must last more than 2 minutes, and at least half of the profit must come from trades longer than 2 minutes
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:30 metals
Per person	$400,000 per household; $300,000 per strategy
Copying	from your own external accounts with proof of ownership
Prohibited	gambling, 'all or nothing' trading

19.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$497
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (no filler trades: ordinary trades, one a day, if days are missing); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days (no filler trades: ordinary trades, one a day, if days are missing); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $100; first payout only after 5 trading days (no fillers; the plan trades at most once a day until then); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Duration rules	the 2-minute rule checked on the account's own trades at every phase pass and payout request (average, majority, half of gross profit); failure: phase restarted or profits removed
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

19.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**6**	**1**	**20%**	**$2,556 ± $740**	**28.6%**	**18.5**
1.75%	5	0.75	30%	$2,489 ± $847	27.6%	16.9
1.75%	12	0.75	30%	$2,487 ± $1,395	27.1%	16.8
1.75%	7	0.75	30%	$2,459 ± $851	26.9%	16.6
1.75%	6	1.25	30%	$2,444 ± $848	29.4%	20.4
1.75%	12	0.75	20%	$2,413 ± $925	27.1%	17.3
1.75%	8	1	20%	$2,386 ± $797	28.8%	18.6
1.75%	6	0.75	30%	$2,349 ± $754	26.8%	16.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$67 ± $276 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.80	1.95	2.04	1.78	1.64	1.84
2	1.76	2.08	1.91	2.37	1.92	2.23
3	2.09	2.30	2.23	2.71	2.57	2.44
4	1.83	2.34	2.85	2.48	2.34	2.37
6	2.09	2.16	2.36	2.40	2.91	2.57
8	1.66	2.14	2.32	1.82	2.78	2.20
12	1.97	2.08	2.39	2.02	2.13	2.33

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.4–1.1K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

19.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an atten
Plan	**1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%**	**$2,863 ± $505**	**$2,620 ± $177**	**28.3% ± 0.8%**	**$7,394**	**18.6**	**+$1,5**

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,653 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

19.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$639{,}413$; $20.58 **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 20.580 lots, rounded down to **20.57 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.17$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$4{,}000$; take-profit 196.4 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3022$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 7{,}071{,}614$; duration about 2.31 h of open market (losers 1.87 h, winners 3.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$8{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 391 points away, $p = 0.1787$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: $\$31{,}971$ = 32.0% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

19.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000, B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4688$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.44$, $K = \$595$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4702$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 3 trading days (ordinary trades only; the 40% policy already needs three winning days).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000, B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6158$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.99$, $K = \$627$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6249$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 3 trading days (ordinary trades only; the 40% policy already needs three winning days).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4688 \times 0.6158 = 0.2887$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2835 ± 0.0084** (cluster-robust).

19.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$8{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3132$; expected paid cycles 0.4561; expected withdrawn before the split $\$9{,}137$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$20{,}034.33$ in the first cycle and $m = \$20{,}034.33$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 863 = \$9{,}137$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}310$ per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,394** per funded account; 11.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6868	$0	$0
1	0.2151	$16,027	$16,000
2	0.0674	$32,055	$32,000
3	0.0211	$48,082	$48,000
4	0.0066	$64,110	$64,000

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

19.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2887 \times 7{,}310 - 497.00 = \$1{,}613$; engine $\$1{,}599$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.58$ days per attempt, so 1.64 attempts a month per slot and $\$814$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.8 days on average; a passed one 19.5 days, then 17.8 days funded with 0.62 payouts; 31.9 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}599/18.58 = \$2{,}620$ ± $177 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,863** ± $505 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

19.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	$497	$497	$2,863 ± $505	$2,863
200K	Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20% (the 100K setting scaled)	$997	$498	$5,912 ± $1,118	$2,956

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000 per household, $300,000 per strategy. **Copying:** from your own external accounts with proof. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $5,912 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K; 1 × 100K, worth $8,775 a month (2 accounts).

19.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,380 ± $188	+$1,433	18.3	28.6%
× 1.5	$2,160 ± $221	+$1,271	17.9	26.9%
× 2	$1,954 ± $319	+$1,107	17.2	25.0%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

19.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, 1.75% risk (below the 2% rule after cost)
- bi-weekly payouts; until the funded account has 5 trading days, at most one normal trade a day
- the 2-minute rule checked on the account's own trades at every phase pass and payout request (average, majority, half of gross profit), with the firm's consequence applied on failure
- no minimal-lot trades to complete days, in evaluations too
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends

- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation

Sources: help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10570531-bi-weekly-performance-fee; https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule; help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8420429-alpha-pro-8-10.

FunderPro Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 6$, $m = 0.92$, payout target 30% of the account; **$2,176 a month per 100K** (± $361, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $4,606 a month.

20.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$539 for 100K list (often 20% off); $989 for 200K; refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5%, balance-based, reset 00:00 GMT+3; the base is not stated (the model takes the stricter of the initial and the day's balance) / 10% static
Minimum days	a minimum number of trading days per phase by default (a 'No Minimum Trading Days' add-on is sold for Classic only); 4 per phase as published by reviewers (the official pages read do not state the number)
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days; at least $100 of profit for every reward
Consistency rule	none on Classic
Risk per trade	at most 2%
Margin (funded)	at most 20% of the starting balance as margin per asset class (FX, metals, energies, US and EU indices, shares, crypto); first breach: the profit of the breaching trades is removed; second: the account fails. No margin rule on challenges.
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:30 indices (Classic and Pro challenges)
Per person	$200,000
Copying	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts; no copying from accounts you do not own

20.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$539
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); at least 4 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); split 80%; $539.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $100; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:30 (evaluation), 1:30 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry, and at most 20% of the starting balance on the funded account

20.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.50%	**6**	**0.92**	**30%**	**$2,559 ± $1,062**	**28.4%**	**18.5**
1.75%	4	1.07	20%	$2,472 ± $773	28.8%	18.7
1.75%	5	1.07	30%	$2,469 ± $1,050	28.4%	18.4
1.75%	7	1.07	30%	$2,457 ± $864	28.4%	18.5
1.75%	6	1.25	15%	$2,410 ± $317	29.0%	20.7
1.50%	12	0.92	30%	$2,399 ± $1,054	27.6%	18.3
1.75%	6	1.07	30%	$2,372 ± $1,040	28.8%	18.5
1.50%	3	0.92	30%	$2,359 ± $795	28.3%	18.4

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$87 ± $414 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.90	2.12	1.88	1.95	1.78	1.46
2	1.84	2.28	2.15	2.11	2.28	2.22
3	2.10	1.91	1.85	2.06	2.74	2.69
4	2.04	2.22	2.19	2.76	2.27	2.51
6	2.07	2.43	2.53	2.60	2.10	2.68
8	2.01	2.26	2.36	2.36	2.42	2.55
12	2.05	2.24	2.29	2.30	2.14	2.66

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,500 and stop m = 0.92, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

20.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.5% / 6 / 0.92 / 30%**	**$2,176 ± $361**	**$2,514 ± $294**	**27.9% ± 1.0%**	**$7,390**	**18.4**	
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	$1,907 ± $444	$2,227 ± $293	26.2% ± 0.7%	$7,020	17.7	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,919 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

20.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.92 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2518\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **78.2 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$595{,}726$; $19.17 **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 19.174 lots, rounded down to **19.17 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}499.71$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.13$, $\rho = c/l = 2.54\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$4{,}000$; take-profit 210.6 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.2708$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 6{,}057{,}190$; duration about 2.28 h of open market (losers 1.80 h, winners 3.6 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$9{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}500$: take-profit 471 points away, $p = 0.1423$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:30: $\$19{,}858$ = 19.9% of the starting balance (limit 20%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.913$.

20.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000, B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4653$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.87$, $K = \$648$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4671$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000, B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6124$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.49$, $K = \$680$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6205$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 4 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4653 \times 0.6124 = 0.2850$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2789 ± 0.0096** (cluster-robust).

20.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$12{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2287$; expected paid cycles 0.2965; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}910$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$30{,}048.74$ in the first cycle and $m = \$30{,}048.74$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}090 = \$8{,}910$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}251$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$123$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,390** per funded account; 10.3% of attempts reach a payout; median 35 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7713	$0	$0
1	0.1764	$24,578	$24,539
2	0.0403	$48,617	$48,539
3	0.0092	$72,656	$72,539
4	0.0021	$96,695	$96,539

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

20.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2850 \times 7{,}251 - 539.00 = \$1{,}527$; engine $\$1{,}522$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.43$ days per attempt, so 1.65 attempts a month per slot and $\$890$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.3 days on average; a passed one 21.8 days, then 15.0 days funded with 0.57 payouts; 40.2 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}522/18.43 = \$2{,}514$ ± $294 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,176** ± $361 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

20.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	FunderPro Classic	1.5% / 6 / 0.92 / 30%	$539	$539	$2,176 ± $361	$2,176
200K	FunderPro Classic	1.5% / 6 / 0.92 / 30% (the 100K setting scaled)	$989	$494	$4,606 ± $668	$2,303

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $200,000. **Copying:** no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $4,606 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K, worth $4,606 a month (1 accounts).

20.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,633 ± $631	+$1,600	18.5	28.3%
× 1.5	$1,985 ± $581	+$1,153	17.7	26.2%
× 2	$1,799 ± $478	+$1,014	17.2	23.9%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

20.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, the larger size if it is worth more
- risk at most 1.75%, below the 2% limit
- stop at least 0.913 hourly standard deviations on the Nasdaq at 1.5% risk (USDJPY: 0.733 at 1.75%), so the funded margin stays under 20% of the starting balance
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days

- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts; support.funderpro.com/en/articles/419844 (rewards, $100 minimum); support.funderpro.com/en/articles/412020 (add-ons); https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges.

Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 3$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 10% of the account; **$2,627 a month per 100K** (± $293, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $4,123 a month.

21.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$524 for 100K; $974 for 200K; refundable
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% subtracted from the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 valid days per phase; a day is valid only with at least 0.5% profit
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days from the first trade; 4 valid days (+0.5%) per payout cycle for accounts bought from 25 July 2026; minimum $100 (the 3% minimum belongs to on-demand rewards); the first two payouts at most 6% of the account or $10,000
Daily profit cap (funded)	$3,000 a day at every account size; profit above it is deducted (not a breach)
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	evaluation 1:20 on indices; funded 1:10 on indices, 1:50 forex
Per person	$400,000 funded
Copying	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts
Goat Guard (funded)	a combined floating loss of 2%: the first time the split falls to 50%, the second time the account is breached

21.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$524
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; $524.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $100; payout caps $6,000, $6,000; profit above $3,000 a day not counted; 4 profitable days of $500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

21.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**3**	**1.07**	**10%**	**$2,265 ± $287**	**28.9%**	**22.2**
1.75%	3.5	1.07	15%	$2,203 ± $357	29.2%	21.9
1.75%	3	1.07	15%	$2,188 ± $305	28.7%	21.7
1.75%	2.5	1.07	15%	$2,145 ± $348	29.4%	22.0
1.75%	3	1.25	20%	$2,113 ± $397	29.2%	22.9
1.75%	4	1.07	8%	$2,102 ± $198	28.4%	22.1
1.75%	6	1.07	10%	$2,084 ± $276	28.3%	22.0
1.75%	3	1.25	10%	$2,062 ± $299	29.3%	23.2

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$62 ± $361 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
1.5	1.67	1.88	1.96	1.87	2.02	2.08

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
2	1.91	2.05	1.93	2.03	1.97	2.27
3	2.00	2.10	2.28	2.36	2.51	2.28
4	1.84	1.72	2.36	2.05	2.14	2.11
6	1.98	2.20	2.16	2.33	2.23	2.26
8	1.98	2.17	2.14	2.24	1.77	1.84
12	1.97	2.08	2.21	2.35	2.01	2.05

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–0.7K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.07, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

21.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%**	**$2,627 ± $293**	**$2,164 ± $115**	**28.5% ± 0.8%**	**$7,326**	**22.0**	
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.5% / 12 / 1.25 / 8%	$1,764 ± $234	$1,781 ± $116	27.1% ± 0.9%	$7,066	23.7	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,197 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

21.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$597{,}582$; $\$19.23$ **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 19.233 lots, rounded down to **19.23 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.69$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$3{,}333$; take-profit 175.3 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3417$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 5{,}900{,}263$; duration about 2.21 h of open market (losers 1.85 h, winners 2.9 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$2{,}400$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 127 points away, $p = 0.4178$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$59{,}758$ = 59.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

21.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4709$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.71$, $K = \$559$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4720$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6197$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.08$, $K = \$585$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6277$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4709 \times 0.6197 = 0.2918$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2853 ± 0.0080** (cluster-robust).

21.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$6{,}000$, $X = \$10{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$3{,}000$.

The first payouts are capped at $6,000, $6,000 (7.2: two special first cycles).

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$6{,}095.56$ in the first cycle and $m = \$6{,}095.56$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.5860$; expected paid cycles 1.2227; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}629$.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}371 = \$8{,}629$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$7{,}210$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$307$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,326** per funded account; 17.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 34 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.4140	$0	$0
1	0.2426	$5,400	$5,324
2	0.1853	$10,277	$10,124
3	0.0853	$18,362	$18,124
4	0.0393	$26,448	$26,124

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

21.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2918 \times 7{,}210 - 524.00 = \$1{,}580$; engine $\$1{,}566$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 22.04$ days per attempt, so 1.38 attempts a month per slot and $\$724$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.0 days on average; a passed one 20.4 days, then 28.8 days funded with 1.42 payouts; 36.7 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}566/22.04 = \$2{,}164$ ± $115 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,627** ± $293 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

21.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	GFT Standard	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%	$524	$524	$2,627 ± $293	$2,627
200K	GFT Standard	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10% (the 100K setting scaled)	$974	$487	$4,123 ± $390	$2,061

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000 funded. **Copying:** no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $4,123 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 200K, worth $4,123 a month (1 accounts).

21.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,221 ± $279	+$1,616	22.1	29.1%
× 1.5	$1,992 ± $148	+$1,414	21.6	28.3%
× 2	$1,632 ± $152	+$1,076	20.1	25.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

21.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account; Nasdaq with a stop of at least 1.066 sd at 1.75% risk (funded 1:10, margin at most 60%) or USDJPY
- take-profit capped at the day's remaining $3,000
- one open position at a time, risking at most 1.75% plus cost: Goat Guard's 2% cannot trigger without an intraday gap
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days

- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard; help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/9549359-all-about-rewards-and-profit-splits; https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard.

BrightFunded 2-Step Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 3.5$, $m = 1$, payout target 30% of the account; **$2,312 a month per 100K** (± $432, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $4,594 a month.

22.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€497 for 100K ($559.42 at 1.1256); €997 for 200K ($1,122.22); refund only with the paid refund add-on
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first payout about 30 days after funding, then every 14 days
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:40 gold
Per person	$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	allowed between your own accounts at any firm
Trading days	a day counts only if at least one trade stays open 60 seconds or more

22.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$559.42
Phase 1	target $10,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($4,000)
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $10,000 below the start, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss $10,000, static; daily loss $5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Duration rules	a trading day counts only with a trade held at least 60 seconds
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

22.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**3.5**	**1**	**30%**	**$2,222 ± $737**	**29.0%**	**19.5**
1.75%	6	1.25	30%	$2,115 ± $595	29.0%	21.8
1.50%	8	1	30%	$2,051 ± $970	28.4%	20.5
1.50%	4	0.75	30%	$2,049 ± $729	27.4%	18.8
1.75%	3	1	30%	$2,032 ± $710	28.3%	19.2
1.75%	12	0.75	30%	$2,017 ± $853	27.4%	17.8
1.50%	12	0.75	20%	$2,003 ± $575	26.9%	19.2
1.75%	3	1	20%	$1,986 ± $654	28.7%	19.7

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$107 ± $346 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.66	1.39	1.45	1.71	1.55	1.40
2	1.59	1.83	1.73	2.15	1.63	1.51
3	1.76	1.97	2.00	2.25	2.23	2.57

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
4	1.67	1.77	1.97	2.08	2.05	1.94
6	1.54	1.77	1.69	1.72	2.07	1.99
8	1.62	2.07	1.97	1.63	1.81	2.05
12	1.56	2.05	1.75	1.85	2.18	1.97

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.1K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

22.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an att
Plan	**1.75% / 3.5 / 1 / 30%**	**$2,312 ± $432**	**$2,276 ± $150**	**28.8% ± 0.9%**	**$7,013**	**19.5**	**+$1**

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,607 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

22.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$639{,}413$; $\$20.58$ **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 20.580 lots, rounded down to **20.57 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.17$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$4{,}000$; take-profit 196.4 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3022$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 7{,}071{,}614$; duration about 2.31 h of open market (losers 1.87 h, winners 3.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$6{,}125$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 300 points away, $p = 0.2211$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: $\$31{,}971$ = 32.0% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

22.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4683$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.64$, $K = \$598$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4696$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $4,000; 5 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$10{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6153$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.12$, $K = \$628$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6239$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 5 trading days (0.01-lot filler trades held 3 minutes in the engine).

Daily loss limit $5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4683 \times 0.6153 = 0.2881$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2878 ± 0.0086** (cluster-robust).

22.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30{,}000$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$12{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2217$; expected paid cycles 0.2848; expected withdrawn before the split $\$8{,}563$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$30{,}061.73$ in the first cycle and $m = \$30{,}061.73$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10{,}000 - 1{,}437 = \$8{,}563$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$6{,}850$ per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **$7,013** per funded account; 7.5% of attempts reach a payout; median 52 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.7783	$0	$0
1	0.1725	$24,049	$24,000
2	0.0383	$48,099	$48,000
3	0.0085	$72,148	$72,000
4	0.0019	$96,198	$96,000

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

22.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2881 \times 6{,}850 - 559.42 = \$1{,}414$; engine $\$1{,}459$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.51$ days per attempt, so 1.56 attempts a month per slot and $\$873$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.9 days on average; a passed one 22.6 days, then 17.9 days funded with 0.38 payouts; 37.6 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}459/19.51 = \$2{,}276$ ± $150 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,312** ± $432 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

22.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	BrightFunded Classic	1.75% / 3.5 / 1 / 30%	$559.42	$559	$2,312 ± $432	$2,312
200K	BrightFunded Classic	1.75% / 3.5 / 1 / 30% (the 100K setting scaled)	$1,122.22	$561	$4,594 ± $873	$2,297

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** allowed between your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $4,594 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 × 100K, worth $9,247 a month (4 accounts).

22.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$2,049 ± $475	+$1,288	19.1	28.0%
× 1.5	$1,601 ± $473	+$970	18.4	26.3%
× 2	$1,441 ± $382	+$845	17.9	24.9%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

22.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account (recommended) or four, Nasdaq
- a day counts only with a trade held at least 60 seconds: the engine counts it only then (filler trades are held 3 minutes)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process; help.brightfunded.com (refund add-on).

Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 15% of the account; **$2,301 a month per 100K** (± $337, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 200K, $4,589 a month.

23.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$579 for 100K list (often half price with a code); $1,162 for 200K; refunded after the fourth payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 4%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the initial balance below the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York (fixed) / 8% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase
Funded split and payouts	85% every 14 days; the payout requires the minimum trading days requirement (read strictly as 3 profitable days in the cycle), the account above its initial balance and all positions closed; minimum $100 by crypto, $500 by Rise
Guardian Shield (funded)	all trades closed at a 2% open loss; first time the split falls to 50%, second time the account closes
Leverage	1:10 on indices
Per person	$400,000; evaluations up to $200,000 each
Copying	your own accounts only
Prohibited	margin use above 80% counts as gambling
Holding time	the minimum holding time is 2 minutes (tick scalping)
News (funded)	no opening or closing 5 minutes before and after red-folder news

23.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$579
Phase 1	target $8,000; maximum loss $8,000 below the start, static; daily loss $4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200)
Phase 2	target $4,000; maximum loss $8,000 below the start, static; daily loss $4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($1,600)
Funded account	maximum loss $8,000, static; daily loss $4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 85%; $579.00 of the fee returned with payout number 4; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout $100; 3 profitable days of $500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Duration rules	the bracket is placed 3 minutes after the entry (minimum holding time 2 minutes); a trade that could close sooner ends the account
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

23.3 The search

Searched: 315 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 17 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**12**	**1.25**	**15%**	**$1,941 ± $372**	**29.8%**	**19.2**
1.75%	2	1.07	10%	$1,923 ± $439	29.3%	19.0
1.75%	2	1.25	15%	$1,862 ± $357	29.2%	18.4
1.75%	2	1.25	10%	$1,858 ± $242	29.9%	19.8
1.50%	6	0.92	15%	$1,812 ± $318	27.9%	17.7
1.75%	3	1.07	10%	$1,808 ± $142	28.8%	19.0
1.50%	6	0.92	20%	$1,792 ± $697	27.9%	17.4
1.50%	7	0.92	15%	$1,787 ± $600	28.1%	17.7

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$18 ± $509 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%
1.5	1.61	1.51	1.67	1.98	1.72
2	1.61	2.06	1.65	2.06	2.16
3	1.47	1.70	2.00	2.02	1.92
4	1.40	1.45	1.99	1.82	2.02
6	1.56	1.78	1.66	1.63	1.78
8	1.61	1.69	1.88	1.91	2.01
12	1.53	1.72	1.60	1.91	2.19

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.3–1.0K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.25, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

23.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 15%**	**$2,301 ± $337**	**$2,071 ± $157**	**29.6% ± 0.7%**	**$6,407**	**19.3**	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $2,231 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

23.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.2737\% = 0.3421\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **106.3 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$511{,}530$; $16.46 **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 16.464 lots, rounded down to **16.46 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.60$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$32.74$, $\rho = c/l = 1.87\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$2{,}667$; take-profit 164.0 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3933$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 4{,}723{,}958$; duration about 2.41 h of open market (losers 2.13 h, winners 2.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$6{,}000$ at risk $\$1{,}750$: take-profit 366 points away, $p = 0.2249$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$51{,}153$ = 51.2% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

23.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8{,}000$, $B = \$8{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4723$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 12.71$, $K = \$388$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4757$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$4{,}000$, $B = \$8{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6302$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 12.62$, $K = \$392$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.6340$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most $1,600; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4723 \times 0.6302 = 0.2976$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2955 ± 0.0066** (cluster-robust).

23.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15{,}000$; split 85%; per-trade cap $\$6{,}000$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3308$; expected paid cycles 0.4943; expected withdrawn before the split $\$7{,}432$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$15{,}035.78$ in the first cycle and $m = \$15{,}035.78$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 8{,}000 - 568 = \$7{,}432$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$6{,}324$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$7$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$6,407** per funded account; 11.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 34 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.6692	$0	$0
1	0.2214	$12,780	$12,750
2	0.0732	$25,561	$25,500
3	0.0242	$38,341	$38,250
4	0.0080	$51,701	$51,579

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

23.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2976 \times 6{,}324 - 579.00 = \$1{,}303$; engine $\$1{,}314$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.32$ days per attempt, so 1.58 attempts a month per slot and $\$912$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.5 days on average; a passed one 20.9 days, then 16.1 days funded with 0.63 payouts; 29.6 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}314/19.32 = \$2{,}071$ ± $157 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$2,301** ± $337 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

23.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	Blue Guardian 2-Step	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 15%	$579	$579	$2,301 ± $337	$2,301
200K	Blue Guardian 2-Step	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 15% (the 100K setting scaled)	$1,162	$581	$4,589 ± $654	$2,295

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $400,000; evaluations up to $200,000 each. **Copying:** your own accounts only. **The plan:** 1 × 200K, worth $4,589 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 × 100K, worth $9,205 a month (4 accounts).

23.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$1,951 ± $265	+$1,220	19.0	29.5%
× 1.5	$1,579 ± $395	+$948	18.3	27.4%
× 2	$1,555 ± $154	+$929	18.2	27.2%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

23.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10
- risk at most 1.75%: a stop-out stays below the 2% shield (a position closed at the market at the end of its 3-minute hold can lose a little more than its stop; reaching 2% would take a move against it of more than 5.3 standard deviations of 3 minutes at the narrowest stop the margin allows, 1.07 hourly sd; 6.3 at the chosen stop of 1.25 sd)
- every position opened with only an emergency stop at the account's breach level; the bracket placed 3 minutes after the entry, or the position closed at the market if the price is then already beyond the stop or the take-profit, so no trade lasts under 2 minutes
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends

- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: help.blueguardian.com/en/articles/14062291-2-step-standard-rules.

Maven 2-Step

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 2$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 4.9% of the account; **$1,461 a month per 100K** (± $111, long-run rate of a continuing slot); in the plan: 1 × 100K, $1,461 a month.

24.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$440 for 100K (largest 2-Step size); refunded with the third payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the higher of equity and balance at 00:00 UTC (relative: 4% of $1,100 in the FAQ's example) / 8% static
Profitable days	3 per phase, each at least +0.5%
Funded split and payouts	80%; a withdrawal every 10 business days after the first trade; 3 profitable days (+0.5%) in the funded phase before a withdrawal; at most $10,000 per trader per rolling 30 days, counted on the date the profit is closed, the excess voided
Leverage	1:75 forex; 1:20 indices and commodities
Per person	$200,000
Consistency (funded)	if the total profit exceeds $5,000, the best day (trades with less than 24 hours between a close and the next opening count as one day) or single trade may not exceed 50% of the cycle's profit; the 20% consistency score belongs to instant accounts
Risk interview	after $5,000 of total profit; a payout is not processed without it
News	no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations and funded accounts
Gambling	large bets at a reward:risk of 1:1.25 or lower ('random odds')
Refund	with the third withdrawal

24.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$440
Phase 1	target $8,000; maximum loss $8,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($3,200); every trade at least 1:1.5
Phase 2	target $5,000; maximum loss $8,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least $500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($2,000); every trade at least 1:1.5
Funded account	maximum loss $8,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; $440.00 of the fee returned with payout number 3; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: funded profit never above $4,900, a margin under the $5,000 above which the firm's 50% rule applies; plan: closed profit in any 30 days never above $10,000 (the excess would be voided); every trade at least 1:1.5; 3 profitable days of $500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

24.3 The search

Searched: 336 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	**2**	**1.25**	**4.9%**	**$1,410 ± $199**	**27.7%**	**25.8**
1.75%	4	1	4.9%	$1,346 ± $64	26.0%	24.2
1.50%	8	1	4.9%	$1,329 ± $114	26.3%	24.8
1.75%	12	1	4.9%	$1,322 ± $197	26.3%	24.5
1.50%	6	1	4.9%	$1,296 ± $183	26.6%	24.6
1.50%	7	1	4.9%	$1,278 ± $182	26.1%	24.4
1.75%	6	1	4%	$1,269 ± $65	26.0%	24.6
1.75%	8	1.25	4%	$1,261 ± $185	26.8%	26.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. The settings share paths and random numbers, so the ranking is judged on paired differences, not on overlapping intervals: the best against the second, paired over the four paths, +$63 ± $209 a month (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom), so the refinement cannot tell them apart.

k \ X	2%	3%	4%	4.9%
1.5	0.99	1.14	1.14	1.28
2	1.11	1.25	1.37	1.41
3	1.02	1.35	1.37	1.35
4	1.14	1.42	1.33	1.38
6	1.06	1.21	1.32	1.24
8	1.05	1.26	1.42	1.29
12	1.08	1.28	1.32	1.38

Grid value per month ($ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so ±$0.2–0.5K for most cells) at risk $1,750 and stop m = 1.25, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

24.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	Long-run EV/month: continuing slot (95%)	Random-start ratio (95%)	Pass rate (95%)	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an
Plan	**1.75% / 2 / 1.25 / 4.9%**	**$1,461 ± $111**	**$1,317 ± $73**	**26.8% ± 0.7%**	**$5,711**	**25.2**	

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting. Continuing slot: 12 slots run back to back on each of 16 new paths (151–166), years 2–9 (8.3). Random-start ratio and the other columns: sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts. Cluster-robust 95% intervals (8.4). Version 8 reported $1,409 a month (random-start) for this programme under its rules and engine.

24.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1{,}750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.2737\% = 0.3421\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **106.3 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$511{,}530$; $16.46 **per point**; at $1.00 per point per lot, 16.464 lots, rounded down to **16.46 lots**, a risk of $\$1{,}749.60$ at the stop (10.1; the figures below are unrounded).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$32.74$, $\rho = c/l = 1.87\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1+\rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(k\,l,\ A_1,\ \text{caps}) = \$2{,}667$; take-profit 164.0 points away; $p = l/(l+w+c) = 0.3933$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w+c) = 4{,}723{,}958$; duration about 2.41 h of open market (losers 2.13 h, winners 2.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): $\$1{,}960$ at risk $\$1{,}307$ (lowered from $\$1{,}750$ so that the reward:risk is at least 1:1.5): take-profit 161 points away, $p = 0.3970$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: $\$25{,}577$ = 25.6% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

24.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8{,}000$, $B = \$8{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4736$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 13.62$, $K = \$388$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8{,}000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.4758$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most $3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5{,}000$, $B = \$8{,}000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5822$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.10$, $K = \$387$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8{,}000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B-K)/(A+B) = 0.5856$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A+B) = 0.6154$.

Rules in play: every win at most $2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit $4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less $200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4736 \times 0.5822 = 0.2757$ (chain, whose phases are calendar-free and independent; 6.1). Engine with every rule, both phases in sequence on one path (so P_2 is the conditional chance given phase 1), fresh paths: **0.2683 ± 0.0068** (cluster-robust).

24.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8{,}000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$4{,}900$; split 80%; per-trade cap $\$1{,}960$.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.5906$; expected paid cycles 1.4427; expected withdrawn before the split $\$7{,}069$.

A paid cycle pays its balance at success: on average $m_1 = \$4{,}900.00$ in the first cycle and $m = \$4{,}900.00$ later (7.2), not exactly the target.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 8{,}000 - 931 = \$7{,}069$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): $\$5{,}746$ per funded account, of which the refund term $\$91$.

Engine, fresh paths: **$5,711** per funded account; 16.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 35 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Mean cash given that many	Nominal (targets only)
0	0.4094	$0	$0
1	0.2418	$3,920	$3,920
2	0.1428	$7,840	$7,840
3	0.0843	$12,200	$12,200
4	0.0498	$16,120	$16,120

Chain values in its model of independent cycles that each start from zero: mean cash given the number of paid cycles, $\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)m)$ plus the refund (7.2). The nominal column (targets only) is for comparison; version 8 printed it as the cash.

24.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2757 \times 5{,}746 - 440.00 = \$1{,}144$; engine $\$1{,}092$.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 25.24$ days per attempt, so 1.21 attempts a month per slot and $\$531$ of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.4 days on average; a passed one 21.5 days, then 42.1 days funded with 1.92 payouts; 36.2 trades per attempt.

Random-start ratio (8.3; the search's yardstick): $30.44 \times 1{,}092/25.24 = \$1{,}317$ ± $73 (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

Long-run rate of one slot run back to back (8.3; continuing_v9.py, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths, years 2–9): **$1,461** ± $111 a month; this is the figure Part III's allocation uses.

24.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Programme	Risk / k / m / X	Fee	Fee per $100K	Long-run EV/month (95%)	EV/month per $100K
100K	Maven 2-Step	1.75% / 2 / 1.25 / 4.9%	$440	$440	$1,461 ± $111	$1,461

Each row names its programme and its setting: other sizes of a programme run its 100K setting scaled in proportion (risk, targets, payout target, safety margins); The5ers' small accounts are New High Stakes accounts with New's own chosen setting scaled, not the plan's 100K programme. Continuing-slot rates (8.3).

Per person: $200,000; at most $10,000 of profit closed per rolling 30 days per person. **Copying:** –. **The plan:** 1 × 100K, worth $1,461 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 × 100K, worth $1,461 a month (1 accounts).

24.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	$1,411 ± $86	+$1,186	25.6	27.1%
× 1.5	$1,255 ± $166	+$1,006	24.4	26.0%
× 2	$1,237 ± $134	+$987	24.3	25.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. The rows share their paths and random draws but not their trades: a different cost changes the first trade's result, and the account's later trades with it, so the rows also differ by Monte Carlo noise of the size of the interval. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

24.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one 100K account, Nasdaq
- every trade at a reward:risk of at least 1:1.5
- funded profit never above $4,900 (payout targets of 2–4.9%), $100 under the threshold, so the 50% rule never applies even with a take-profit filled a few points better
- no win placed that could take the profit closed in any 30 days above $10,000
- the risk interview booked as soon as it is offered
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends

- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry (a plan choice: a bracket with both levels at that distance still closes within 2 minutes about 0.2% of the time, so a firm's duration rule is met by a holding time where it has one, not by this distance)
- positions in whole lots (0.01-lot steps; whole futures contracts), rounded down; risk sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop order at the floor itself: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- missing trading days, where the firm counts any opened position, completed with one 0.01-lot trade a day, opened at the day's first permitted hour and closed at the market after 3 minutes (none at Fintokei and Alpha Capital)

Sources: https://maventrading.com/faqs (read 4 Oct 2026).

Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well; the choice keeps the plan's stop of at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations (the grid also tries 0.5, which the first version 9 run chose for Apex: n21).

25.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$49 a month (Standard path); a reset after a breach $49; $149 activation per Express Funded Account
Target / maximum loss	$3,000 / $2,000 trailing at the end of each day, locking at the start balance
Consistency (Combine)	best day at most 55% of the profit target (the model uses 50%)
Funded payouts	after 5 winning days of $150+; at most 50% of the balance and $2,000 a request; 90%; every payout after the first needs net profit since the last; after the first payout the maximum loss level moves to the starting balance
Per person	up to 5 Express Funded Accounts at once
Trading hours	flat by the daily close (the plan: by 20:00 UTC)

25.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$49 a month (renewed while the evaluation lasts); activation $149 on passing
Evaluation	target $3,000; maximum loss $2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; at least 2 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); best day at most 50% of the profit; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($1,200)
Funded account	maximum loss $2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; split 90%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least $150; payout caps $2,000, $2,000, $2,000, $2,000, $2,000, $2,000; a payout at most 50% of the balance; each later payout needs net profit since the last
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days

25.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1.5	1	$950	$808 ± $240	28.2%	4.4
3	0.75	$600	$749 ± $231	27.6%	4.8
1.5	1	$800	$743 ± $135	28.5%	4.7
2	0.75	$600	$711 ± $302	27.5%	4.6
1.5	0.75	$950	$708 ± $244	26.4%	3.9
2	0.75	$950	$663 ± $172	27.0%	4.0
4	0.5	$400	$620 ± $386	27.6%	4.8
2	0.75	$1,100	$605 ± $245	25.9%	4.1

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

25.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk $950: at the reference level of 31,070 the stop is 85.0 points and one MNQ contract loses $170 at the stop, so 5 contracts (rounded down), a risk of $850; the engine recomputes this at every entry from the path's price (10.1).

Fresh paths: $762 ± $109 a month per account as a random-start ratio (pass rate 28.4% ± 0.6%, 4.5 days per attempt); long-run rate of a continuing slot (whose price level and calendar carry from attempt to attempt): **$878 ± $164**.

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a $2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

25.5 How many

5 Express Funded Accounts at once: 5 accounts, worth $4,389 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

25.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts
- risk and k searched (no percentage rule applies)
- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down, never fewer than one
- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy; help.topstep.com (pricing).

Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well; the choice keeps the plan's stop of at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations (the grid also tries 0.5, which the first version 9 run chose for Apex: n21).

26.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	$550 list; public 80–90% codes most of 2026 (about $55); $99 activation when passed
Target / maximum loss	$3,000 / $2,000 trailing end of day; $1,000 daily loss limit; evaluations expire after 30 days
Funded payouts	100% split; 5 qualifying days per request; no day may make 50% or more of the request's profit; $500 minimum; caps $1,500, $1,500, $2,000, $2,500, $2,500, $3,000; at most 6 payouts, then the account closes; safety net of drawdown + $100
Per person	up to 20 funded accounts; copying between your own accounts allowed
Trading hours	flat by 4:59 pm ET every session

26.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	$55; activation $99 on passing
Evaluation	target $3,000; maximum loss $2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss $1,000 (2% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 1 trading days (a missing day: a 0.01-lot filler trade held 3 minutes); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target ($1,200); expires after 30 days
Funded account	maximum loss $2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss $1,000 (2% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 100%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least $250; minimum payout $500; payout caps $1,500, $1,500, $2,000, $2,500, $2,500, $3,000; best day below 50% of a payout's profit (strictly); at most 6 payouts; buffer $2,100 kept in the account
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Positions	whole volume steps at the contract size (0.01 lot; whole futures contracts), rounded down, never below the smallest; the account's breach level (floor or today's limit, the nearer) is a barrier of every trade; reviews and payout processing in working days

26.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
3	0.5	$400	$229 ± $199	26.4%	11.9
1.5	1	$600	$221 ± $34	26.6%	13.1
3	0.75	$400	$217 ± $175	26.3%	12.2
1.5	1	$800	$203 ± $31	27.5%	12.6
2	1	$600	$197 ± $138	27.0%	12.6
1.5	0.75	$950	$192 ± $51	25.7%	12.3
1.5	0.75	$1,100	$182 ± $30	25.5%	12.5
1.5	0.75	$800	$175 ± $90	25.4%	11.8

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

26.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk $600: at the reference level of 31,070 the stop is 85.0 points and one MNQ contract loses $170 at the stop, so 3 contracts (rounded down), a risk of $510; the engine recomputes this at every entry from the path's price (10.1).

Fresh paths: $238 ± $41 a month per account as a random-start ratio (pass rate 26.8% ± 0.7%, 13.0 days per attempt); long-run rate of a continuing slot (whose price level and calendar carry from attempt to attempt): **$293 ± $76**.

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a $2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

26.5 How many

20 funded accounts: 20 accounts, worth $5,852 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

26.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction
- only at 80–90% off: at the list price the value is negative
- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down, never fewer than one
- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/; apextraderfunding.com help centre.

PART III

One person, many accounts

Part II valued one account at a time, as a long-run rate. This part runs them together for one person: how much each firm allows, how to fill it, what a first year looks like, what the long run is, how much cash it takes, and what happens if costs are higher, markets move together, news must be avoided, or payouts are refused.

CHAPTER 27

The maximum allocation per person

27.1 Firm by firm

Firm (tier)	Per-person limit	Copying between accounts	Market	Recommended	EV/month	Full allowance	EV/month
FTMO (A)	$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included	your own accounts, within the cap	Nasdaq	4×100K	$10,897	4×100K	$10,897
FundingPips (A)	$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts	your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services	USDJPY	4×100K	$7,914	4×100K	$7,914
The5ers (A)	one 50K or 100K account across Classic and New together; New also 3 × 2.5K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 10K and 1 × 25K (Classic's own small slots not used: fees not readable)	your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K	$3,038	1×100K, 1×25K, 3×10K, 3×5K, 3×2.5K	$5,195
FXIFY (A)	one active account of each size	between your own FXIFY accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	$4,661	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	$4,661
FundedNext (A)	$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account	EURUSD	1×200K	$2,439	1×200K	$2,439
Fintokei (B)	€500,000 of accounts	your own trades across your own accounts	Nasdaq	5×100K	$13,391	5×100K	$13,391
Hola Prime (B)	$500,000	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms	gold	2×100K	$4,900	2×100K	$4,900
Alpha Capital (D)	$400,000 per household, $300,000 per strategy	from your own external accounts with proof	Nasdaq	1×200K	$5,912	1×200K, 1×100K	$8,775
FunderPro (D)	$200,000	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	$4,606	1×200K	$4,606
GFT (D)	$400,000 funded	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	$4,123	1×200K	$4,123
BrightFunded (D)	$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	allowed between your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	$4,594	4×100K	$9,247
Blue Guardian (D)	$400,000; evaluations up to $200,000 each	your own accounts only	Nasdaq	1×200K	$4,589	4×100K	$9,205
Maven (D)	$200,000; at most $10,000 of profit closed per rolling 30 days per person	–	Nasdaq	1×100K	$1,461	1×100K	$1,461
Topstep (A)	5 Express Funded Accounts at once	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	5×50K	$4,389
Apex (B)	20 funded accounts	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	20×50K	$5,852
Total, CFD firms					**$72,523**		**$86,812**

EV per month: each account's long-run rate as a continuing slot (8.3; its programme chapter), summed. A firm whose programme is not worth it under the plan's policies has no accounts. The full-allowance column includes The5ers' optional small accounts. It is the largest allocation the plan models under each firm's limit and copying rule; at GFT and FundedNext, whose rules forbid duplicated trades between their own funded accounts, a second account on a market of its own (within GFT's $400,000 and FundedNext's $300,000) is not modelled. Futures (Topstep, Apex) are an optional layer, not in either total.

27.2 Four 100K accounts or two 200K?

Scale every dollar amount of a programme by λ (account, targets, limits, risk, payout target, safety margins). The engine's rules then scale exactly: every trade's win, loss and cost scale by λ, the pass probabilities and the time are unchanged, and the funded account's trading cash scales by λ. The fee need not scale, and the refund follows the fee actually paid. Writing $G(S)$ for the funded cash *excluding* the refund, $R(S)$ for the refund and q_R for the chance of reaching the payout that carries it (given a pass):

SCALING AN ACCOUNT (RULES THAT SCALE)

$$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P\big[\lambda\, G(S) + q_R\, R(\lambda S)\big] - F(\lambda S), \qquad \mathbb{E}[T](\lambda S) = \mathbb{E}[T](S).$$

With $R = F$, one account of size λS is worth more than λ accounts of size S by $\big[\lambda F(S) - F(\lambda S)\big](1 - P\, q_R)$ per attempt: the fee saving, less the part of it that would have come back as a refund. (Version 6's formula scaled the refund with the account; it does not.) The formula does not apply where a rule is a fixed dollar amount: GFT's $3,000 day cap and $10,000 payout cap, Maven's $5,000 threshold (the plan's $4,900 ceiling) and $10,000 rolling cap, the minimum payouts ($50 to $150), and whole futures contracts; and since version 9 it holds only up to rounding, because volumes are whole 0.01-lot steps and a filler trade is 0.01 lot at any size. Chapter 11 measures the scaling path by path on the same seeds, once with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee (the rules) and once with the real fee (the contracts).

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K − 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
FTMO 2-Step	$607.82	$1,215.65	$0.00	$5,307	$5,297	−$10
FundedNext Stellar	$549.99	$1,049.99	−$49.99	$2,853	$2,991	+$138

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K − 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
Fintokei ProTrader	$549.00	$1,249.00	$151.00	$5,447	$5,354	−$92
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	$497.00	$997.00	$3.00	$5,240	$5,289	+$49
FunderPro Classic	$539.00	$989.00	−$89.00	$5,028	$5,215	+$187
GFT Standard	$524.00	$974.00	−$74.00	$4,327	$3,787	−$540
BrightFunded Classic	$559.42	$1,122.22	$3.38	$4,553	$4,532	−$21
Blue Guardian 2-Step	$579.00	$1,162.00	$4.00	$4,143	$4,239	+$96

Random-start ratios of the same setting scaled, on the same sixteen paths and random numbers. Where every rule scales with the account, the only differences are the fee and the refund that follows it, up to the rounding of whole lots and the 0.01-lot filler trades, which do not scale (11.1 measures the scaling path by path); GFT's flat $3,000 day cap and $10,000 payout cap do not scale.

The answer, firm by firm. With the corrected formula of 27.2, 200K beats 2 × 100K exactly when $F(2S) < 2F(S)$, by $(2F(S) - F(2S))(1 - Pq_R)$ per attempt, unless a rule fails to scale. Where the plan holds one account (FunderPro, whose $200,000 cap allows one 200K; GFT and FundedNext, which forbid duplicated trades between their own funded accounts, so a second account would need a market no other account of the firm trades), the larger size is used if it is worth more than one smaller account. GFT is the case where the formula fails: its $3,000 day cap and $10,000 payout cap bind harder at 200K, so one 200K account is worth less than two 100K accounts would be; two GFT accounts on the same trades are not allowed, and one 200K account is still worth more than one 100K account.

FTMO, 4 × 100K or 2 × 200K. Same fee per dollar, same rules: the paired difference on the same 1,200 seeds is +$124 ± $167 a month for the whole portfolio. In the model the four 100K accounts copy the same trades, so four 100K accounts and two 200K accounts (both $400,000) bring in equal cash, up to the rounding of whole lots (10.1): neither is smoother. Two accounts make half as many payout requests, which matters only if refusals are a per-request risk (Chapter 29). The plan uses four 100K accounts for the headline.

CHAPTER 28

Running every account at once

28.1 What adds up and what does not

By linearity (2.1), the expected cash of a set of slots over a horizon is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, under the policy actually run, however correlated the accounts are. Correlation changes the spread: in a bad week every Nasdaq account loses together, fees fall due together, and a finite budget can run short together.

28.2 One direction per market

No two of your accounts ever hold opposite positions on one market at the same time. When a new trade opens and another of your accounts already holds that market, the new trade takes the same direction; when none does, the plan's rule decides (the sign of the last five hourly closes). The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is to keep every account on one side.

28.3 The lockstep simulation

The portfolio results come from an engine that runs every account of one person on shared price paths and one calendar (lockstep.py). Every event, a trade's entry or a purchase, is processed in the order of its time; a position counts as open until its actual exit (the end of its exit minute), not until its account may trade again, so the shared-direction rule copies only positions really held (version 8 kept a closed position "open" for up to an hour longer: review of version 8, finding 11). Every firm's rules (with the plan's policies) apply to its own accounts, and every fee, credit, phase result and payout is written to a dated ledger. The settings were frozen before any portfolio run, and each simulated life runs on its own new paths (path numbers 100,000 and up, each market its own stream, 3.3), used by nothing else; version 7's market offsets made one life's yen path another life's Nasdaq path, which version 8 removes. Lives are therefore independent and their average is an unbiased estimate with an ordinary interval. In 8,400 simulated years, no two accounts held opposite positions.

28.4 The portfolios: the first year

Portfolio	Accounts	Firms	First year, EV/month (95%)	Months 2–12	Sum of long-run rates	First-year cash p5	median	p95	Lowest cumulative cash: median
Tier A only	15	5	$24,078 ± $948	$27,521	$28,948	$4,211	$271,356	$653,422	−$26,999
Tiers A and B	22	7	$40,249 ± $1,477	$45,669	$47,239	$56,450	$435,941	$1,084,033	−$39,479
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	**28**	**13**	**$60,714 ± $2,251**	**$68,972**	**$72,523**	**$94,501**	**$665,386**	**$1,647,738**	**−$54,315**
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	26	13	$60,838 ± $2,258	$69,107	$72,591	$88,981	$666,178	$1,647,702	−$54,388
Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled)	35	13	$69,885 ± $2,685	$79,480	$84,654	$86,008	$755,283	$1,894,294	−$64,826
Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts	45	13	$71,804 ± $2,759	$81,669	$86,812	$62,561	$774,763	$1,946,589	−$66,366
Recommended + futures layer	53	15	$67,882 ± $2,536	$77,078	$82,764	$92,007	$736,379	$1,839,872	−$64,552

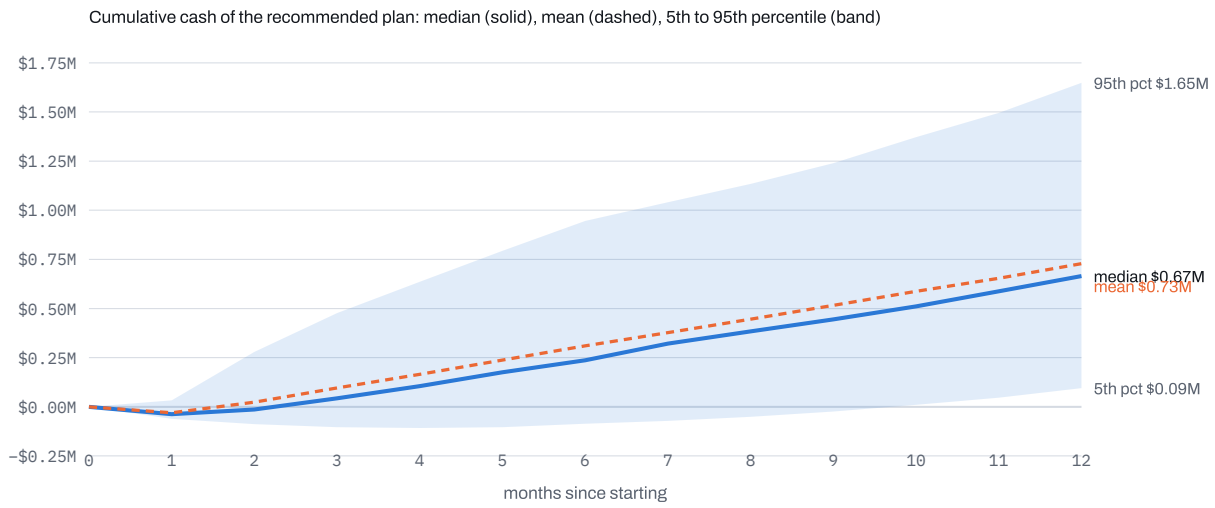
1,200 simulated first years per portfolio, each on its own new price paths (seeds from 100,000; the same seeds for every portfolio, so differences are paired). First year: total cash over 12 months ÷ 12, after every fee modelled. Sum of long-run rates: the accounts' continuing-slot rates from Part II (8.3), a different quantity (8.5). Lowest cumulative cash: the deepest point of fees paid minus cash received.

Three quantities. The recommended portfolio's first year averages $60,714 a month (±$2,251); months 2–12 average $68,972; the sum of its accounts' long-run rates is $72,523. They answer different questions (8.5), and Section 28.6 measures the long-run rate of the portfolio itself. 97.4% of simulated first years ended ahead; the 5th percentile of first-year cash is $94,501.

No account ever opposed another. In 8,400 simulated years the engine recorded 0 moments when two accounts held opposite positions on one market. The recommended plan places about 70 orders a trading day across all accounts.

Paired differences (same seeds, 95%): Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled) minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +$9,171 ± $578; Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts minus Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled): +$1,919 ± $441; Recommended + futures layer minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +$7,168 ± $976; Tiers A and B minus Tier A only: +$16,171 ± $917; Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm) minus Tiers A and B: +$20,465 ± $1,406.

28.5 Month by month



1,200 simulated first years of the recommended plan (28 accounts), each on its own paths. Cash = payouts received minus fees paid.

Month	Mean cash	p10	median	p90	Cumulative mean	Ahead
1	−$30,119	−$55,421	−$37,959	−$4,782	−$30,119	9%
2	$54,094	−$34,247	$18,806	$195,513	$23,974	44%
3	$72,114	−$29,650	$36,279	$228,400	$96,088	63%
4	$69,246	−$30,933	$36,319	$213,558	$165,334	75%
5	$72,423	−$27,996	$35,343	$217,265	$237,757	81%
6	$72,862	−$29,580	$35,366	$225,011	$310,619	87%
7	$67,004	−$27,775	$29,548	$210,633	$377,623	89%
8	$67,841	−$26,152	$33,943	$213,586	$445,464	92%
9	$70,183	−$29,169	$34,119	$216,672	$515,647	94%
10	$71,339	−$29,500	$36,527	$220,840	$586,986	95%
11	$66,831	−$29,048	$30,011	$218,159	$653,817	97%
12	$74,752	−$27,719	$33,002	$234,164	$728,569	97%

28.6 The long run, and what is left at month 12

Period (36-month lives)	Average cash per month (95%)
months 1–12	$63,108 ± $2,644
months 13–24	$72,984 ± $2,762
months 25–36	$70,978 ± $2,710
month 12 alone	$73,839 ± $8,031
months 11 and 13	$73,411 and $75,548

800 simulated 36-month lives of the recommended plan, each on its own new paths (path numbers 300,000 and up).

Months 13–36. They average $71,981 ± $1,931 a month. That is a finite-window estimate, not by itself the asymptotic rate. Its two annual windows differ by +$2,006 ± $3,877 a month (months 13–24 minus 25–36, paired over the same lives, 95%): no measurable trend, so the window average is read as an estimate of the long-run rate. The sum of the accounts' long-run rates from Part II (continuing slots, each account alone) is $72,523 ± $5,189, its interval computed from the per-path totals of all the portfolio's programmes, which share their paths; the window average is $542 lower (0.2 combined standard errors, the two estimates being independent). The sum is not a selection-free estimate: the same continuing-slot figures chose between each firm's programmes, markets and sizes, so it carries a little winner's bias; the portfolio lives run on fresh paths and carry none. The first year is lower ($63,108) because it carries the start-up: fees at once, payouts later. Firm by firm, inside the portfolio (months 13–36) against each account's continuing-slot rate alone: Fintokei $14,143 ± $701 against $13,391; FTMO $9,768 ± $518 against $10,897; FundingPips $9,618 ± $485 against $7,914; Alpha Capital $5,232 ± $238 against $5,912; Hola Prime $4,821 ± $237 against $4,900; FXIFY $3,959 ± $206 against $4,661; FunderPro $5,148 ± $258 against $4,606; BrightFunded $4,341 ± $263 against $4,594; Blue Guardian $3,954 ± $204 against $4,589; GFT $3,927 ± $146 against $4,123; The5ers $2,853 ± $125 against $3,038; FundedNext $2,791 ± $191 against $2,439; Maven $1,427 ± $52 against $1,461. Inside the portfolio an account copies the direction of any position already open in its market, so its trades differ from those of the slot alone; the two need not agree beyond sampling error. **Value of the accounts open at month 12**: the cash those accounts (evaluations in progress and funded accounts) go on to pay after month 12 averages $168,355 (±$12,509); it belongs to the first year's purchases but arrives later.

Each firm alone, on the same paths. On the first 200 of these lives, every firm's accounts were also run alone, on the same paths and calendar. This is a comparison of two policies, not a test of linearity: alone, a firm's account chooses its own direction where in the portfolio it copies the direction of an account already open, so the trades differ. Full portfolio minus the sum of the firms alone: +$1,724 ± $2,517 a month over months 13–36 and +$3,661 ± $3,570 in the first year (paired, 95%). Running the accounts together changes the result measurably. On those same paths the firms alone average $73,811 a month, against the sum of their long-run rates in Part II of $72,523: every account on the Nasdaq trades the same path, largely in the same direction, so their sampling errors move together and a sample of a few hundred lives can sit some thousands of dollars from the expectation.

28.7 Finite cash, higher costs, correlation, news and behaviour

A finite budget. The first-year figures assume every slot is refilled the moment its attempt ends, which needs cash for fees before payouts arrive. Version 6 quoted the median of the deepest cash shortfall as if it kept every slot filled; half of all years need more. Here the plan is run with a fixed starting budget instead. A purchase is an event at its own time: it is paid from the cash dated at or before it (the starting cash, less earlier purchases, plus payouts received by then), and otherwise waits a day at a time. Version 8 let a purchase made while processing a later event use a payout dated after an earlier purchase, so five of its 1,400 budget lives went below zero on the dated ledger while its wallet reported a positive minimum (review of version 8, finding 1); every budget life now asserts that its dated cash never falls below zero.

Starting cash	First year, EV/month	of unlimited	Evaluations bought in the year	Ahead at 12 months	First-year cash p5	Lowest cash left (mean)
$5,000	$13,612 ± $4,409	23%	103	21%	−$4,981	$18
$10,000	$17,168 ± $5,046	28%	139	26%	−$9,986	$23
$20,000	$31,474 ± $6,039	52%	253	48%	−$19,998	$40
$30,000	$36,670 ± $6,208	61%	308	56%	−$29,991	$600
$50,000	$48,008 ± $6,418	80%	393	74%	−$49,995	$5,787
$75,000	$55,467 ± $6,188	92%	474	88%	−$74,984	$19,331
$100,000	$58,007 ± $6,114	96%	498	92%	−$99,957	$38,175
unlimited	$60,292 ± $5,821	100%	523	96%	$60,717	–

The recommended plan with a finite budget. Every purchase is an event at its own time, processed in time order with every trade: it is paid from the cash dated at or before it (the starting cash, less earlier purchases, plus payouts received by then), and otherwise waits a day at a time (version 9; version 8 let a purchase use a payout dated after it: review of version 8, finding 1). The cash dated by the ledger never falls below zero in any life (asserted in every run; lowest $0.04). Slots are filled in order of value per fee dollar. 200 lives per row, same seeds in every row.

Other scenarios, each a full portfolio run on the baseline's seeds. The news-hours row is a stylised sensitivity (6.5), not a bound.

Scenario (recommended plan)	First year, EV/month	Paired difference to baseline	First-year cash p5	Lowest cumulative cash p5
Baseline (same 200 seeds)	$60,292 ± $5,821		$60,717	−$133,387
All trading costs × 1.5	$50,674 ± $5,615	−$9,619 ± $2,566	−$30,796	−$175,475
All trading costs × 2	$42,808 ± $5,328	−$17,484 ± $2,612	−$80,117	−$181,615
Markets correlated 0.3 (one joint path)	$61,221 ± $5,552	+$929 ± $7,500	$23,818	−$128,961
News proxy: flat 12:00–14:00 UTC every weekday	$55,115 ± $5,125	−$5,178 ± $4,434	$82,646	−$144,214
FundedNext 1% risk (behavioural remedy)	$59,170 ± $5,829	−$1,122 ± $452	$43,159	−$152,353
FundedNext 7-day pause (behavioural remedy)	$59,853 ± $5,770	−$439 ± $432	$47,483	−$148,156

Full portfolio runs, 200 lives each on the baseline's seeds (paired). The correlated run uses joint paths, so its pairing is by seed only.

CHAPTER 29

If payouts can be refused

Every firm keeps the right to refuse a payout it judges to break its rules. Nobody publishes how often it happens. This chapter turns that uncertainty into scenarios; it does not cover payouts lost because a firm judges the strategy itself to break a behavioural rule (Chapter 31.2), which would not be random.

29.1 A model

Suppose each payout request at a firm is refused with probability ϕ, independently, and a refusal ends your use of that firm. The number of paid requests before the first refusal is geometric, with mean $(1-\phi)/\phi$. If the firm's requests arrive as a Poisson process at rate r a month (an assumption made for this illustration only), each of gross size a, the expected cash actually paid over H months is

PAID CASH UNDER REFUSALS

$$a\,r\,(1-\phi)\,\frac{1-e^{-\phi r H}}{\phi r} \;=\; a\,r\,H \times (1-\phi)\,\frac{1-e^{-\phi r H}}{\phi r H},$$

the all-paid cash arH times the average survival fraction *and* the factor $(1-\phi)$: the refused request itself is not paid. For n requests on a fixed schedule instead, the expected paid amount is $a\,(1-\phi)\left[1-(1-\phi)^{n}\right]/\phi$. Neither formula is used for the figures below: the simulation applies the refusals to each life's actual dated payout requests. Fees paid while the firm is still used count against the paid cash. In the recommended plan the FTMO accounts together make about 0.99 requests a month: at $\phi = 2\%$, FTMO is expected to last $1/(0.02 \times 0.99) = 50$ months.

29.2 Tiers and scenarios

Tier	Evidence (4 October 2026)	Firms	Refusal chance per request: tiered	harsh
A	PropFirmMap A/A+, TrustPilot profile active	FTMO, FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, FundedNext, Topstep	2%	5%
B	PropFirmMap B+, TrustPilot active	Fintokei, Hola Prime, Apex	5%	10%
D	TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews; PropFirmMap D	Alpha Capital, FunderPro, GFT, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, Maven	15%	30%

Chosen scenarios, not measurements: public ratings do not calibrate refusal rates.

29.3 What it does to each portfolio

Portfolio	All payouts honoured	Tiered	kept	Harsh	kept
Tier A only	$24,078	$20,179	84%	$15,686	65%
Tiers A and B	$40,249	$30,036	75%	$22,004	55%
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	**$60,714**	**$41,579**	**68%**	**$27,820**	**46%**
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	$60,838	$42,307	70%	$29,316	48%
Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled)	$69,885	$40,635	58%	$25,383	36%
Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts	$71,804	$41,129	57%	$24,874	35%
Recommended + futures layer	$67,882	$42,238	62%	$27,435	40%

First-year average per month. Each payout request is refused with its firm's probability; the refused payout is not paid, and the person stops using that firm (no more fees or payouts there). Ten draws of refusals per simulated year.

Firm	Tier	Payout requests a month	Average request	Net cash a month	Expected months until a refusal (tiered)
FTMO	A	0.99	$12,186	$8,022	50
FundingPips	A	0.93	$11,257	$8,096	54
The5ers	A	0.25	$13,312	$2,504	198
FXIFY	A	0.77	$5,788	$2,922	65
FundedNext	A	0.17	$24,452	$2,366	297
Fintokei	B	1.09	$15,781	$12,114	18
Hola Prime	B	0.54	$11,685	$4,289	37
Alpha Capital	D	0.29	$21,523	$4,589	23
FunderPro	D	0.25	$25,862	$4,703	27
GFT	D	0.59	$7,665	$3,219	11
BrightFunded	D	0.16	$33,750	$3,420	43
Blue Guardian	D	0.28	$19,258	$3,348	24
Maven	D	0.54	$3,148	$1,123	12

Recommended plan, first-year averages from the portfolio simulation.

The recommended plan's accounts make about 6.8 payout requests a month. In the tiered scenario it keeps 68% of its first-year value, in the harsh one 46%. Under the 40% policy requests are smaller and more frequent than in version 6, so each firm is exposed to more requests; the scenarios price that.

PART IV

Running it

The settings of every account in one place, the routine that runs them, and everything that could make the numbers wrong.

CHAPTER 30

The routine

30.1 Every account's settings

Programme	Accounts	Market	Risk per trade	Stop	Size	k	Payout target	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	4 × 100K	Nasdaq	$1,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	17.63 lots	8	$30,000	$10,897
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	4 × 100K	USDJPY	$1,750	1.25 σ = 23.5 pips	11.73 lots	6	$20,000	$7,914
The5ers HS	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	$1,750	0.75 σ = 63.8 points	27.43 lots	12	$20,000	$3,038
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	$1,750	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	19.23 lots	3	$15,000	$2,609
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 50K	Nasdaq	$875	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	9.61 lots	3	$7,500	$1,194
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 25K	Nasdaq	$438	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	4.80 lots	3	$3,750	$558
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 10K	Nasdaq	$175	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	1.92 lots	3	$1,500	$212
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 5K	Nasdaq	$88	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	0.96 lots	3	$750	$87
FundedNext Stellar	1 × 200K	EURUSD	$3,500	1 σ = 9.6 pips	36.47 lots	6	$40,000	$2,439
Fintokei ProTrader	5 × 100K	Nasdaq	$1,500	0.75 σ = 63.8 points	23.51 lots	12	$30,000	$13,391
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	2 × 100K	gold	$1,750	1.03 σ = 12.2 dollars	1.43 lots	7	$20,000	$4,900
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	$3,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	41.15 lots	6	$40,000	$5,912
FunderPro Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	$3,000	0.92 σ = 78.2 points	38.34 lots	6	$60,000	$4,606
GFT Standard	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	$3,500	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	38.46 lots	3	$20,000	$4,123
BrightFunded Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	$3,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	41.15 lots	3.5	$60,000	$4,594
Blue Guardian 2-Step	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	$3,500	1.25 σ = 106.3 points	32.92 lots	12	$30,000	$4,589
Maven 2-Step	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	$1,750	1.25 σ = 106.3 points	16.46 lots	2	$4,900	$1,461

Stops in points (Nasdaq), pips (USDJPY, EURUSD) or dollars (gold) at the prices of 2 October 2026; recompute $m\sigma\times$price weekly and re-measure σ monthly. The take-profit is the smallest of k times the risk, the distance to the current target, 40% of the current target less today's profit, and any firm cap, plus the cost (4.1).

30.2 Placing a trade, step by step

1. **Is a trade allowed now?** Weekdays, inside the market's entry hours and not from 19:00 UTC onward; not before 00:05 UTC (after the midnight resets); no restricted news window for this firm, stage and market coming up before the trade could reasonably end (use the firm's own calendar); at least 10 minutes since this account's last close, whatever its result and direction (Hola Prime groups any re-entry within 10 minutes; FundingPips groups trade ideas).
2. **Direction.** If any of your accounts holds this market, the same direction. Otherwise the plan's rule: long if the last hourly close is above the close five hours earlier, short if below. The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is that no two of your accounts are ever opposite.
3. **Room.** Floor room $= (\text{balance} - \text{floor} - \$100 \text{ per } \$100\text{K})/(1+\rho)$; day room $= (\text{daily limit} - \text{today's loss} - \$200 \text{ per } \$100\text{K})/(1+\rho)$; margin room $= 0.6\,\lambda\,m\sigma \times$ balance. If the floor room is under a tenth of the normal risk, **trade the rest**: the largest volume whose stop at the plan's distance fits the room between the balance and the floor (at least 0.01 lot, or one contract), with its stop order placed at the floor level itself, so that a loss ends exactly at the floor (if today's room is smaller than the floor room, a normal stop inside today's room instead). It either recovers or ends the account in a breach, which frees its allocation; buy the replacement only then. If only the day room is short, wait until tomorrow.
4. **Risk.** l = the smallest of the plan's risk and the three rooms. **Stop**: $m\sigma\times$ price; size $= l/$ (stop in points $\times$ dollars per point per lot), rounded down to the volume step (0.01 lot; whole contracts on futures, never fewer than one: if one contract at this stop risks more than l, trade one contract if the floor and day rooms allow it).
5. **Take-profit.** w = the smaller of $k\,l$ and the distance to the current target (or today's profitable-day target), but never a take-profit closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations (finishing a little above a target is fine); then capped by 40% of the current target less today's profit (the whole calendar day's, including any made before a payout request today) and any firm cap (FXIFY 25% of the payout target per day less $1 per $100K, GFT's $3,000 a day less today's profit, Maven: the distance to $4,900 of funded profit less $550 per $100K for each profitable day the cycle still needs after today, and for today as well if this win would leave today short of +0.5%, and the distance to $10,000 of closed profit in any 30 days). If a cap leaves less than the minimum distance: with nothing made today, lower the risk until the cap is a full minimum-distance win; otherwise no further trade today. At Maven, if $w < 1.5\,l$, lower l to $w/1.5$ (on the last trade of step 3, raise the target to 1.5 times the room instead). Place the take-profit for the win w at the rounded volume: distance $= (w+c)/$(volume $\times$ dollars per point per lot).
6. **Place one bracket order**; never move it. **At Blue Guardian**, whose minimum holding time is 2 minutes: open with an emergency stop at the account's breach level only, and place the bracket 3 minutes after the entry; if by then the price is already beyond the stop or the take-profit, close at the market. **At 20:00 UTC close everything still open.**
7. **Log it**: time, account, market, direction, size, stop, target, fill, and the closing reason. The log is the evidence for any review.

30.3 Phases, payouts and refills

- When a phase target (plus $20 per $100K) is reached: stop. Where the firm counts trading days and accepts any opened position, place one minimal trade (0.01 lot, one contract on futures) on each of the next trading days not yet traded, at the day's first permitted hour, with an emergency stop at the account's breach level, and close it at the market after 3 minutes; if a filler's loss takes the balance under the firm's target, resume normal trading. At Fintokei and Alpha Capital, which object to minimal trades, no fillers: the 40% policy already needs three winning days per phase, and missing days are traded with ordinary trades, one a day. Where the firm counts profitable days, the daily target of 6.4 has met it.

- When a funded account reaches its payout target: stop, request the payout on the first allowed day (counted from the account's first trade), withdraw everything above the start, and start the next cycle. At Alpha Capital the first request also needs five trading days: until then trade at most once a day, past the target if needed. At Fintokei every request needs three trading days in the cycle (ordinary trades, one a day, if days are missing; no fillers) and comes at least 14 days after the previous payout was processed. At Hola Prime the three profitable days must fall within the 14 days before the request.
- When a payout date arrives before the target is reached, request whatever profit the account holds, if the firm's minimum (FundingPips 1% of the account; FXIFY $50; Fintokei, GFT, FunderPro, Blue Guardian, Alpha $100; The5ers $150) and its consistency and day rules allow it (FXIFY: no day above 25% of it; profitable days at FundingPips 95%, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven, Blue Guardian), and start the next cycle; if a rule does not allow it, keep trading toward a target large enough for the rule to hold.
- When an account fails (a breach, including the last trade of step 3): buy the next evaluation of the same programme (at FundedNext, after a pause if its gambling indicators are a concern: 28.7). Every account ends in a breach or in normal trading; none is left open and unused.
- Credits (The5ers) are spent on the next evaluation at that firm.

30.4 Cash needed

Fees are paid before payouts arrive. In the simulation the running total of the recommended plan falls to −$54,315 at its lowest in a typical first year, −$150,867 in the worst 5% and −$194,983 in the worst 1%. These are not amounts that keep every slot filled in every year: Section 28.7 runs the plan with fixed budgets, each purchase paid only from cash already received, and shows what each budget gives.

30.5 Workload

About 70 bracket orders a trading day across 28 accounts, a daily close-out at 20:00 UTC, payout requests and evaluation purchases.

CHAPTER 31

What could make the numbers wrong

31.1 Higher trading costs

Programme	Market	EV/month: cost × 1	× 1.5	× 2	Days per attempt × 1	× 2
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	$2,263	$2,015	$1,778	19.0	17.5
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	$2,521	$2,239	$1,970	27.6	25.1
The5ers HS	Nasdaq	$2,750	$2,136	$1,945	16.8	15.3
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	$2,132	$1,731	$1,488	27.7	25.6
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	$1,346	$792	$195	19.1	15.5
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	$2,672	$2,083	$1,963	17.5	16.0
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	$1,925	$1,789	$1,216	18.0	16.5
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	$2,380	$2,160	$1,954	18.3	17.2
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	$2,633	$1,985	$1,799	18.5	17.2
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	$2,221	$1,992	$1,632	22.1	20.1
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	$2,049	$1,601	$1,441	19.1	17.9
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	$1,951	$1,579	$1,555	19.0	18.2
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	$1,411	$1,255	$1,237	25.6	24.3

One 100K account at the plan's setting, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per cell, the same random numbers in each row. Higher costs lower the value of an attempt and also shorten attempts (more fail, sooner), which is why a value per month can fall less than proportionally.

For the whole recommended portfolio, full portfolio runs (not ratios) give $50,674 a month at 1.5 times the costs and $42,808 at twice, against $60,292 for the same 200 lives at the assumed costs (Section 28.7; the 1,200-life headline is $60,714, a larger sample of the same quantity). **Measure your real costs in the first week** and redo the settings if they differ from 3.1 by more than a quarter.

31.2 Behavioural rules the model cannot state

These rules are applied at the firm's discretion. The figures in this document assume the plan's trading is not judged to break them; if it is, the affected payouts are lost, which is not the same as the random refusals of Chapter 29:

- **FTMO**: gambling, "all-in" trading, account rolling; no gap trading within 2 hours of a close.
- **Fintokei**: reaching a target in one or a few identical trades; token trades and "much smaller trades ... just to meet the minimum 3-day trading requirement". The plan's three-winning-day minimum is its answer, and it places no filler trades at Fintokei.
- **The5ers**: one-trade target attainment (permanent ban). No trade makes more than 40% of a target.
- **FundedNext**: one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, several breached accounts in a short span (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split). Section 28.7 measures the remedies.
- **Hola Prime**: profitability "materially dependent on concentrated outcomes". **Alpha**: "all or nothing", risk or loss of 2% or more, trades under 2 minutes on average, minimal lots to pass trading days. **FXIFY**: gambling. **Blue Guardian**: margin above 80%, holding under 2 minutes (met by the 3-minute hold of step 6). **Other firms' fillers**: their day definitions count a day on which a position is opened and state no minimum volume; that a 0.01-lot trade for 3 minutes is accepted is an assumption, and Section 31.8 measures the plan without it. **Maven**: large bets at 1:1.25 or worse. The terminal trade of step 3 is a normal bracket at the plan's reward:risk with a small risk; a firm could still read a final trade sized to the floor as deliberate, which the model cannot price.

31.3 Payouts refused, accounts closed

Chapter 29: $41,579 a month if payouts are refused at 2/5/15% per request by tier, $27,820 at 5/10/30%.

31.4 Spreads, gaps and news

The engine's cost is an average. Spreads widen at the daily break (now outside the plan's hours), at the open and around news. The news-hours sensitivity of Section 28.7 is a stylised scenario, not a bound: the model has no news calendar.

31.5 Rules change

Every rule in Part II was read on 4 October 2026, from the pages listed in Appendix E; rules_snapshot_v9.json quotes the sentences used. Leverage, consistency rules, payout schedules, prices and per-person limits change often. Recheck before buying and rerun the programme's optimisation (optimize_v9.py) when a rule that enters the model changes.

31.6 The model itself

- **Zero skill, zero drift.** If entries are systematically late or fills worse, the edge is negative; the cost stress is the guide. A real trend in a market (the Nasdaq's long-run rise) is left out of the model (3.2); the plan's direction rule is symmetric, but over a given year a trend can favour or hurt it.

- **Markets move together.** The baseline gives gold, euro and yen independent paths; Section 28.7 measures a correlation of 0.3. Real correlations change and rise in crises.
- **Taxes and payment costs** are not modelled.

31.7 What is not allowed, and is not in the plan

No hedging across accounts or firms; no accounts in anyone else's name; no copy-trading services or other people's signals; no trading of restricted news windows; no tick scalping, latency or gap arbitrage; no grid or martingale sizing; no deliberately failed accounts. Do not share or sell the plan: several firms treat traders who run the same marketed strategy as a group.

31.8 Filler trades and holding times

Where a firm counts any day on which a position is opened, the plan completes missing trading days with 0.01-lot trades held 3 minutes (6.3). The firms' day definitions state no minimum volume, but none says in so many words that such a trade is welcome, and Fintokei objects to it; so the plan's value is also measured without fillers, missing days traded with ordinary trades of the plan, one a day. Blue Guardian's 3-minute hold is measured the same way.

Programme	Market	Variant	EV/month: plan	variant	Paired difference (95%)	Fillers per attempt (plan)
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,263	$2,144	−$119 ± $317	0.29
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	USDJPY	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,097	$2,153	+$56 ± $206	0.00
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	EURUSD	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,298	$1,420	+$121 ± $68	0.00
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,346	$1,165	−$181 ± $312	0.60
FundedNext Stellar	gold	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,208	$1,710	−$498 ± $293	0.73
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,132	$1,928	−$204 ± $383	0.38
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	USDJPY	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,154	$1,947	−$207 ± $488	0.35
FXIFY Classic (80%)	Nasdaq	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,641	$1,496	−$145 ± $88	0.35
FXIFY Classic (80%)	USDJPY	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,621	$1,436	−$185 ± $249	0.34
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,925	$2,066	+$142 ± $54	0.00
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	EURUSD	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$1,480	$1,366	−$114 ± $312	0.00
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,633	$2,228	−$405 ± $365	0.30
FunderPro Classic	USDJPY	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,537	$2,099	−$438 ± $481	0.30
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$2,049	$1,880	−$169 ± $240	0.67
Topstep 50K	MNQ	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$727	$764	+$37 ± $140	0.00
Apex 50K EOD	MNQ	ordinary trades instead of fillers	$273	$261	−$12 ± $59	0.00
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	no 3-minute hold (a trade under 2 minutes ends the account)	$1,951	$1,946	−$4 ± $9	–

One 100K account at the plan's setting, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per cell, the same random numbers in both cells of a row; the paired difference is over the four paths (Student t, 3 degrees of freedom).

APPENDIX A

Corrections: the version 8 review, point by point

A third detailed review, of version 8 (5 October 2026), raised 21 findings, with the repository at hand. Every rule finding was checked on the firms' own pages (rules_snapshot_v9.json quotes the sentences) and every model finding against the code and by rerunning the review's witnesses; 21 are agreed in full. Each fix is described with the test that checks it (tests_v9.py) and, where a result moved, the new figure. Fixing them uncovered the further errors of the second table.

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 8	What version 9 does
1	**The finite-budget simulation spent cash that had not arrived** AGREED	The portfolio engine processed trades in the order of their entry, but resolved each trade to its exit at once and let the account's generator run on: a purchase made while processing one account's later events could release a payout receipt dated after another account's earlier purchase, which then used that cash. The wallet's own minimum was positive while the cash dated by the ledger was not: five of the 1,400 budget lives went below zero, the worst ($10,000 budget, life 100,016) $6,971 below zero at hour 2,047, as the review reproduced.	Every purchase is now an event at its own time on the simulation's queue, processed in time order with the trades' entries; it is paid from the cash dated at or before it (starting cash, earlier purchases, payouts received by then) and otherwise waits a day at a time. The wallet asserts that it is used in time order, and every budget life asserts that the cash dated by its ledger never falls below zero. tests_v9.py reruns the review's witness life (100,016) and two others at $10,000 and $30,000. Over the 1,400 budget lives of version 9 the lowest cash dated by the ledger is $0.04. Monthly subscriptions and activation fees are not in the budget runs (the recommended plan has none; the code refuses them with a budget).
2	**The path generator's error bound was false** AGREED	Section 3.3 bounded the chance that independently drawn sub-step extremes misrepresent a bracket by exp(-W^2/v), arguing that the exponent is smallest with both end points at the middle. That holds only for a sub-step with no net move; with end points near opposite barriers the exponent is close to zero. The review's counterexample (l = 0, u = 1, a = 0.01, b = 0.99, v = 0.01) has independent-draw probability exp(-3.96) = 0.019 and exact probability exp(-4) = 0.0183, against the claimed bound of 3.7e-44. The 'about 2e-48 per trade' check and the claim of exactness within the bound were therefore unsupported.	A valid bound replaces it (pathfirm.bridge_err, Section 3.3). Given a sub-step's end points, the generator's outcome (no touch, stop, target) differs from the exact law in total variation by at most the chance that both barriers are touched under either law; the exact chance is at most twice the independent one (strong Markov property at the first touch), so the error is at most 3 P_ind. For a net move delta the largest P_ind over the starting point is exp(-(W^2 - delta^2)/v); the move is independent of where the sub-step starts and of whether the trade is still open, so each watched sub-step contributes at most G(r) = E[min(1, 3 exp(-(r^2 - Z^2)))], r = W/sqrt(v), which has a closed form and is close to exp(-r^2/2), the square root of the old figure. The engine adds G over every sub-step in which a trade watches both barriers. Over every chosen programme's final run the bound is at most 9.8e-11 per trade in the programme where it is largest, and 6.6e-05 summed over all 22,127,281 trades of every chosen programme's final run, futures included (3,505,683,472 watched sub-steps). tests_v9.py reproduces the counterexample with the exact two-barrier series and checks the strong-Markov bound on 4,000 random bridges. The fair-chance fallback for a sub-step touching both barriers stays; its effect lies inside this bound.
3	**Terminal trades did not enforce the account floor during the trade** AGREED	The floor entered a trade's size but not its path: a futures account with $100 above its floor traded one contract with a $170 stop, so a path that first went $110 against it and then $255 for it ended in a $255 win where the firm would have closed the account at $100. On CFDs a risk below $1 per $100K was rounded up to $1 and a loss clipped back to the floor afterwards, which changed the payoff (mean +$0.44 instead of -$0.03 in the review's example) without changing the chance of reaching the floor. tests_v8.py checked only end balances.	The account's breach level (the nearer of the floor and today's loss limit, cost included) is a barrier of every trade (pathfirm.resolve): reaching it ends the account at that moment, whatever the price does later. The terminal trade places its stop at that level itself, at the volume the smallest position allows, so the stop is a real order at the floor; a loss is no longer clipped anywhere. tests_v9.py reruns the review's futures witness (now a breach at -$100, against +$255 before) and 40,000 minimal-lot trades with $0.50 left, whose mean is zero within its interval and whose lowest result is exactly -$0.50. Rule test: 173 phase-1 failures; end P&L between -10000.000000 and -10000.000000 (floor -10000): each a breach of the floor barrier, nothing clipped.
4	**The CFD engine had no lots** AGREED	Only futures were whole contracts. A CFD position was the exact notional l/s, however small, and the $1 per $100K floor on the risk was not a lot size: the smallest real position's risk depends on the contract, the price and the stop distance.	Every market now trades whole volume steps at its contract size (pathfirm.LOTS): index CFDs one index unit a lot ($1 a point, FTMO's MT5 contract size for its index CFDs), gold 100 ounces, currency pairs 100,000 units, volumes from 0.01 lot in steps of 0.01; the micro Nasdaq future one contract at $2 a point. The volume is rounded down, never below the smallest position; the risk, the take-profit, the cost and the margin are computed from the rounded volume. A take-profit set by a cap keeps its amount (the price is set for exactly that win), so a target-landing trade still lands; otherwise the win scales with the rounded risk. The smallest position's risk enters the sizing rule wherever the plan's own risk would be smaller. In the final runs 240,447 of 22,127,281 trades (1.087%) were at the smallest volume. Other brokers' contract sizes change only the rounding.
5	**Filler days were calendar entries, not trades** AGREED	filler_days marked a missing day as traded and moved the clock on; no position, price, cost or result existed. Version 8 called these 'minimal filler trades' and relied on a $20 buffer to keep the target.	A filler is now a real position (pathfirm.resolve, kind 'filler'): 0.01 lot (one futures contract), opened at the day's first permitted hour, closed at the market after 3 minutes, with its cost, its result in the balance and the breach barrier of finding 3; the day counts only if the firm's day definition is met (BrightFunded: held 60 seconds). If a filler's loss takes the balance under the firm's target, ordinary trading resumes. The $20 per $100K margin stays as a plan choice. Over every chosen programme's final run (624,000 attempts) the engine placed 104,132 filler trades, with a total result of –$11,200.17; replacing them with ordinary trades changes the value per month by –$498 to +$142 across the 16 programmes that use them (Chapter 31.8).
6	**'Fewer than 1 in 1,000 within two minutes' was false** AGREED	For a driftless Brownian motion a one-sided level 0.6 hourly sd away is touched within 2 minutes with probability erfc(0.6 sqrt(15)) = 0.1015%, above 0.1%, and a bracket with both levels at 0.6 sd is closed within 2 minutes with probability about 0.203%. The distance floor was presented as a universal guarantee; an observed low share of short trades is a different statement.	The claim is withdrawn everywhere. The 0.6 sd minimum distance stays as a plan choice (it keeps costs a fair description), with the exact two-barrier probabilities of a close within 2 minutes stated for each chosen setting and the measured share of trades that may have lasted under 2 minutes reported separately. Where a firm has a duration rule it is now met by construction or checked on the account's own trades (finding 7). Exact chance (driftless Brownian motion) that a bracket of a chosen setting closes within 2 minutes: 0.102% to 0.105% with the take-profit at the minimum distance, at most 0.0040% at the full k m. Measured in the final runs: 375 of 21,278,025 trades (0.002%) may have closed within 2 minutes (the most in one programme: 0.008%, The5ers HS); the shortest programme average is 95 minutes, and at most 0.006% of any programme's gross profit came from such trades. These are observations, not a guarantee; the firms with duration rules are handled by 7 and 11.
7	**Duration rules were not enforced where they apply** AGREED	Blue Guardian states a 2-minute minimum holding time; Alpha Capital assesses each account's average duration, the majority of its trades and the share of its gross profit from trades over 2 minutes, with a restart (evaluation) or the removal of profits (qualified account) on failure; BrightFunded counts a trading day only if a position on it was open 60 seconds. Version 8 had no per-firm handling: a global short-trade count, a distance argument (finding 6), and BrightFunded days counted after every trade.	Blue Guardian: the plan places the bracket only after 3 minutes (hold_min); until then only the breach level can close the position, and at 3 minutes it is closed at the market if the price is already beyond the stop or the target; a trade that could still close sooner (only a breach can) is treated as ending the account. Alpha Capital: the rule is checked on the account's own trades at every phase pass and payout request, with the firm's consequences applied (dur_rule; durations are lower bounds). BrightFunded: a day counts only if a trade on it was held at least one minute. In the final runs the duration consequences fired 0 times at Alpha's phases, 0 times at its funded accounts and 0 times at Blue Guardian; 35 of Blue Guardian's 720,275 trades were closed at the end of the hold. The engine reports 'no violation by construction' (Blue Guardian), 'checked, consequence applied' (Alpha) and 'counted by the firm's definition' (BrightFunded) separately.
8	**Fintokei's filler permission was not established** AGREED	Fintokei's all-in article objects to 'much smaller trades … just to meet the minimum 3-day trading requirement', and its trading-day definition requires an executed trade with a real market outcome. Version 8's rule table called token trades prohibited while its engine description said 'fillers allowed', and its response inferred permission from the day definition.	No filler trades at Fintokei (no_fillers). The plan's 40% concentration policy already needs three winning days per phase, so a phase never needs one; a funded cycle short of its 3 trading days collects them with ordinary trades of the plan, one a day. Alpha Capital, which forbids minimal lots on qualified accounts, is treated the same way in its evaluations too. The other firms' fillers rest on their day definitions (a day on which a position is opened; no minimum volume stated), an assumption the no-filler sensitivity measures. Fintokei's final run places 0 filler trades; its value is $2,723 ± $313 a month (random-start), against version 8's $2,877.

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 8	What version 9 does
9	**Hola Prime's 14-day window was absent** AGREED	The bi-weekly payout needs three profitable days (+0.5% of the initial balance) within a 14-day period; the engine counted them since the last payout, and a cycle can last longer than 14 days. The review's controlled run (profitable days 0, 22 and 23) was paid on day 23.8.	The engine keeps the dates of the cycle's profitable days and counts those within the 14 calendar days ending on the request day (profit_days_window); the daily profit target of 6.4 is recomputed as old days leave the window. tests_v9.py reruns the review's witness: no payout; with the days moved to 15, 22 and 23, a payout. Hola Prime on gold: $2,385 ± $193 a month (version 8: $2,413); Hola Prime on EURUSD: $1,317 ± $142 a month (version 8: $1,343).
10	**Fintokei's recurring payout clock ran from the request** AGREED	Fintokei allows a withdrawal 14 days after the last successfully processed payout; version 8 set the next date 14 days after the request and dated the cash one day later, so a request could come 13 days after the previous payout's processing.	Request, processing and receipt are separate times: the cash arrives after the firm's processing time in working days, and at Fintokei the next request is allowed 14 days after that (cycle_from_processed). The plan assumes the standard (not instant) method, one working day. tests_v9.py checks every later Fintokei request: 121 later Fintokei requests: shortest time from the previous payout's processing 14.00 days.
11	**The portfolio kept a closed position open until its next entry** AGREED	The resolver returned the hours until another entry may be considered (rounded to the hour, plus an hour after a late exit), and the portfolio stored that as the position's exit: a bracket closed at minute 55 counted as open for another hour, and another account could copy its direction. Maven's rolling 30-day window dated closed profit by the same next-entry time.	The resolver returns the exit time (the end of the exit minute) separately from the next permitted entry. Exposure (the shared-direction rule), Maven's dated closed profit and every day attribution use the exit; only the next entry uses the 10-minute rule. tests_v9.py checks every trade of a life with 10,886 trades: each copied direction comes from a position still open at the entry and no uncopied entry had one open. All portfolio runs were repeated.
12	**Part II's 'stationary long-run rate' was not what the estimator measured** AGREED	optimize_v8.run starts every attempt with a new trader at a random point of a path and at a random hour, with no state carried over and with a random direction, while the text described a Markov renewal estimate under the stationary start-state distribution with credits and windows carried. Random starts are not that distribution, and the continuing strategy uses the 5-hour direction rule; the futures state also includes the price level.	The search still ranks settings by the random-start attempt ratio, now named so. Version 9 adds a continuing-slot stage (continuing_v9.py): for every final setting, a slot runs attempts back to back for nine years on one path and calendar with everything it carries (path position and price level, calendar, The5ers credits, monthly and activation fees, dated payouts, the 5-hour direction rule), the first year discarded as warm-up, 12 slots on each of 16 new paths. Its rate, with a path-cluster interval, is Part II's long-run rate, and the portfolio's choices between alternatives use it. The continuing-slot rate lies within 1.96 combined standard errors of the final random-start ratio for 22 of 26 chosen settings (largest +3.1, GFT on Nasdaq); summed over them, $50,929 against $51,035 a month. On the continuing stage's own paths and with the same momentum rule (cont_check_v9.py), the measurement alone differs by less than its 95% interval for 26 of 26 settings (largest +2.0 standard errors); the larger gaps come from the momentum rule, whose attempts on one path take the same side at the same time and scatter more from path to path (11.1).
13	**A fresh account does not make the two phases independent** AGREED	Section 6.1 said the second phase's trades are independent of the first's, so P(pass 2 | passed 1) equals an unconditional P2. The starting weekday, hour and (futures) price level of phase 2 depend on how phase 1 ended.	6.1 keeps the always-valid product P(both) = P1 x P(2 | 1), defines the engine's P2 as that conditional probability (the engine simulates both phases in sequence on one path, so it estimates it directly), and reserves the product of unconditional probabilities for the calendar-free chain, where it is exact.
14	**Pass-rate intervals were binomial, not path-clustered** AGREED	The '±' on every two-phase pass rate was 1.96 sqrt(P(1-P)/n) over 24,000 attempts that reuse 16 paths, while the text promised the larger of a cluster interval and an attempt-level one.	optimize_v9 keeps each path's attempts and passes and prints the larger of the cluster-robust interval (Student t, 15 degrees of freedom) and the attempt-level one, as for the EV per month. FTMO: 0.2914 ± 0.0079 (cluster 0.0079, attempt-level 0.0057).
15	**The interval of the summed programme rates left out the shared paths** AGREED	Every final figure used the same 16 paths, so programmes on one market (and sizes of one programme) are correlated, but the sum's interval added the programmes' widths in quadrature. Its 'about 1.1 standard errors' comparison was therefore not established. tq(23) also took the table's 25-degree value (2.060 for 2.069). The claim that overlapping intervals made a choice indistinguishable from noise ignored that candidates share paths and seeds, so a paired difference can be precise when the separate intervals overlap. The fresh final figures were also reused to choose markets and allocations, so the Part II sum of the chosen programmes is not free of selection.	Every final and continuing row keeps its per-path sums; the interval of a sum of programmes is computed from the per-path sums of the whole portfolio (its full covariance), with exact Student quantiles (optimize_v9.tq). Comparisons between settings use paired per-path differences. The text states that the portfolio's choices use the continuing-slot figures and that the Part II sum is therefore not a selection-free estimate; the portfolio simulations run on fresh paths, so their means are. The recommended plan's sum of long-run rates is $72,523 ± $5,189 with the full covariance; adding the programmes' widths in quadrature would give ±$3,599.
16	**Cycle cash formulas and cash tables used the nominal payout target** AGREED	Since version 8 a win may pass the target, so a successful cycle pays its balance at success, not X. 7.2's formula, the formula sheet and the cash-per-payout tables multiplied by X1 and X while the chain's withdrawal used the balance at success: for FTMO the mean paid per successful cycle was $20,082, not $20,000, and the mean cash with exactly one paid cycle $16,673.51, not $16,608. Maven's mean, $4,701.92, was below the nominal $4,900 because of finding 17.	7.2 and the formula sheet use m1 = E[balance at success, cycle 1] and m = E[balance at success, later cycles]: E[C] = alpha (m1 q1 + m q1 q/(1-q)) + R q1 q^(r-1), and GFT's two special cycles likewise. The tables give E[cash | n cycles paid] = alpha (m1 + (n-1) m) + refund, from the chain, labelled as the chain's reset-cycle model. FTMO at its chosen setting: $m_1 = \$30{,}044.33$ against a target of $\$30{,}000$; mean cash with exactly one paid cycle $\$24{,}643.29$ (chain).
17	**Maven's chain and engine stopped on different balances** AGREED	The chain declared a cycle successful whenever the distance to the ceiling was below the smallest allowed win (about $865 at the chosen setting), so it paid $4,500 at a balance where the engine, which pays at the target or within $1 of the ceiling, kept trading with a smaller position. Agreement of expected cash within an interval did not show that the two models used one rule.	The chain now uses the engine's rule: the ceiling is a cap on every win, a win too small for the minimum distance is placed with its risk lowered (as the engine does), and a cycle is paid only at the target or within $1 of the ceiling. Verification 7 compares the paid amount per successful cycle and the first cycle's success rate between the engine and the chain on the same stopping set. At the chosen setting the engine (the chain's rules, 48 paths, 19,200 funded accounts, 27,512 payouts) pays $4,900.00 ± $0.00 per successful cycle against the chain's $4,900.00, and the first cycle succeeds in 58.9% ± 0.7% against 59.1%.
18	**'Fewest trades means least cost' does not follow under variable stakes** AGREED	With cost proportional to risk, the expected total cost is rho E[sum of risks], not a constant times the number of trades, and with overshoots the pass probability depends on the mean balance at success too. Invoking bold play did not fill those steps.	5.6 now states the cost as rho E[sum of l_i] and the pass probability through both K and the mean balance at success, and presents the search's winners as empirical results for the grid searched; the bold-play theorem is cited only for its own model.
19	**A daily profit stop is not automatically neutral for the pass probability** AGREED	6.4 said that stopping at a daily target is a stopping time, so in a cost-free fair game the pass probability is unchanged. Optional stopping preserves the expected stopped balance, not a hitting probability; with overshoots P = B/(B + E[X_end | pass]), which a policy change can move (a fair game ending at +1 or -1 passes with probability 1/2, one ending at +2 or -1 with 1/3).	6.4 states the invariance only for exact landing at fixed boundaries, and otherwise refers to the engine, which measures the effect.
20	**Working-day reviews were calendar days** AGREED	The engine added review x 24 hours, so a three-working-day review after a Friday ended on Monday.	Reviews and payout processing are working days on the path's calendar (acct_mc._bdays): three working days after a Friday afternoon end on Wednesday afternoon. tests_v9.py checks it.

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 8	What version 9 does
21	**Smaller document errors** AGREED	p.75: four 100K accounts' cash was said to be 'exactly twice' that of two 200K accounts; both hold $400,000, so under exact scaling the two are equal. p.13: the boxed terminal rule ran off the page. p.38: the The5ers size table called every row the plan's setting scaled, while the 100K row is High Stakes Classic and the small rows New with their own settings. p.84: the cost stresses (200 paired lives, baseline $61,227) were compared with the 1,200-life headline. p.19 and response 11: counting from the first trade was said to delay the clock 'at most hours', but a funded account issued after Friday's cut-off waits until Monday.	Each is corrected: 'equal to' (and, with whole lots and minimal fillers, equal only up to rounding, which the scaling test now reports as a paired difference); the formula is reflowed; the size table names each row's programme and setting; the stresses are compared with their own paired baseline; the first-trade clock can wait days.

Further errors found while fixing the review's findings

#	Further error	What it was, and the fix
n17	**A position opened at the open of an hour that had already begun**	Found by the payout-clock test of tests_v9.py. The engine's clock can stand part-way into an hour (a random start, a day boundary plus a few seconds); the trader then opened the position at the open of that hour, up to an hour before the decision, and the first funded trade's time, which starts the payout clock, was taken from the clock rather than from the bar. There is no look-ahead in the decision (the direction uses completed hours only, and the price is a martingale), but the dates were inconsistent. A position now opens at the first hourly open not before the clock, and every date is that bar's open.
n18	**A rounded futures position fell short of the target it was sized to reach**	Version 8 rounded a futures position down to whole contracts and scaled both the risk and the win by the same factor, so a trade sized to close the gap to a target fell short by up to the dropped fraction and needed a further trade. A take-profit set by a cap now keeps its amount at the rounded volume (the price is placed for that win), on futures and CFDs alike.
n19	**Maven's minimum reward:risk on the last trade near the floor**	The plan never trades Maven below 1 : 1.5. On a terminal trade the risk is the room to the floor, not the planned risk, and lowering the planned risk (the rule's remedy on a normal trade) changed only the volume. The terminal trade's target is now raised to 1.5 times the room where the caps allow, in the engine and the chain alike.
n20	**The chain check charged overnight financing**	Chapter 11 compares the engine with the exact chain by switching off what the chain leaves out, the daily flat included, so the engine's positions were held overnight and paid the markets' overnight financing. The chain has no financing and the plan, flat every evening, never pays it: the check compared two cost models, and the engine came out below the chain in most programmes (in version 9's first run, kept as verify_v9_with_financing.json, 17 of 24 on the value of an attempt, mean −0.8 standard errors; version 8's table showed the same tilt), which the text attributed to noise, Friday closes and rounding. FTMO's funded account at its chosen setting on the chain's rules (48 paths, 14,400 accounts each way, fin_check_v9.py): the first cycle paid in 0.214 ± 0.012 of accounts with financing and 0.227 ± 0.012 without it, against the chain's 0.235; cash per account $6,791 ± $464 and $7,310 ± $465, against $7,523; a normal trade averaged -0.0485 ± 0.0184 R with financing and -0.0282 ± 0.0163 R without, against the chain's -0.0234 R; paired path by path (the same paths and random numbers), financing lowered the first cycle's success by 0.0137 ± 0.0099, the cash by $519 ± $340 and a trade's mean by 0.0220 ± 0.0125 R. The check now runs on the same paths without financing, trading costs kept, and on 48 paths instead of 24 (finding nothing about the plan's own figures, which never hold a position overnight): the engine's value of an attempt now lies within its 95% interval of the chain's in 20 of 24 programmes (mean difference -0.49 standard errors, 17 of 24 below), its pass rate in 24 and its cash per funded account in 19; the largest differences are -2.6, +2.0 and -2.9 standard errors. Programmes on one market share their 48 paths, so their differences move together; the largest group, the USDJPY programmes' funded cash, was rerun on 192 fresh paths for FunderPro (fin_check_v9.py): its first funded cycle succeeds in 0.294 ± 0.006 of accounts against the chain's 0.298, or 0.297 once the chain is charged the engine's own cost (15.75 trades a cycle against 15.30: positions closed at the Friday close are reopened on Monday).
n21	**The futures choice did not apply the plan's minimum stop**	The plan places no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations, and the CFD choice enforces it, but the futures search also tries 0.5 and its choice took the best refined setting without the limit; the audit checked the limit on 100K accounts only. Version 8 happened to choose a stop of 1 for both futures programmes; version 9's first run chose 0.5 for Apex (k = 3, $400 risk: $229 ± $199 a month on the refine paths, against $221 ± $34 for the best setting inside the limit; opt_v9_futures.jsonl). The futures choice and the audit now apply the minimum: Apex at k = 1.5, m = 1, $600 risk, $238 ± $41 a month on the final paths and $293 ± $76 as a continuing slot; the recommended plan holds no futures, so its figures are unchanged, and the futures portfolio was rerun.

APPENDIX A2

The earlier reviews, in brief

Version 8 answered a 27-point review of version 7 (26 agreed in full, one in part) and found 16 further errors: daily-loss bases per firm, FXIFY Classic without a refund, Fintokei's and Alpha's payout gates, Maven's ceiling and rolling cap, one-minute sub-steps, a terminal rule that ends every failed account in a breach, the 10-minute gap from the exit minute, futures valued at the path's level, keyed random streams, trades decided on the day they open, and payouts recorded when paid. Version 7 answered a 35-point review of version 6 (no bold play, the daily flat, cost-aware sizing, margin at every entry, the exact chain and cluster intervals). The full responses are docs/v8_review_response.md and docs/v7_review_response.md.

APPENDIX B

Formula sheet

Quantity	Formula	Exact for	Where
Value of one attempt	$\mathbb{E}[V] = \Pr(\text{pass})\,\mathbb{E}[C] + \text{credits} - F$	always	1.2
Zero-cost example	$-F + P(\alpha D + qR), q = D/(D+X)$	idealised model	1.3
Notional, target distance	$N = l/(m\sigma), u = m\sigma\,(w+c)/l$	always	4.1
Win probability, mean, variance	$p = l/(l+w+c); -c; l(w+c)$	fixed cost, binary outcome	4.2–4.3
Cost per unit of risk	$\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	always	4.4
Pass probability, no cost	$B/(A+B)$	exact landing on A or $-B$	5.1
Pass probability with cost	$(e^{\theta B}-1)/(e^{\theta(A+B)}-1), \theta = 2c/v$	approximation	5.2
Risk of the next trade; the terminal trade	$l = \min(L, (x+B-b)/(1+\rho), \dots)$; if that is $< l_{\min}$: the volume of $(x+B)/(1+\rho)$ at the plan's stop (at least the smallest), its stop order at the floor; win chance $l_e/(l_e+w+c), l_e = x+B-c$	the plan's rule	5.4
Exact chain	$V(x) = p\,V(x+w) + (1-p)\,V(x-l-c)$, and N, K, T	binary trades, per-trade caps	5.5
Accounting identity	$P\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + (1-P)\,\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$; with every failure at $-B$: $P = (B-K)/(\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B)$	bounded stopped sum, mean of each trade $-c$	5.5
Two phases	$P = P_1 \Pr(2 \mid 1)$; the engine estimates $\Pr(2 \mid 1)$ directly; $= P_1 P_2$ with unconditional P_2 in the calendar-free chain	always / the chain	6.1
Withdrawal identity	$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] - \mathbb{E}[Q]$, Q = profit forfeited	cycle-by-cycle stopping	7.1
Funded cash, cycle form	$\alpha\,(m_1 q_1 + m\,q_1 q/(1-q)) + R\,q_1 q^{r-1}, m_1, m$ = mean balance at a cycle's success	independent reset cycles	7.2
Two special first cycles (GFT)	$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid}] = q_a + q_a^2/(1-q_b); \mathbb{E}[W] = m_a(q_a+q_a^2) + m_b\,q_a^2 q_b/(1-q_b)$	independent reset cycles	7.2
Cash given n paid cycles	$\alpha(m_1 + (n-1)\,m)$ + refund	independent reset cycles (a mean: cash is random)	7.2
Trade duration	$m^2(w+c)/l$	approximation (arithmetic motion)	8.1
Value per month	$30.44\,\mathbb{E}_\pi[V]/\mathbb{E}_\pi[T_{\text{days}}]$, estimated by a continuing slot; the random-start ratio $30.44\sum V/\sum T$ ranks settings	long-run rate (Markov renewal)	8.3
Cluster-robust variance of a ratio	$\frac{G}{G-1}\sum_g (V_g - \hat{r}T_g)^2/(\sum_g T_g)^2$; a sum of programmes: the same from the per-path sums of all of them	independent clusters	8.4
Path generator's error per watched sub-step	$G(r) = \mathbb{E}\min(1, 3e^{-(r^2-Z^2)}), r = W/\sqrt{v}$	a valid bound	3.3
Margin at entry	$l \le 0.6\,\lambda\,m\sigma\,(S+x)$	the plan's rule	10.2
Scaling an account	$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S)$	scale-free rules	27.2
Paid cash under refusals	$ar(1-\phi)(1-e^{-\phi r H})/(\phi r)$; n scheduled requests: $a(1-\phi)(1-(1-\phi)^n)/\phi$	Poisson requests; a fixed schedule	29.1

APPENDIX C

Glossary

Terminal trade	The last bracket of an account whose room above the floor is too small for a normal trade: its stop order sits at the floor, so the account recovers or ends in a breach (5.4).
Breach level	The loss at which an account breaches: the nearer of its floor and today's loss limit. A barrier of every trade in the engine (4.1).
Continuing slot	One slot run back to back on one path and calendar, carrying everything an attempt passes to the next; Part II's long-run rate (8.3).
Random-start ratio	$30.44 \sum V / \sum T$ over attempts started at random points of a path: the search's yardstick (8.3).
Filler trade	A 0.01-lot position held 3 minutes on a missing trading day, where a firm counts any opened position (6.3).
Allowance D	The funded account's maximum loss: the floor sits D below the starting balance.
Attempt	One evaluation bought, from purchase until a phase fails or the funded account that followed it ends.
Bold play	Staking enough on each bet to reach the goal in one win; not used by the plan (5.6).
Bracket	A position with its stop-loss and take-profit attached at entry and never moved.
Concentration policy	No trade and no day above 40% of the current target (6.7).
Daily flat	No entry from 19:00 UTC, everything closed at 20:00 UTC (6.5).
Engine	The rule-by-rule simulation of an account on hourly price paths (acct_mc.py, pathfirm.py, lockstep.py).
Exact chain	The trade-level Markov chain of 5.5, solved by iteration (analytic_v9.py).
Stream	The random numbers of one synthetic path, keyed by path number, market, length and sub-steps (3.3; stream_manifest_v9.json).
Payout target X	The profit at which a funded account stops and requests a payout.
Renewal–reward	The long-run value per unit time of a repeated process: $\mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$, under the stationary distribution of the states attempts start in (8.3).
Slot	One account position at one firm, refilled with a new evaluation whenever an attempt ends.
Tier	A firm's reliability class (A, B, D) from public evidence, used for the refusal scenarios.
Winner's curse	The upward bias of the best of many noisy estimates; removed by reporting every figure from paths not used to choose it.

APPENDIX D

How every number was computed

File	What it does
`calibrate.py, sigma_v32.json`	costs and trading hours per market; hourly volatilities
`multi.py, pathfirm.py`	synthetic price paths (one-minute Brownian-bridge sub-steps with their closes, one random stream per path and market) and the trader (whole lots and contracts, the breach barrier, holding times, filler trades, exit times, the 10-minute gap, the generator's error bound)
`acct_mc.py`	the rule engine: phases, funded accounts, payouts, daily-loss bases, the terminal rule, cost-aware sizing, concentration, minimum target distance, margin, payout clocks and gates, duration rules, working days
`firms_v3.py … firms_v8.py, firms_v9.py`	every firm's rules; firms_v9 holds the version 9 inputs and the plan's policies
`rules_snapshot_v9.json`	the sentences from the firms' pages behind every rule input, with URLs and date
`optimize_v9.py`	grid (paths 101–104), refine (111–114), futures, final (121–136) → opt_v9_*.json(l)
`continuing_v9.py → continuing_v9.json`	every final setting as a continuing slot (paths 151–166): Part II's long-run rates
`cont_check_v9.py → cont_check_v9.json`	every chosen setting as random starts on the continuing paths with both direction rules: the measurement and the direction rule separated
`analytic_v9.py`	the exact chain with the terminal rule and the minimum target distance, written separately from the engine
`tests_v9.py → tests_v9.json`	direct tests of every new rule mechanism of the engine
`streams_v9.py → stream_manifest_v9.json`	every random stream of every stage; fails if two independent stages share one
`verify_v9.py, sens_v9.py`	checks against theory (the chain checks without overnight financing), sub-step convergence, scaling, Maven's stopping set; cost, risk, concentration, flat, daily-loss base, direction, filler and holding-time sensitivities
`fin_check_v9.py → fin_check_v9.json`	the witnesses of n20: FTMO's funded account on the chain's rules with and without overnight financing; FunderPro's first funded cycle on USDJPY on 192 fresh paths
`verify_v9_with_financing.json`	the first run of the chain check, with overnight financing (n20), kept as the record
`lockstep.py, lockstep_portfolio_v9.py`	one person's accounts on one calendar; portfolios, 36-month lives, budgets, stress, correlation, news hours, behaviour
`progs_v9.py, review_v9.py`	the firms' written rules and sources; the review response
`build_math_v9.py, doc9_*.py, math_v9_*.html`	this document: every number is read from the files above
`rerun_v9.sh, environment_v9.json`	the whole pipeline, in order; the software versions used
`audit_v9.py → audit_v9.json`	the end-of-run audit: stalls, coverage, a trade-by-trade replay of every chosen setting against every rule, the chain's identity, the tests, the budget lives' dated cash, the document's numbers

The repository: `github.com/astrafala/Monthly-EV-Maxxing`. To reproduce: `sh rerun_v9.sh` (every stage, the grid included), then `python3 build_math_v9.py` and `python3 audit_v9.py`. Synthetic paths are rebuilt exactly from their stream keys and sigma_v32.json; no market data is needed. Every key and seed is fixed in the code; with the versions in environment_v9.json every figure reproduces exactly (other platforms may differ in the last digits of floating-point sums). Version 9 uses no real-history run: one two-year history is one sample, and its attempts are not independent validations.

APPENDIX E

Sources

Programme	Sources (read 4 and 5 October 2026, Blue Guardian, BrightFunded and Fintokei again on 11 October; rules_snapshot_v9.json quotes them)
FTMO 2-Step Challenge	ftmo.com/en/faq/how-do-i-withdraw-my-profits/ (first reward 14 days after the first trade); ftmo.com/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/ ($400,000 per trader); https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trade/; ftmo.com (trading objectives, forbidden practices); https://ftmo.com/en/trading-objectives/
FundingPips 2-Step Flex	https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/4817428798017 7-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy)
The5ers High Stakes	the5ers.com/faqs/what-is-the-drawdown-rule-for-high-stakes/; the5ers.com/faqs/how-many-high-stakes-accounts-can-i-have/; the5ers.com/high-stakes/
FXIFY Two Phase Classic	intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/12130186-2-phase-account-types (refunds by type); intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/14834680-the-2-phase-classic-account; fxify.com/blog/cheapest-path-funded-50k-fxify/ (refund guide, 14 September 2026)
FundedNext Stellar 2-Step	https://help.fundednext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundednext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model; help.fundednext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies)
Fintokei ProTrader	https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated; support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538884 (withdrawals, minimum amount); support.fintokei.com/en/articles/8428030 (minimum trading days); https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade; https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538884-how-and-how-often-can-i-withdraw-my-performance-rewards-and-what-is-the-minimum-amount
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/
Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%	help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10570531-bi-weekly-performance-fee; https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule; help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8420429-alpha-pro-8-10
FunderPro Classic	https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts; support.funderpro.com/en/articles/419844 (rewards, $100 minimum); support.funderpro.com/en/articles/412020 (add-ons); https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges
Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard	help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard; help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/9549359-all-about-rewards-and-profit-splits; https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard
BrightFunded 2-Step Classic	https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process; help.brightfunded.com (refund add-on)
Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard	help.blueguardian.com/en/articles/14062291-2-step-standard-rules
Maven 2-Step	https://maventrading.com/faqs (read 4 Oct 2026)
Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)	https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy; help.topstep.com (pricing)
Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)	https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/; apextraderfunding.com help centre

Reliability evidence: TrustPilot company pages (rating-withheld notices, August–September 2026) and PropFirmMap safety grades, both read on 4 October 2026. Rules change; keep dated copies of the pages that apply to each purchase.